

FIELD HQ · PRINTED EDITION

Beyond the Map's Edge

The complete working file: poem, solves, evidence, gate, statements, map and next moves

40	25	249
SOLVES ON THE BOARD	STILL STANDING	FACTS
92	35	20
POSEY STATEMENTS	CONFIRMED IN WRITING	GATE RULES

Printed September 13, 2026 from the live Field HQ database.
Leading solve: **TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor** · score 97
claude.ai/code/artifact/1487d6f0-4342-4d62-b67b-c46c2a88d5ed

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HOW TO READ THE TIERS

Confirmed: Posey in writing or the official rules. **Likely / Reported:** Posey through a named secondary source (a transcript, a Q&A compilation). **Circulating:** community consensus. **Fan analysis:** a derived argument. **Unverified:** a single claim, unchecked. Nothing below Reported carries a poem line on its own.

HOW A SOLVE IS SCORED

score = chain×2 + poem verdicts×3 – fails×4 + gates passed×1.5 + evidence – hard-line fails×30 – gate fails×40. A solve is *ruled out* when it fails a gate or a hard line.

1 HUNT STATUS AT A GLANCE

LEADING SOLVE

TOP 1 ·
Wisdom River
corridor

score 97 · 12/20 lines placed ·
12 gates passed

STANDING / TOTAL

25 / 40

15 ruled out by the gate or a
hard line

POEM PLACED

15 / 20

13 lines contested between
solves

POSEY SAID

92

35 confirmed in writing · 249
facts total

TOP 3 VERDICT

1

Wisdom River corridor — Big Hole → Beaverhead → Twin Bridges (SW Montana)
Most evidence, least finished. The only region where the poem's own words (Wisdom, Hole, three, river) and Posey's own life (grandfather's Montana, the Dillon signing, the book's gazetteer) land on the same forty miles.

2

Sinks Canyon → Wind River front (Lander, Wyoming)
The cleanest stanza 2 in the store: four lines in order, on foot, in under a mile, with a natural capital-H Hole. Ranked second only because stanza 3 is unpinned.

3

Jackson Hole — Granite Creek / the Tetons' foot (Wyoming)
The proper-noun Hole Posey was asked about by name, granite by name and by rock, and a 'him' and a 'her' facing each other across the valley. Ranked third because the poem's order fights the geography.

LEADERBOARD

#	SOLVE	REGION	SCORE	CHAIN	POEM	GATE	EVID.	PLACED	GATES ✓/X	STATUS
1	TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor	MT · Beaverhead / Madison counties	97	40	9	18	30	12/20	12/0	standing
2	TOP 2 · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front	WY · Fremont County, Sinks Canyon SP / Shoshone NF	91	34	12	22.5	22.5	7/20	15/0	standing
3	Wisdom / Big Hole / Beaverhead Rock	MT · Beaverhead County	88	26	21	18	22.5	7/20	12/0	standing
4	Sinks Canyon → Wind River front	WY · Fremont County, Sinks Canyon SP / Shoshone NF	84	28	15	18	22.5	7/20	12/0	standing
5	Thermopolis	WY · Hot Springs County, Hot Springs SP / BLM canyon	84	28	18	15	22.5	7/20	10/0	standing
6	Granite Creek / Jackson Hole	WY · Teton County, Bridger-Teton NF / Hoback	81	24	21	13.5	22.5	7/20	9/0	standing
7	Twin Bridges	MT · Madison County, Twin Bridges / Beaverhead Rock	78	22	18	15	22.5	7/20	10/0	standing
8	TOP 3 · Jackson Hole	WY · Teton County, Bridger-Teton NF / Hoback	77	26	6	19.5	25.5	9/20	13/0	standing
9	Pioneer Mountains	MT · Beaverhead County, Beaverhead-Deerlodge NF	75	22	18	13.5	21	6/20	9/0	standing

#	SOLVE	REGION	SCORE	CHAIN	POEM	GATE	EVID.	PLACED	GATES ✓/X	STATUS
10	Sweetwater River	WY · Natrona / Fremont counties, Hwy 220	75	18	21	16.5	19.5	5/20	11/0	standing
11	Gates of the Mountains	MT · Lewis and Clark County, Holter Lake / Helena NF	68	18	17	15	18.3	5/20	10/0	standing
12	Hole-in-the-Wall	WY · Johnson County, BLM Middle Fork Powder	59	16	11	12	19.5	5/20	8/0	standing
13	City of Rocks	ID · Cassia County, City of Rocks National Reserve	40	10	1	12	16.5	3/20	8/0	standing
14	Beartooth Highway / Beartooth Butte	MT/WY · Custer-Gallatin / Shoshone NF	27	0	6	9	12	0/20	6/0	standing
15	Lemhi Pass / Sacagawea's return	MT/ID · Continental Divide, Salmon-Challis / Beaverhead-Deerlodge NF	27	0	6	9	12	0/20	6/0	standing
16	Tres Piedras / Ojo Caliente	NM · Taos County, Carson NF	23	0	12	9	2.4	0/20	6/0	standing
17	Bear Lodge / Devils Tower	WY · Crook County, Bear Lodge Mountains / Black Hills NF	21	0	3	6	12	0/20	4/0	standing
18	Big Springs / Henry's Fork	ID · Fremont County, Caribou-Targhee NF	20	0	9	9	2.4	0/20	6/0	standing
19	Torrey Lake petroglyphs	WY · Fremont County, Whiskey Basin WHMA	18	0	2	6	9.6	0/20	4/0	standing
20	Heron Lake	NM · Rio Arriba County, Heron Lake SP / Carson NF	17	0	6	7.5	3.6	0/20	5/0	standing
21	Ennis / Sphinx Mountain	MT · Madison County, Custer-Gallatin NF	15	0	6	9	0	0/20	6/0	standing
22	Provo Canyon / Timpanogos	UT · Utah County, Uinta-Wasatch-Cache NF	15	0	5	7.5	2.4	0/20	5/0	standing
23	High Uintas	UT · Summit County, Uinta-Wasatch-Cache NF	15	0	-1	4.5	11.4	0/20	3/0	standing
24	Vedauwoo / Pole Mountain	WY · Albany County, Medicine Bow NF	11	0	6	4.5	0	0/20	3/0	standing
25	Crazy Mountains	MT · Sweet Grass / Park counties	5	0	0	4.5	0	0/20	3/0	standing
26	Hidden Lake / Queener Mountain	MT · Beaverhead County, Anaconda-Pintler Wilderness, N of Wisdom	17	10	18	-40	19.5	5/20	6/1	ruled out
27	Bear Trap Canyon	MT · Madison County, BLM Lee Metcalf Wilderness	11	12	12	-40	18	4/20	6/1	ruled out
28	Gold Basin / Tuk cirque	UT · La Sal Mountains, Geyser Pass Rd → Gold Basin Rd	10	0	24	-40	12	0/20	9/1	ruled out

#	SOLVE	REGION	SCORE	CHAIN	POEM	GATE	EVID.	PLACED	GATES ✓/X	STATUS
29	Thousand Springs / Lost River Sinks	ID · Gooding / Butte counties	-17	0	6	-40	12	0/20	3/1	ruled out
30	Devil's Slide / Gardiner	MT · Park County, roadside US-89	-20	0	3	-40	12	0/20	3/1	ruled out
31	Medicine Wheel	WY · Big Horn County, Bighorn NF	-21	0	2	-40	12	0/20	3/1	ruled out
32	Blue Hole	NM · Guadalupe County, city park	-27	0	2	-40	6	0/20	3/1	ruled out
33	Sacajawea Peak	MT · Gallatin County, Custer- Gallatin NF	-27	0	3	-40	2.4	0/20	5/1	ruled out
34	Sister Superior / Castle Valley	UT · Grand County, Castle Valley / BLM	-33	20	-3	-80	22.5	7/20	5/2	ruled out
35	Pompeys Pillar	MT · Yellowstone County, BLM National Monument	-36	0	-1	-40	0	0/20	3/1	ruled out
36	Madison River / Harlequin Lake	MT · Gallatin NF / Yellowstone boundary	-50	0	6	-80	9	0/20	10/2	ruled out
37	Rainbow Arch bridge	MT · Deer Lodge County, Warm Springs WMA	-62	0	6	-80	6	0/20	4/2	ruled out
38	Boiling River / Gardiner	MT · Park County, YNP north entrance	-70	0	3	-80	2.4	0/20	3/2	ruled out
39	Medicine Lakes	UT · La Sal Mountains, near La Sal Pass	-108	0	27	-160	10.2	0/20	10/4	ruled out
40	Corona & Bowtie Arch	UT · Moab / Gold Bar, BLM	-127	0	12	-160	7.2	0/20	9/4	ruled out

BEST READ OF THE POEM

The top-confidence placement per line across standing solves. Contested = more than one distinct reading.

LINE	POEM	BEST READ	BY	AGREE
L01	Can you find what lives in time,	The river What lives in time is the river; stanza 1 is the frame, and 5:4 says you already had it	TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor	1 place · 1 read
L02	Flowing through each measured rhyme?	Word count 'Hole' is the poem's 42nd word (verified by count); 42 is confirmed relevant by Posey (reported)	TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor	2 place · 2 reads
L03	Wisdom waits in shadowed sight—	Wisdom, MT A town named Wisdom on the Wisdom River — the book names it	Wisdom / Big Hole / Beaverhead Rock	5 place · 5 reads
L04	For those who read these words just right.	no standing solve places this line		
L05	As hope surges, clear and bright,	The Rise of the Sinks Spring surges up clear from the rock; giant trout; no fishing	TOP 2 · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front	6 place · 4 reads

LINE	POEM	BEST READ	BY	AGREE
L06	<i>Walk near waters' silent flight.</i>	Popo Agie underground, Sinks → Rise A quarter mile of silent, unseen flow; about two hours underground	TOP 2 · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front	6 place · 4 reads
L07	<i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	Big Hole River / Big Hole valley Natural, proper-noun Hole. Posey: no man-made implication (reported); hole-named place = 'on the nose' (reported); community calls this line solved (circulating)	TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor	9 place · 7 reads
L08	<i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Popo Agie above the Sinks Fishing is banned from the Rise to the road bridge; cast your pole above, in the national forest	TOP 2 · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front	12 place · 11 reads
L09	<i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Sleeping Indian (Sheep Mountain), east rim A 'he' lying on his back, obvious from the west; alive or not by perspective. No bear name	TOP 3 · Jackson Hole	9 place · 8 reads
L10	<i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	Devil's Gate The ancient gates: a 370-ft granite cleft on the Oregon Trail	Sweetwater River	10 place · 9 reads
L11	<i>Her foot of three at twenty degree,</i>	Twin Bridges — three forks make the Jefferson Wisdom, Philanthropy, Philosophy (verified history). Run 20° from the confluence	TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor	6 place · 6 reads
L12	<i>Return her face to find the place.</i>	Back-bearing 200° / Sacagawea's return Reverse the 20° line from her foot; or her literal return home over Lemhi. Rotation is 'technically' implied (reported)	TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor	3 place · 3 reads
L13	<i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Wind River granite, upper Sinks Canyon Precambrian granite cliffs in Shoshone NF; off-trail faces within a mile of the road	TOP 2 · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front	10 place · 9 reads
L14	<i>Where secrets of the past still hold.</i>	Independence Rock 5,000 carved emigrant names — secrets of the past still hold	Sweetwater River	3 place · 3 reads
L15	<i>Beyond the reach of time's swift race,</i>	Wind River Canyon geologic signs Road signs count back through 2.9 billion years: 'beyond the reach of time'	Thermopolis	1 place · 1 read
L16	<i>Wonder guards this sacred space.</i>	no standing solve places this line		
L17	<i>Truth rests not in clever minds,</i>	no standing solve places this line		
L18	<i>Not in tangled, twisted finds.</i>	no standing solve places this line		
L19	<i>Like a river's steady flow—</i>	The Big Hole / Jefferson A river's steady flow — the through-line	TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor	4 place · 4 reads
L20	<i>What you seek, you already know.</i>	no standing solve places this line		

2

THE POEM, LINE BY LINE

Beyond the Map's Edge

*Can you find what lives in time,
Flowing through each measured rhyme?
Wisdom waits in shadowed sight—
For those who read these words just right.*

*As hope surges, clear and bright,
Walk near waters' silent flight.
Round the bend, past the Hole,
I wait for you to cast your pole.*

*In ursa east his realm awaits;
His bride stands guard at ancient gates.
Her foot of three at twenty degree,
Return her face to find the place.*

*Double arcs on granite bold,
Where secrets of the past still hold.
Beyond the reach of time's swift race,
Wonder guards this sacred space.*

*Truth rests not in clever minds,
Not in tangled, twisted finds.
Like a river's steady flow—
What you seek, you already know.*

STANZA 1 · METHOD

armchair · how to read, not where to go

L01 *Can you find what lives in time,*

UNSOLVED

MYSTERY

35 facts · 3 against · 1 solves place it

Read 'time' literally: clock, date, hours. Stanza 1 is reading method, not geography. Under stanza-5 reading 4, this line IS the answer (a river lives in time) rather than a step — which would explain why stanza 1 has no actionable clue. New: the map as a time anchor (~1864) — old names, no dams, Washington as 42nd, Whitney unnamed. If the map is fixed to a year, 'what lives in time' has a literal referent.

Best read: [The river](#) (TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor)

L02 *Flowing through each measured rhyme?*

UNSOLVED

MYSTERY

11 facts · 0 against · 2 solves place it

Counting is the method: words per line, syllables, positions. Posey confirmed numbers are indirectly encoded.

Best read: [Word count](#) (TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor)

L03 *Wisdom waits in shadowed sight—*

UNSOLVED

GEOGRAPHIC

20 facts · 1 against · 5 solves place it

Ends on an em dash — one of only two in the poem (the other is 5:3). Possibly the cipher's home.

Best read: [Wisdom, MT](#) (Wisdom / Big Hole / Beaverhead Rock)

L04 *For those who read these words just right.*

UNSOLVED

INSTRUCTION

23 facts · 2 against · 0 solves place it

Confirms the stanza is instruction, not movement. He would not rule out reading or rearranging the poem other than as presented.

STANZA 2 · APPROACH

armchair · then a walk

L05 *As hope surges, clear and bright,*

PINNED

GEOGRAPHIC

23 facts · 1 against · 6 solves place it

First actionable clue (Posey). Working read: Matrimony Spring at US-191/SR-128 north of Moab — cold, clear, year-round, La Sal-fed; local marriage legend plants the bride motif early.

Best read: [The Rise of the Sinks](#) (TOP 2 · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front)

L06 ***Walk near waters' silent flight.*** PINNED NAVIGATE 19 facts · 4 against · 6 solves place it

The Colorado River along SR-279 (Potash Road). Walking-distance constraint starts here. Open objection: nothing in the line picks 279 over SR-128 or a bank.

Best read: **Popo Agie underground, Sinks → Rise** (TOP 2 · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front)

L07 ***Round the bend, past the Hole,*** CONTESTED GEOGRAPHIC 47 facts · 18 against · 9 solves place it

Working read: the canyon bend, then the large culvert on the Gold Bar approach to Jeep Arch. Contested — Posey gave a direct 'no' to the Hole being man-made. VERIFIED: 'Hole' is the poem's 42nd word — the confirmed number lands on this line.

Best read: **Big Hole River / Big Hole valley** (TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor)

L08 ***I wait for you to cast your pole.*** THEMATIC NAVIGATE 21 facts · 2 against · 12 solves place it

Colorado riverbank along 279. Placeholder, not pinned. Fishing-pole reading unconfirmed.

Best read: **Popo Agie above the Sinks** (TOP 2 · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front)

STANZA 3 · CONSTRUCTION armchair · solvable from home

L09 ***In ursa east his realm awaits;*** PINNED CELESTIAL 63 facts · 21 against · 9 solves place it

'Bear east' as a heading; from Jeep Arch the La Sals lie east. 'His realm' = Mount Waas (12,306 ft), Grand County high point, named for a Ute chief. Objections: no bear naming in the La Sals; 'Waas = man' is hedged. New lead: 'ursa' as a decapitalized proper name — Bear Lodge (Devils Tower, Bear Lodge Mountains, NE Wyoming), where lodge ≈ realm confirms itself. Unchecked for a bride or gates.

Best read: **Sleeping Indian (Sheep Mountain), east rim** (TOP 3 · Jackson Hole)

L10 ***His bride stands guard at ancient gates.*** CONTESTED GEOGRAPHIC 50 facts · 6 against · 10 solves place it

Mount Tukuñnikivat as bride to the man-mountain, at the gates of the range. 'Ancient gates' not pinned to a feature. Contested by the 'not a living person' clarification, which reads person-shaped.

Best read: **Devil's Gate** (Sweetwater River)

L11 ***Her foot of three at twenty degree,*** PARTIAL PRECISION 38 facts · 4 against · 6 solves place it

Measurement, not shape: three feet = a yard, or 3°20' (degrees and minutes). The Tuk three-sided-pyramid reading is demoted. Posey: numbers are indirect, there is a distance element, and you needn't be at the bride to identify her foot of three — all consistent with a measurement. If the poem converges rather than walks, this is one arm of the X. Hub: 11–12 is the poem's only non-end-rhyming couplet (degree/place); the rhyme is internal — THREE/FACE — and Justin confirmed it is the only one, i.e. deliberate emphasis.

Best read: **Twin Bridges — three forks make the Jefferson** (TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor)

L12 ***Return her face to find the place.*** PARTIAL NAVIGATE 46 facts · 7 against · 3 solves place it

Three readings. A: back bearing — 20° reversed = 200°, needs an origin so yields a line not a point. B: walk to her face and turn around — plain 'return', but strands 'twenty degree' and may face away from the basin. C: reverse the face on the map — north face reversed gives the south side; armchair-solvable, leaves 20 for the foot, outputs a named place. C is the only reading that currently produces a destination: Medicine Lakes. Backtracking Q&A now supports B directly (feet return to trodden ground); the Indiana Jones / National Treasure nudge supports the bearing here being one arm of an X rather than a walk. 'Find' appears only here and at 1:1. Structure read: the middle of the poem builds a construction on a map (Indiana Jones / National Treasure — a device oriented correctly reveals the place), which is why BOTG waits until stanza 4.

Best read: **Back-bearing 200° / Sacagawea's return** (TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor)

STANZA 4 · SITE boots on the ground from here

L13 ***Double arcs on granite bold,*** PARTIAL CHECKPOINT 59 facts · 20 against · 10 solves place it

Two basins at Tuk's foot on opposite faces. Option 1 (favored): Medicine Lakes, south side near La Sal Pass — plural by name, drivable pass with trailhead, exactly what Reading C delivers; access-road roughness must be checked against the no-high-clearance rule. Option 2: Gold Basin / Tuk cirque, north side — cirques are arcs by definition, but no named paired pools and higher, more snowbound. Old objection stands: none of this is granite. Corona/Bowtie now demoted.

Best read: [Wind River granite, upper Sinks Canyon](#) (TOP 2 · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front)

L14 ***Where secrets of the past still hold.*** THEMATIC CHECKPOINT 16 facts · 0 against · 3 solves place it

The sediment record on the basin floor: alpine basins hold undisturbed layers back to deglaciation — pollen, charcoal, ash, isotopes — which is why researchers core exactly these lakes.

Best read: [Independence Rock](#) (Sweetwater River)

L15 ***Beyond the reach of time's swift race,*** THEMATIC LITERARY 7 facts · 0 against · 1 solves place it

That same sealed record, beyond time's reach. L2 and L3 read as one continuous statement, which is what consecutive clue order should produce. The water itself is annual snowmelt; the sediment carries the age.

Best read: [Wind River Canyon geologic signs](#) (Thermopolis)

L16 ***Wonder guards this sacred space.*** THEMATIC MYSTERY 80 facts · 24 against · 0 solves place it

The peaks ringing the basin — Tuk, Peale, Mellenthin, Mount Laurel — a cirque of 12,000-foot summits, so 'wonder guards' is literal description.

STANZA 5 · WARNING armchair · what not to do

L17 ***Truth rests not in clever minds,*** THEMATIC INSTRUCTION 4 facts · 2 against · 0 solves place it

Method instruction: solve plainly. Reading 1 makes this a warning label. Caution — Posey left stanza 5 open as possibly the last actionable clue.

L18 ***Not in tangled, twisted finds.*** THEMATIC INSTRUCTION 7 facts · 0 against · 0 solves place it

Warns against tangled, twisted finds — a check on solves built backward from a destination. Backed by no red herrings, consecutive order.

L19 ***Like a river's steady flow—*** PARTIAL LITERARY 10 facts · 1 against · 4 solves place it

Second em dash, pairing with 1:3 (reading 2, the frame's closing bracket). Also the literal river through-line (reading 3). Or an at-site instruction if stanza 5 is still geography.

Best read: [The Big Hole / Jefferson](#) (TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor)

L20 ***What you seek, you already know.*** PARTIAL MYSTERY 10 facts · 2 against · 0 solves place it

Callback to 1:1 — weighted highest: 'what lives in time' is the river, and the closing line says you have carried the answer since stanza 1. Caution: may be memoir consolation, not a clue.

3 TOP 3 SOLVES — ANALYST VERDICT

Built Sep 6 2026. Every claim carries its reliability tier.

HOW THEY WERE RANKED

- Every candidate in the store was re-argued line by line against the 35 confirmed and 57 reported Posey statements, not against its own case notes.
- A solve was ranked by how many hard statements it survives with nothing overridden, how much of stanzas 2–4 it places in consecutive order at the distances Posey describes, and how much independent support it has from the book, the map and Posey's own history.
- Crowd exposure was not scored against a solve. Posey's confirmed Aug 2025 post (first two clues solved by several, some within 200 ft of the checkpoint) is mild evidence FOR the region the crowd has worked, because the crowd has overwhelmingly worked southwest Montana.
- Tiers are shown on every claim. Nothing below 'reported' was allowed to carry a line on its own.

WHAT ALL THREE SHARE

- All three keep the Hole natural and proper-noun. Posey's direct 'no' to a man-made Hole (reported, Seekers Summit) and his 'on the nose' punt on hole-named places (reported) are the two statements that cut hardest through the candidate list. The Moab culvert, Hole-in-the-Wall and Baker's Hole fail or wobble on them.
- All three keep stanza 2 at walking distance and stanza 3 solvable from a map (reported: boots on the ground only at stanza 4; 'you do not need to be at the bride to identify her foot of three' is confirmed).
- All three are inside the printed map, on free 24/7 public land with dogs allowed, and in Montana or Wyoming, the two states with the most independent support (Fenn footprint, the disclaimer's Wyoming law, the grandfather's Montana).

1

Wisdom River corridor — Big Hole → Beaverhead → Twin Bridges (SW Montana)

97
ENGINE SCORE
12✓ 0× 8 OPEN

MT · Beaverhead / Madison counties · 45.6166, -113.4536 (Wisdom) → 45.5461, -112.3320 (Twin Bridges) · 6,060 ft at Wisdom · 4,600 ft at Twin Bridges

Most evidence, least finished. The only region where the poem's own words (Wisdom, Hole, three, river) and Posey's own life (grandfather's Montana, the Dillon signing, the book's gazetteer) land on the same forty miles.

THE CASE

Lewis named the Big Hole the Wisdom River in August 1805; trappers renamed it for the 'hole' (their word for a mountain valley) it drains. So 'Wisdom waits in shadowed sight' and 'past the Hole' are one river under two names, and the book's map, drawn in a deliberately old style, is the shadowed sight that keeps the old name. The river runs out of its Hole to Twin Bridges, where Lewis's three virtues (Wisdom, Philanthropy, Philosophy) make the Jefferson: a literal 'foot of three'. Beaverhead Rock, the landmark Sacagawea recognised as home, stands twelve miles up the Beaverhead as a bride that is visible, not alive, and 'follows from the gates' if the gates are the ancient Beaverhead passage the Corps walked. Granite is on both sides: the Pioneer batholith west (Crystal Park, the book's 'wet granite') and the Tobacco Root batholith east.

ROUTE THROUGH THE POEM

LINE	PLACE	READING	TIER
L01 <i>Can you find what lives in time,</i>	The river	What lives in time is the river; stanza 1 is the frame, and 5:4 says you already had it	FAN ANALYSIS
L02 <i>Flowing through each measured rhyme?</i>	Word count	'Hole' is the poem's 42nd word (verified by count); 42 is confirmed relevant by Posey (reported)	REPORTED
L03 <i>Wisdom waits in shadowed sight—</i>	Wisdom River = Big Hole River; the town of Wisdom	Lewis's 1805 name, kept only by the town and by old maps: hidden in plain sight	CIRCULATING
L05 <i>As hope surges, clear and bright,</i>	UNPLACED — the corridor's weakest slot	Candidates: spring surge on the upper Big Hole; Jackson Hot Springs (private lodge, fails as a site, may pass as a view); Elkhorn Hot Springs on the Pioneer Byway	UNVERIFIED
L06 <i>Walk near waters' silent flight.</i>	Upper Big Hole, Land of 10,000 Haystacks	Slow silent meanders; the Netflix 'needle in a football field' points here (fan)	CIRCULATING
L07 <i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	Big Hole River / Big Hole valley	Natural, proper-noun Hole. Posey: no man-made implication (reported); hole-named place = 'on the nose' (reported); community calls this line solved (circulating)	REPORTED
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Big Hole blue-ribbon water	The book's fishing chapters; alt: 'pole' = pole star, fixing north before 3:1 (fan)	CIRCULATING
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Polaris, MT / the East Pioneers	Polaris is the pole star in Ursa Minor and a town the book names outright; East Pioneers give an 'east' half of one range	CIRCULATING

LINE	PLACE	READING	TIER
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	Beaverhead Rock over the Beaverhead passage	Visible-only, not alive (state park: view from a distance). Gates = the ancient route up the Beaverhead to Lemhi Pass; alt bride site: Sacajawea Memorial at Lemhi Pass	FAN ANALYSIS
L11 <i>Her foot of three at twenty degree,</i>	Twin Bridges — three forks make the Jefferson	Wisdom, Philanthropy, Philosophy (verified history). Run 20° from the confluence	FAN ANALYSIS
L12 <i>Return her face to find the place.</i>	Back-bearing 200° / Sacajawea's return	Reverse the 20° line from her foot; or her literal return home over Lemhi. Rotation is 'technically' implied (reported)	UNVERIFIED
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Pioneer batholith (Crystal Park) or Tobacco Root granite	Book: 'smell of pine and wet granite' at Crystal Park. No arcs identified	UNVERIFIED
L19 <i>Like a river's steady flow—</i>	The Big Hole / Jefferson	A river's steady flow — the through-line	FAN ANALYSIS

EVIDENCE

CONFIRMED Lewis named the Big Hole the Wisdom River, 6 Aug 1805; trappers' 'hole' = mountain valley. History, verified Sep 2026

REPORTED The book names Dillon, Big Hole Valley, Wisdom, Polaris, Pioneer Mountains, Crystal Park, Bannack, Blacktail Deer Creek, Clark Canyon, Red Rock River; 'the Big Hole's crystal waters'. Hub gazetteer / book verbatim

REPORTED Posey's grandfather was a Montana fish-and-game warden; Posey's summers were at the family cabin; the June 2025 signing was in Dillon; the Sep 12 2026 meet-and-greet is in Polaris. Statements report; TAU

REPORTED 'Hole' is the 42nd word of the poem; Posey confirmed 42 is relevant and called 4:19 'a little uncanny'. Count verified; hub

REPORTED Posey: the Hole has no man-made implication; whether it corresponds to a hole-named place is 'an on the nose question'. Seekers Summit

FAN ANALYSIS The book cover's torn outline matches the Big Hole watershed; pp. 4 and 117 → 113th meridian through Wisdom. Mysterious Writings top-10 list

CONFIRMED Beaverhead Rock 'may be viewed from a distance but is not directly accessible'; non-residents pay \$8 — fine for a bride you only look at, fatal for a site. Montana FWP, verified

AGAINST IT

- Distance. Wisdom to Beaverhead Rock is about 50 air miles; Posey said each clue is 'not meant to convey great distance' (reported). The corridor only works if stanza 3 is drawn on the map, not walked.
- 'As hope surges' has no pin. The first actionable clue is the one this solve is worst at.
- West Yellowstone, Posey's best-documented Fenn ground, is about 130 air miles from Wisdom (85 from Twin Bridges), outside the walked-back 75-mile remark.
- It is the crowd's solve. Fifteen months of searchers and no checkpoint photo means either the checkpoint is subtle or the crowd is in the wrong part of the corridor.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT

Any Posey answer that the Hole is not a place name; a bride confirmed outside the Beaverhead; or a checkpoint statement that puts stanza 2 and stanza 3 within walking distance of each other (this corridor cannot do that).

REPORTED

Posey: it would be 'a little strange' to discover the bride without understanding the ancient gates; the bride is visible and not alive.

Seekers Summit

CHEAPEST TESTS, IN ORDER

1. Read 'The Mountain Memory' and the chapter that introduces Tucker. If the brook is named, work it; if it is withheld, note that.
2. From the Twin Bridges confluence and from Beaverhead Rock, run 20° and 200° on the quad. List every granite outcrop within a mile of a road that the lines cross.
3. Check Crystal Park's day-use fee and hours against 'free, 24/7'. If it charges, strike it as a site.
4. Measure 'walking distance' from a candidate surge to the first bend past the Hole; anything over three miles fails the reported constraint.
5. Ask the September Featured Question: 'Is the Hole a body of water?' It is specific without being on the nose.

STILL OPEN

Which surge? · Which gates: the Beaverhead passage, Lemhi Pass, Big Hole Pass or Chief Joseph Pass? · Where are two arcs on granite within a mile of a road?

THE GATE

✓ Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling

✓ On publicly accessible land, not private property

✓ Not associated with man-made buildings; not near graves

✓ No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed

✓ No high-clearance vehicle needed

· Access free and available 24/7

✓ You can bring your dog – so not a no-dogs park trail

· Not near any man-made trail – 'a little ways off'

· Not at railroad tracks

· Within about a mile of the car to identify the spot

· Below about a mile high? (soft – check his exact words)

✓ Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe

✓ Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find

✓ Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication

✓ The Hole carries no man-made implication

✓ Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4

✓ Bride is visible, not alive, and follows from understanding the gates

· 'Return her face' technically implies a physical rotation

· Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft)

· Something must be manipulated to see it; a flashlight may help

2

Sinks Canyon → Wind River front (Lander, Wyoming)

91

ENGINE SCORE
15✓ 0× 5 OPEN

WY · Fremont County, Sinks Canyon SP / Shoshone NF · 42.7397, -108.8187 (the Rise) ·
≈ 6,100 ft

The cleanest stanza 2 in the store: four lines in order, on foot, in under a mile, with a natural capital-H Hole. Ranked second only because stanza 3 is unpinned.

THE CASE

The Middle Fork of the Popo Agie vanishes into a limestone cavern (the Sinks) and surges back up a quarter mile down-canyon at the Rise, a clear pool of huge trout where fishing is banned. Walk the poem: hope surges clear and bright (the Rise) → walk near the water's silent flight (the river running unseen underground) → round the bend, past the Hole (the canyon road bends at the Sinks) → cast your pole where fishing is allowed again above the cavern in Shoshone National Forest. The upper canyon is Wind River granite. Reported through Treasure Among Us, Sinks Canyon was itself one of Posey's Fenn-search locations, which would satisfy the 75-mile remark at zero miles.

ROUTE THROUGH THE POEM

LINE	PLACE	READING	TIER
L05 <i>As hope surges, clear and bright,</i>	The Rise of the Sinks	Spring surges up clear from the rock; giant trout; no fishing	CONFIRMED
L06 <i>Walk near waters' silent flight.</i>	Popo Agie underground, Sinks → Rise	A quarter mile of silent, unseen flow; about two hours underground	CONFIRMED
L07 <i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	The Sinks	A natural capital-H Hole the river disappears into; the canyon road bends at it	REPORTED
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Popo Agie above the Sinks	Fishing is banned from the Rise to the road bridge; cast your pole above, in the national forest	CONFIRMED
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	OPEN — three options within 30 mi	Wind River Reservation east of the Winds (Chief Washakie's realm); Bears Ears peak in the Winds; a 20° bearing from the pole star	UNVERIFIED
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	OPEN — Sacagawea at Fort Washakie	A statue and grave: visible, not alive. But 'near graves' fails the rules for a SITE, so she can only be a bride you look at, never the place	UNVERIFIED
L11 <i>Her foot of three at twenty degree,</i>	Three forks of the Popo Agie (North, Middle, Little)	Foot of three; run 20° from their junction near Lander	FAN ANALYSIS
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Wind River granite, upper Sinks Canyon	Precambrian granite cliffs in Shoshone NF; off-trail faces within a mile of the road	REPORTED
L19 <i>Like a river's steady flow—</i>	The Popo Agie	A river that literally goes away and comes back	FAN ANALYSIS

EVIDENCE

CONFIRMED Sinks and Rise verified: river underground about a quarter mile and two hours; fishing prohibited at the Rise and down to the bridge; no day-use fee reported; leashed dogs allowed; upper canyon is Shoshone NF.

Wyoming State Parks / Shoshone NF, verified

REPORTED Fenn footprint list per Treasure Among Us: Madison Junction, Nine Mile Hole, Hebgen Lake, Yellowstone, Sinks Canyon, Grand Teton, San Juans.
Treasure Among Us (secondary; verify in the book)

REPORTED Posey: walking distance from 'waters' silent flight' through 'round the bend, past the Hole'.
MW Q&A compilation

REPORTED Posey: the Hole has no man-made implication.
Seekers Summit

REPORTED The disclaimer invokes Wyoming law; Fenn's chest was found in Wyoming; Posey searched within 75 miles of his own hide (walked back).
Book disclaimer; Seekers Summit

FAN ANALYSIS Rule 42 'below a mile high' would fail this site at 6,100 ft.
r/beyondthemapledge

AGAINST IT

- Stanza 3 has no pin. 'His realm', 'his bride' and 'ancient gates' are all candidates, none argued to the point of a verdict.
- No bear name in the canyon; the nearest is Bears Ears peak, deep in the Winds.
- The Sinks is a cavern. The rules bar the TREASURE from caves, not a clue; but a searcher who reads 'past the Hole' as 'go into the Hole' is walking into a rule violation.
- The Fenn-footprint claim is secondary. If the book's list does not contain Sinks Canyon, the 75-mile support collapses to nothing.
- The Sinks Canyon State Park segment may carry a non-resident day fee. The NF reach above it is free either way.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT

The book's Treasure Trail list not naming Sinks Canyon AND no bear, star or bearing that brings the stanza 3 construction back into the canyon; or the upper-canyon granite proving to be all trail.

CHEAPEST TESTS, IN ORDER

1. Open the book's Treasure Trail list and confirm or strike Sinks Canyon. Fifteen minutes; changes the rank.
2. From the Rise, and from the three-forks junction near Lander, run 20° and 200° on the quad; note what each line crosses within a mile of Sinks Canyon Road.
3. Map off-trail granite faces in the upper canyon above the state park boundary, within a mile of the road.
4. Check Sinks Canyon State Park fees and hours; confirm the NF boundary on the ground.

STILL OPEN

Who is 'he'? · Which gates? · Is the checkpoint the Rise itself (something already there and something he placed)?

THE GATE

✓ Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling

✓ On publicly accessible land, not private property

✓ Not associated with man-made buildings; not near graves

✓ No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed

✓ No high-clearance vehicle needed

✓ Access free and available 24/7

✓ You can bring your dog – so not a no-dogs park trail

· Not near any man-made trail – 'a little ways off'

✓ Not at railroad tracks

✓ Within about a mile of the car to identify the spot

· Below about a mile high? (soft – check his exact words)

✓ Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe

✓ Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find

✓ Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication

✓ The Hole carries no man-made implication

✓ Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4

· Bride is visible, not alive, and follows from understanding the gates

· 'Return her face' technically implies a physical rotation

✓ Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft)

· Something must be manipulated to see it; a flashlight may help

3

Jackson Hole — Granite Creek / the Tetons' foot (Wyoming)

77

ENGINE SCORE
13✓ 0× 7 OPEN

WY · Teton County, Bridger-Teton NF / Hoback · 43.3598, -110.4416 (Granite Hot Springs) · ≈ 6,900 ft

The proper-noun Hole Posey was asked about by name, granite by name and by rock, and a 'him' and a 'her' facing each other across the valley. Ranked third because the poem's order fights the geography.

THE CASE

Jackson Hole is the Hole the 'on the nose' question named. Granite Hot Springs surges hot and clear up Granite Creek; the creek walks down to the Hoback and the Snake, serious fishing water. The Sleeping Indian (Sheep Mountain) lies on his back along the EAST edge of the Hole, a 'he' who is alive or not depending on your perspective, exactly Posey's phrasing. The Tetons, French 'the three breasts', are 'her' and 'three' in one name, and their foot is the valley floor. Run 20° from her foot and return it. Site must be outside Grand Teton National Park (fee, no dogs): Bridger-Teton NF is free.

ROUTE THROUGH THE POEM

LINE	PLACE	READING	TIER
L05 <i>As hope surges, clear and bright,</i>	Granite Hot Springs	Hot water surges up Granite Creek; the creek below the pool is free	FAN ANALYSIS
L06 <i>Walk near waters' silent flight.</i>	Granite Creek → Hoback River	Walk near the creek down to the Hoback	FAN ANALYSIS
L07 <i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	Jackson Hole	The proper-noun natural Hole; named in the 'on the nose' question	REPORTED
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Hoback / Snake fly water	Blue-ribbon water at walking distance	FAN ANALYSIS
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Sleeping Indian (Sheep Mountain), east rim	A 'he' lying on his back, obvious from the west; alive or not by perspective. No bear name	REPORTED
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	The Tetons over the valley	'Her' by name; the gates = the Hoback and Snake canyons the trappers came through (fan)	FAN ANALYSIS
L11 <i>Her foot of three at twenty degree,</i>	Foot of the three Tetons	Grand, Middle, South; their foot is the valley floor; run 20°	FAN ANALYSIS
L12 <i>Return her face to find the place.</i>	Reverse 200° from the Tetons' foot	Back toward the Hoback / Granite Creek side	UNVERIFIED
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Granite Creek granite	Granite by name; Gros Ventre outcrops; no arcs identified	UNVERIFIED

EVIDENCE

REPORTED Posey punted on whether the Hole corresponds to a place with 'hole' in its name (Jackson Hole, Big Hole River): 'an on the nose question.'

Seekers Summit

CONFIRMED Sleeping Indian verified: Sheep Mountain, Gros Ventre Range, a chief on his back, on the east edge of the Hole. Verified Sep 2026

REPORTED Posey on 'he': 'That depends on your perspective.' On the bride: visible, not alive.

Seekers Summit

REPORTED Grand Teton is in Posey's reported Fenn footprint; Fenn's chest was found in Wyoming. Treasure Among Us; Fenn 2020

CONFIRMED Dogs are barred from trails in Grand Teton NP and the park charges a fee; national forest allows both. The site cannot be in the park.

Official FAQ + NPS rules

CIRCULATING 'Ursa east' anagram 'use a star' (circulating) would replace the missing bear with a bearing from Polaris.

MW Discord

AGAINST IT

- Order. The surge (Granite Hot Springs) sits about 18 air miles south-east of Jackson, up the Hoback; the poem reaches the Hole in line 7 and the surge in line 5. The route only works if 'past the Hole' means leaving the valley, not entering it.
- Granite Hot Springs is a fee pool with a seasonal road; only the creek below it is free. Winter access is by snowmobile.
- No bear anywhere. Sheep Mountain is named for bighorn sheep.
- It is heavily visited Fenn country: 'not near any trail, so it wouldn't be stumbled upon' is hard to satisfy within a mile of a road here.
- Thermopolis is the near alternate if the bride must be named: the Wedding of the Waters stands at the mouth of Wind River Canyon, with Precambrian granite at the north end. It loses on the Hole (none on the approach) and on 'ursa'.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT

Confirmation that the clues run in geographic order at walking distances (surge before Hole kills it); or 'return her face' producing nothing within a mile of a road on the 200° line.

CHEAPEST TESTS, IN ORDER

1. Run 20° and 200° from the foot of the Grand Teton and from the Sleeping Indian's head; list what falls on NF land within a mile of a road.
2. Check the Granite Creek Road season and the hot-springs fee boundary; confirm the creek below the pool is free and dog-legal.
3. Look for any bear-named feature on the east rim of the Hole (Gros Ventre, Sheep Mountain area).
4. Decide the order question with Posey's words: 'walking distance from silent flight through past the Hole' cannot span the 18 miles from the hot springs to the valley.

STILL OPEN

Where is 'ursa'? · Are the gates the Hoback canyon, the Snake River canyon or Teton Pass? · Any double arcs on Granite Creek granite?

THE GATE

✓ Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling

✓ On publicly accessible land, not private property

✓ Not associated with man-made buildings; not near graves

✓ No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed

· No high-clearance vehicle needed

✓ Access free and available 24/7

✓ You can bring your dog – so not a no-dogs park trail

· Not near any man-made trail – 'a little ways off'

✓ Not at railroad tracks

· Within about a mile of the car to identify the spot

· Below about a mile high? (soft – check his exact words)

✓ Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe

✓ Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find

✓ Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication

✓ The Hole carries no man-made implication

✓ Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4

· Bride is visible, not alive, and follows from understanding the gates

· 'Return her face' technically implies a physical rotation

✓ Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft)

· Something must be manipulated to see it; a flashlight may help

SIDE BY SIDE

	1. WISDOM RIVER CORRIDOR	2. SINKS CANYON → WIND RIVER FRONT	3. JACKSON HOLE
Stanza 2 placed	3 of 4 (no surge)	4 of 4, in order, on foot	4 of 4, but order fights geography
Stanza 3 placed	Realm, bride, three: all argued, none pinned	Nothing pinned	'He' and 'her' verified, gates open
Stanza 4 granite	Pioneer and Tobacco Root batholiths, no arcs	Wind River granite in NF, no arcs	Granite Creek, no arcs
Book support	Strongest: nine named places	None known	None known
Posey's history	Grandfather's Montana; Dillon signing	Reported Fenn-search site (verify)	Reported Fenn-search site (verify)
Clue-to-clue distance	Tens of miles: map construction only	Under a mile for stanza 2	18 miles surge to Hole
Elevation vs 'below a mile' (fan)	6,060 ft at Wisdom; 4,600 at Twin Bridges	6,100 ft: fails if confirmed	6,900 ft: fails if confirmed
Crowd exposure	Highest; 'within 200 ft of the checkpoint' likely here	Low	High (Fenn country)
Engine score	97	91	77

WHERE THE MOAB SOLVE STANDS

The Moab / La Sal solve (Matrimony Spring → Potash Road → Jeep Arch → Castle Valley) does not make the three. It is not dead on any single confirmed rule, but it needs three reported statements read against their plain sense at once: the Hole as a culvert (Posey: no man-made implication), 'ursa east' as a heading (Posey: Ursa East is a thing with no west version), and 'granite bold' in country with no granite. Sister Superior fixed the bride and broke the sequence. Keep it archived, not deleted.

WHAT I DO NOT KNOW

- I have not seen the book's Treasure Trail list. The claim that Sinks Canyon and Grand Teton were Posey's own Fenn-search locations is reported through Treasure Among Us and is not verified.
- I cannot check current fee status or hours for Crystal Park, Sinks Canyon State Park or the Granite Hot Springs road from here; those are flagged as tests.
- The 'below a mile high' rule is fan analysis from the Lewis Carroll quote. All three top sites are above 5,280 ft except Twin Bridges. If that rule is ever confirmed, ranks 2 and 3 fall and rank 1 moves to its Twin Bridges end.
- No candidate in the store places 'double arcs' on a specific granite feature with any confidence. Stanza 4

is unsolved everywhere; every rank above is a stanza
1–3 ranking.

4

SOLVE ROSTER — EVERY CANDIDATE, RANKED

Standing solves first, then those ruled out. Each entry shows its case, what would kill it, the cheapest test, gate results and its route through the poem.

1

TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor — Big Hole → Beaverhead → Twin Bridges (SW Montana)

MT · Beaverhead / Madison counties · 45.6166, -113.4536 (Wisdom) → 45.5461, -112.3320 (Twin Bridges) · 6,060 ft at Wisdom · 4,600 ft at Twin Bridges

chain 40 (12 slots) poem 9 (3 fit · 0 fail) gate +18 (12✓ 0× 8 open) evidence 30 (93 facts mention it)

97

STANDING

CASE TOP-3 VERDICT (Sep 6 2026): Most evidence, least finished. The only region where the poem's own words (Wisdom, Hole, three, river) and Posey's own life (grandfather's Montana, the Dillon signing, the book's gazetteer) land on the same forty miles. — Lewis named the Big Hole the Wisdom River in August 1805; trappers renamed it for the 'hole' (their word for a mountain valley) it drains. So 'Wisdom waits in shadowed sight' and 'past the Hole' are one river under two names, and the book's map, drawn in a deliberately old style, is the shadowed sight that keeps the old name. The river runs out of its Hole to Twin Bridges, where Lewis's three virtues (Wisdom, Philanthropy, Philosophy) make the Jefferson: a literal 'foot of three'. Beaverhead Rock, the landmark Sacagawea recognised as home, stands twelve miles up the Beaverhead as a bride that is visible, not alive, and 'follows from the gates' if the gates are the ancient Beaverhead passage the Corps walked. Granite is on both sides: the Pioneer batholith west (Crystal Park, the book's 'wet granite') and the Tobacco Root batholith east.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT Any Posey answer that the Hole is not a place name; a bride confirmed outside the Beaverhead; or a checkpoint statement that puts stanza 2 and stanza 3 within walking distance of each other (this corridor cannot do that).

CHEAPEST TEST Read 'The Mountain Memory' and the chapter that introduces Tucker. If the brook is named, work it; if it is withheld, note that (1 of 5). From the Twin Bridges confluence and from Beaverhead Rock, run 20° and 200° on the quad. List every granite outcrop within a mile of a road that the lines cross (2 of 5). Check Crystal Park's day-use fee and hours against 'free, 24/7'. If it charges, strike it as a site (3 of 5). Measure 'walking distance' from a candidate surge to the first bend past the Hole; anything over three miles fails the reported constraint (4 of 5). Ask the September Featured Question: 'Is the Hole a body of water?' It is specific without being on the nose (5 of 5).

GATE **Passes:** Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4; Not associated with man-made buildings; not near graves; Bride is visible, not alive, and follows from understanding the gates; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; The Hole carries no man-made implication; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe; No high-clearance vehicle needed.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L01 <i>Can you find what lives in time,</i>	The river	What lives in time is the river; stanza 1 is the frame, and 5:4 says you already had it	1	unjudged
L02 <i>Flowing through each measured rhyme?</i>	Word count	'Hole' is the poem's 42nd word (verified by count); 42 is confirmed relevant by Posey (reported)	3	unjudged
L03 <i>Wisdom waits in shadowed sight—</i>	Wisdom River = Big Hole River; the town of Wisdom	Lewis's 1805 name, kept only by the town and by old maps: hidden in plain sight	2	✓ fits
L06 <i>Walk near waters' silent flight.</i>	Upper Big Hole, Land of 10,000 Haystacks	Slow silent meanders; the Netflix 'needle in a football field' points here (fan)	2	unjudged

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L07 <i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	Big Hole River / Big Hole valley	Natural, proper-noun Hole. Posey: no man-made implication (reported); hole-named place = 'on the nose' (reported); community calls this line solved (circulating)	3	✓ fits
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Big Hole blue-ribbon water	The book's fishing chapters; alt: 'pole' = pole star, fixing north before 3:1 (fan)	2	unjudged
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Polaris, MT / the East Pioneers	Polaris is the pole star in Ursa Minor and a town the book names outright; East Pioneers give an 'east' half of one range	2	unjudged
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	Beaverhead Rock over the Beaverhead passage	Visible-only, not alive (state park: view from a distance). Gates = the ancient route up the Beaverhead to Lemhi Pass; alt bride site: Sacajawea Memorial at Lemhi Pass	1	unjudged
L11 <i>Her foot of three at twenty degree,</i>	Twin Bridges — three forks make the Jefferson	Wisdom, Philanthropy, Philosophy (verified history). Run 20° from the confluence	1	✓ fits
L12 <i>Return her face to find the place.</i>	Back-bearing 200° / Sacagawea's return	Reverse the 20° line from her foot; or her literal return home over Lemhi. Rotation is 'technically' implied (reported)	1	unjudged
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Pioneer batholith (Crystal Park) or Tobacco Root granite	Book: 'smell of pine and wet granite' at Crystal Park. No arcs identified	1	unjudged
L19 <i>Like a river's steady flow—</i>	The Big Hole / Jefferson	A river's steady flow — the through-line	1	unjudged

2

TOP 2 · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front (Lander, Wyoming)

WY · Fremont County, Sinks Canyon SP / Shoshone NF · 42.7397, -108.8187 (the Rise) · ≈ 6,100 ft

91

STANDING

chain 34 (7 slots) poem 12 (4 fit · 0 fail) gate +22.5 (15✓ 0× 5 open) evidence 22.5 (15 facts mention it)

CASE

TOP-3 VERDICT (Sep 6 2026): The cleanest stanza 2 in the store: four lines in order, on foot, in under a mile, with a natural capital-H Hole. Ranked second only because stanza 3 is unpinned. — The Middle Fork of the Popo Agie vanishes into a limestone cavern (the Sinks) and surges back up a quarter mile down-canyon at the Rise, a clear pool of huge trout where fishing is banned. Walk the poem: hope surges clear and bright (the Rise) → walk near the water's silent flight (the river running unseen underground) → round the bend, past the Hole (the canyon road bends at the Sinks) → cast your pole where fishing is allowed again above the cavern in Shoshone National Forest. The upper canyon is Wind River granite. Reported through Treasure Among Us, Sinks Canyon was itself one of Posey's Fenn-search locations, which would satisfy the 75-mile remark at zero miles.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT

The book's Treasure Trail list not naming Sinks Canyon AND no bear, star or bearing that brings the stanza 3 construction back into the canyon; or the upper-canyon granite proving to be all trail.

CHEAPEST TEST

Open the book's Treasure Trail list and confirm or strike Sinks Canyon. Fifteen minutes; changes the rank (1 of 4). From the Rise, and from the three-forks junction near Lander, run 20° and 200° on the quad; note what each line crosses within a mile of Sinks Canyon Road (2 of 4). Map off-trail granite faces in the upper canyon above the state park boundary, within a mile of the road (3 of 4). Check Sinks Canyon State Park fees and hours; confirm the NF boundary on the ground (4 of 4).

GATE **Passes:** Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4; Not associated with man-made buildings; not near graves; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft); Access free and available 24/7; The Hole carries no man-made implication; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Within about a mile of the car to identify the spot; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; Not at railroad tracks; No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe; No high-clearance vehicle needed.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L05 <i>As hope surges, clear and bright,</i>	The Rise of the Sinks	Spring surges up clear from the rock; giant trout; no fishing	3	✓ fits
L06 <i>Walk near waters' silent flight.</i>	Popo Agie underground, Sinks → Rise	A quarter mile of silent, unseen flow; about two hours underground	3	✓ fits
L07 <i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	The Sinks	A natural capital-H Hole the river disappears into; the canyon road bends at it	3	✓ fits
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Popo Agie above the Sinks	Fishing is banned from the Rise to the road bridge; cast your pole above, in the national forest	3	✓ fits
L11 <i>Her foot of three at twenty degree,</i>	Three forks of the Popo Agie (North, Middle, Little)	Foot of three; run 20° from their junction near Lander	1	unjudged
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Wind River granite, upper Sinks Canyon	Precambrian granite cliffs in Shoshone NF; off-trail faces within a mile of the road	3	unjudged
L19 <i>Like a river's steady flow—</i>	The Popo Agie	A river that literally goes away and comes back	1	unjudged

3 Wisdom / Big Hole / Beaverhead Rock — SW Montana cluster (dominant theory)

88
STANDING

MT · Beaverhead County · ≈ 45.62, -113.45 (verify) · ≈ 6,000 ft

chain 26 (7 slots) poem 21 (7 fit · 0 fail) gate +18 (12✓ 0× 8 open) evidence 22.5 (27 facts mention it)

CASE Community cluster: Polaris MT (realm), Beaverhead Rock (bride), Pioneer Byway (gates), Big Hole River (Hole), Wisdom MT ('Wisdom waits'). Inside Fenn's map; Posey's Dillon signing is nearby. Not walked. VERIFIED: the Big Hole River was Lewis's 'Wisdom River' (1805) — 1:3 and 2:3 are one river. HUB: the book names Polaris, Crystal Park, Wisdom (Grasshopper Valley chapter), Bannack, Blacktail Deer Creek, Clark Canyon Reservoir and Red Rock River — Dillon as hub, 'grandfather's territory'. Sep 12 2026: Posey meet-and-greet in Polaris (event, not a clue).

WHAT WOULD KILL IT Big Hole National Battlefield is 'near graves'; a Beaverhead Rock bride puts the gates 40 miles from the Hole. And it is the crowd's solve — 'within two miles' means the crowd has been there.

CHEAPEST TEST Draw the route Wisdom → Big Hole → Polaris → Beaverhead Rock and measure it against 'not a great distance'.

GATE **Passes:** Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4; Bride is visible, not alive, and follows from understanding the gates; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7; The Hole carries no man-made implication; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe; No high-clearance vehicle needed.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L02 <i>Flowing through each measured rhyme?</i>	Wisdom (Big Hole) River 45.62, -113.45	The river that flows through the stanzas: Lewis's Wisdom River is the Big Hole	1	✓ fits
L03 <i>Wisdom waits in shadowed sight—</i>	Wisdom, MT 45.6166, -113.4536	A town named Wisdom on the Wisdom River — the book names it	3	✓ fits
L07 <i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	Big Hole River / Big Hole valley 45.62, -113.45	The Hole is the Big Hole; the river rounds the bend at Wisdom	2	✓ fits
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Big Hole River blue-ribbon water 45.70, -113.30	Fly-fishing river of the book's Dillon chapters	2	unjudged
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Polaris, MT 45.3660, -113.1220	North star = Ursa Minor; 'his realm' east of the Divide	2	✓ fits
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	Beaverhead Rock 45.4267, -112.4563	Sacagawea's landmark: a bride not alive but visible	2	✓ fits
L19 <i>Like a river's steady flow —</i>	Big Hole River 45.62, -113.45	A river's steady flow	1	✓ fits

4

Sinks Canyon → Wind River front (Lander, WY)

84

WY · Fremont County, Sinks Canyon SP / Shoshone NF · ≈ 42.74, -108.83 (the Rise; verify) · ≈ STANDING 6,100 ft

chain 28 (7 slots) poem 15 (5 fit · 0 fail) gate +18 (12✓ 0× 8 open) evidence 22.5 (15 facts mention it)

CASE Stanza 2 in order and at walking distance: the Rise (surge, clear, giant trout, no fishing) → the river underground (silent flight) → the Sinks (natural capital-H Hole) → cast your pole above it. Upper canyon is Wind River granite in national forest. Free, dogs, Wyoming law. Stanza 3 candidates within 30 miles: Chief Washakie's reservation ('his realm'), Sacagawea's statue and grave at Fort Washakie ('his bride', not alive, visible), Bears Ears peak in the Winds, the Popo Agie's three forks. Nothing in stanza 3 is pinned yet. HUB/TAU: Sinks Canyon is listed among Posey's own Fenn-search locations — the 75-mile gate is met at zero miles (source is secondary; verify in the book's Treasure Trail list).

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No bear, star or bearing that lands the construction back in the canyon; or the granite reach being all trail.

CHEAPEST TEST From the Rise, run 20° and 200°: what do the lines cross within a mile of a road? Is there off-trail granite in the upper canyon with a carvable face? Did Posey ever search the Winds for Fenn?

GATE **Passes:** Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft); Access free and available 24/7; The Hole carries no man-made implication; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe; No high-clearance vehicle needed.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L05 <i>As hope surges, clear and bright,</i>	The Rise of the Sinks 42.7397, -108.8187	Spring surges up clear from the rock; giant trout, no fishing allowed	3	✓ fits

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L06 <i>Walk near waters' silent flight.</i>	Popo Agie underground, Sinks → Rise 42.735, -108.83	The river runs a quarter mile underground in silence and takes two hours to emerge	3	✓ fits
L07 <i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	The Sinks, Sinks Canyon 42.7315, -108.8357	Capital-H natural Hole where the river vanishes; the canyon road bends right at it	2	✓ fits
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Popo Agie above the Sinks 42.72, -108.85	Public fishing water in Shoshone NF above the cavern	2	✓ fits
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Wind River Reservation, east of the Winds 43.00, -108.90	Chief Washakie's realm; 'his' whose living is a matter of perspective	1	unjudged
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	Sacagawea's grave, Fort Washakie 43.0057, -108.9022	A bride, not alive, visible as a statue at the cemetery gates	1	unjudged
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Wind River granite, upper Sinks Canyon 42.72, -108.85	Precambrian granite cliffs in Shoshone NF; carvable faces off the trail	2	✓ fits

5 Thermopolis — Wind River Canyon / Wedding of the Waters (WY)

84

WY · Hot Springs County, Hot Springs SP / BLM canyon · ≈ 43.61, -108.21 (Wedding of the Waters; verify) · ≈ 4,400 ft

STANDING

chain 28 (7 slots) poem 18 (6 fit · 0 fail) gate +15 (10✓ 0× 10 open) evidence 22.5 (48 facts mention it)

CASE Big Spring (surges, free, 24/7) → Bighorn River through the Owl Creek Mountains (silent flight) → Wedding of the Waters at the canyon mouth (his bride at ancient gates, both named) → Precambrian granite, three tunnel arcs, bighorn horns. Named fishing access. Below a mile high. Wyoming. VERIFIED: park hours 6–10, so the site is canyon-side or at the Wedding of the Waters access, not in the park. Tunnel 3 is in Precambrian granite; old dam abutments beside it.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No natural Hole on the approach, and no bear — if 'ursa' is a place name rather than a bearing, this has none.

CHEAPEST TEST Walk the map from Big Spring south: is there a named natural Hole between the spring and the canyon mouth? Is the north-end granite carvable and off-trail, outside the tunnels?

GATE **Passes:** Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4; Bride is visible, not alive, and follows from understanding the gates; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe; No high-clearance vehicle needed.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L05 <i>As hope surges, clear and bright,</i>	Big Spring, Hot Springs State Park 43.6533, -108.1990	3.6 million gal/day surge, clear, 24/7 free bathhouse	3	✓ fits
L06 <i>Walk near waters' silent flight.</i>	Bighorn River south toward Wind River Canyon 43.60, -108.20	Flat water walking the riverbank south from the park	2	✓ fits
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Wedding of the Waters fishing access 43.5963, -108.2085	Named public fishing access where the Wind becomes the Bighorn	2	✓ fits

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Owl Creek Mountains / reservation south of the canyon 43.50, -108.20	The canyon cuts through the Owl Creeks; reservation land is 'his realm'	1	unjudged
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	Wedding of the Waters at the canyon mouth 43.5963, -108.2085	The bride stands at the ancient gates: a named wedding at the gates of a 2.9-billion-year canyon	2	✓ fits
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Precambrian granite at the canyon's north end (Tunnel 3) 43.58, -108.21	Granite by the tunnels and old dam abutments; canyon-side, outside the park	2	✓ fits
L15 <i>Beyond the reach of time's swift race,</i>	Wind River Canyon geologic signs 43.55, -108.20	Road signs count back through 2.9 billion years: 'beyond the reach of time'	2	✓ fits

6

Granite Creek / Jackson Hole — Tetons (Wyoming)

WY · Teton County, Bridger-Teton NF / Hoback · ≈ 43.36, -110.44 (Granite Hot Springs; verify) · ≈ 6,900 ft

81

STANDING

chain 24 (7 slots) poem 21 (7 fit · 0 fail) gate +13.5 (9✓ 0× 11 open) evidence 22.5 (28 facts mention it)

CASE Capital-H proper-noun natural Hole that Posey called on the nose; surge (Granite Hot Springs), water (Granite Creek / Hoback), serious fishing, granite by name and rock. Cross-reference adds the Tetons as 'her' and 'three'. Inside Fenn's map, Wyoming law in the disclaimer, Fenn country. Site must sit outside Grand Teton NP (fee) — Bridger-Teton NF is free. VERIFIED: the Sleeping Indian (a 'he', alive or not by perspective) is the east edge of the Hole; the Tetons ('her', three) the west. TAU: Grand Teton is in his Fenn footprint.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No bear or star east of the Hole for 'ursa east', or 'return her face' producing nothing near the Tetons' foot.

CHEAPEST TEST Bear or star east of the Hole; run 20°/200° from the Tetons' foot; check Teton Canyon (ID) for off-trail granite within a mile of the road.

GATE **Passes:** Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft); The Hole carries no man-made implication; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L05 <i>As hope surges, clear and bright,</i>	Granite Hot Springs 43.3598, -110.4416	Hot water surges up Granite Creek; free below the pool	2	✓ fits
L06 <i>Walk near waters' silent flight.</i>	Granite Creek → Hoback River 43.33, -110.45	Walk near the creek down to the Hoback	2	✓ fits
L07 <i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	Jackson Hole 43.48, -110.76	Proper-noun natural Hole that Posey called on the nose	3	✓ fits
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Snake / Hoback fly water 43.28, -110.70	Serious fishing water at walking distance	2	✓ fits

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Sleeping Indian (Sheep Mountain), east edge of the Hole 43.55, -110.55	A 'he' alive or not by perspective, on the east rim	1	✓ fits
L11 <i>Her foot of three at twenty degree,</i>	The Tetons (Trois Tétos) — three 43.74, -110.80	Her foot of three: the base of the three Tetons; run 20° from it	1	✓ fits
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Granite Creek granite / Gros Ventre outcrops 43.36, -110.44	Granite by name and by rock	1	✓ fits

7

Twin Bridges — Big Hole / Beaverhead / Ruby → Jefferson (MT)

78

MT · Madison County, Twin Bridges / Beaverhead Rock · ≈ 45.55, -112.33 (verify) · ≈ 4,600 ft STANDING

chain 22 (7 slots) poem 18 (6 fit · 0 fail) gate +15 (10✓ 0× 10 open) evidence 22.5 (60 facts mention it)

CASE Where the Wisdom River (Big Hole) ends: three rivers — Lewis's Wisdom, Philanthropy, Philosophy — make the Jefferson. Beaverhead Rock (Sacagawea's landmark, visible-only) 12 mi up the Beaverhead. Tobacco Root granite batholith to the east. Below a mile; free fishing access; dogs. Built from the MW 'round the bend' reading plus the 1805 names.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No bear and no double arcs within a mile of a road; or Beaverhead Rock being the wrong bride (someone has identified her — is it this?).

CHEAPEST TEST From the Twin Bridges confluence run 20° and 200°; list granite outcrops in the Tobacco Roots within a mile of a road; check what sits east of Beaverhead Rock.

GATE **Passes:** Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4; Bride is visible, not alive, and follows from understanding the gates; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7; The Hole carries no man-made implication; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; On publicly accessible land, not private property; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe; No high-clearance vehicle needed.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L03 <i>Wisdom waits in shadowed sight—</i>	Wisdom River (Big Hole), Lewis's 1805 name 45.55, -112.33	Wisdom waits at the river's end	2	✓ fits
L07 <i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	Big Hole bends into the Jefferson at Twin Bridges 45.5461, -112.3320	Round the bend where the Big Hole ends	2	✓ fits
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Jefferson / Big Hole confluence fishing access 45.5461, -112.3320	Free FAS with fly water	2	✓ fits
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	Beaverhead Rock 45.4267, -112.4563	Sacagawea's landmark, 12 mi up the Beaverhead; visible-only	2	✓ fits
L11 <i>Her foot of three at twenty degree,</i>	Three rivers make the Jefferson 45.55, -112.33	Foot of three: Wisdom, Philanthropy (Ruby), Philosophy (Beaverhead) at her feet	1	✓ fits
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Tobacco Root granite batholith 45.55, -112.10	Granite outcrops east of the valley	1	unjudged

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L19 <i>Like a river's steady flow—</i>	Jefferson River 45.55, -112.33	A river's steady flow	1	✓ fits

8 TOP 3 · Jackson Hole — Granite Creek / the Tetons' foot (Wyoming) 77

WY · Teton County, Bridger-Teton NF / Hoback · 43.3598, -110.4416 (Granite Hot Springs) · ≈ STANDING 6,900 ft

chain 26 (9 slots) poem 6 (2 fit · 0 fail) gate +19.5 (13✓ 0× 7 open) evidence 25.5 (32 facts mention it)

CASE TOP-3 VERDICT (Sep 6 2026): The proper-noun Hole Posey was asked about by name, granite by name and by rock, and a 'him' and a 'her' facing each other across the valley. Ranked third because the poem's order fights the geography. — Jackson Hole is the Hole the 'on the nose' question named. Granite Hot Springs surges hot and clear up Granite Creek; the creek walks down to the Hoback and the Snake, serious fishing water. The Sleeping Indian (Sheep Mountain) lies on his back along the EAST edge of the Hole, a 'he' who is alive or not depending on your perspective, exactly Posey's phrasing. The Tetons, French 'the three breasts', are 'her' and 'three' in one name, and their foot is the valley floor. Run 20° from her foot and return it. Site must be outside Grand Teton National Park (fee, no dogs): Bridger-Teton NF is free.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT Confirmation that the clues run in geographic order at walking distances (surge before Hole kills it); or 'return her face' producing nothing within a mile of a road on the 200° line.

CHEAPEST TEST Run 20° and 200° from the foot of the Grand Teton and from the Sleeping Indian's head; list what falls on NF land within a mile of a road (1 of 4). Check the Granite Creek Road season and the hot-springs fee boundary; confirm the creek below the pool is free and dog-legal (2 of 4). Look for any bear-named feature on the east rim of the Hole (Gros Ventre, Sheep Mountain area) (3 of 4). Decide the order question with Posey's words: 'walking distance from silent flight through past the Hole' cannot span the 18 miles from the hot springs to the valley (4 of 4).

GATE **Passes:** Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4; Not associated with man-made buildings; not near graves; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft); Access free and available 24/7; The Hole carries no man-made implication; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; Not at railroad tracks; No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L05 <i>As hope surges, clear and bright,</i>	Granite Hot Springs	Hot water surges up Granite Creek; the creek below the pool is free	1	unjudged
L06 <i>Walk near waters' silent flight.</i>	Granite Creek → Hoback River	Walk near the creek down to the Hoback	1	unjudged
L07 <i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	Jackson Hole	The proper-noun natural Hole; named in the 'on the nose' question	3	✓ fits
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Hoback / Snake fly water	Blue-ribbon water at walking distance	1	unjudged
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Sleeping Indian (Sheep Mountain), east rim	A 'he' lying on his back, obvious from the west; alive or not by perspective. No bear name	3	✓ fits
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	The Tetons over the valley	'Her' by name; the gates = the Hoback and Snake canyons the trappers came through (fan)	1	unjudged

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L11 <i>Her foot of three at twenty degree,</i>	Foot of the three Tetons	Grand, Middle, South; their foot is the valley floor; run 20°	1	unjudged
L12 <i>Return her face to find the place.</i>	Reverse 200° from the Tetons' foot	Back toward the Hoback / Granite Creek side	1	unjudged
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Granite Creek granite	Granite by name; Gros Ventre outcrops; no arcs identified	1	unjudged

9

Pioneer Mountains — Polaris / Elkhorn / Crystal Park (Montana)

MT · Beaverhead County, Beaverhead-Deerlodge NF · ≈ 45.42, -113.10 (Crystal Park; verify) · ≈ 7,800 ft

75

STANDING

chain 22 (6 slots) poem 18 (6 fit · 0 fail) gate +13.5 (9/ 0× 11 open) evidence 21 (48 facts mention it)

CASE The Wisdom theory routed through Polaris: Elkhorn Hot Springs surge, Polaris for ursa/north star, Big Hole for Hole and fishing, granitic Pioneers, Crystal Park free public dig. Inside Fenn's map. Heavily searched; 'within two miles' cuts both ways. Bride is the gap — Beaverhead Rock is ~40 mi off. HUB: the book names Polaris, Crystal Park, Wisdom (Grasshopper Valley chapter), Bannack, Blacktail Deer Creek, Clark Canyon Reservoir and Red Rock River — Dillon as hub, 'grandfather's territory'. Sep 12 2026: Posey meet-and-greet in Polaris (event, not a clue).

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No bride or gates within the Pioneers; or Crystal Park / the Byway sitting inside the two-mile ring the crowd has already worked.

CHEAPEST TEST Check Crystal Park fee status and hours (must be free, 24/7); look for any 'Gate' or bride-shaped feature on the Pioneer Byway between Polaris and Elkhorn.

GATE **Passes:** Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; The Hole carries no man-made implication; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe; No high-clearance vehicle needed.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L03 <i>Wisdom waits in shadowed sight–</i>	Wisdom / Wisdom River 45.6166, -113.4536	Lewis's Wisdom River on the west side of the Pioneers	2	✓ fits
L05 <i>As hope surges, clear and bright,</i>	Elkhorn Hot Springs 45.4483, -113.1236	Hot springs surge on the Pioneer Byway	2	✓ fits
L07 <i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	Big Hole River at Wise River 45.79, -112.95	The Hole is the Big Hole; the byway leaves it at Wise River	2	✓ fits
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Big Hole fishing access 45.79, -112.95	Blue-ribbon water	1	✓ fits
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Polaris, MT 45.3660, -113.1220	North star = Ursa Minor; the 2026 meet-and- greet town	2	✓ fits

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Crystal Park / Pioneer batholith granite 45.487, -113.113	Granitic Pioneers; free public crystal dig	2	✓ fits

10

Sweetwater River — Devil's Gate / Split Rock / South Pass
(TreasureNet walkthrough)

75

STANDING

WY · Natrona / Fremont counties, Hwy 220 · ≈ 42.47, -107.73 (Split Rock; verify) · ≈ 6,300 ft

chain 18 (5 slots) poem 21 (7 fit · 0 fail) gate +16.5 (11✓ 0× 9 open) evidence 19.5 (13 facts mention it)

CASE The only rival that assigns every line. Devil's Gate = ancient gates, Split Rock = double arcs on literal granite, ends near South Pass. Inside Fenn's map. Not walked. VERIFIED: Independence Rock (granite, 5,000 carved names, free, dogs) is 5 mi from Devil's Gate — a better 4:1–4:2 than Split Rock, but beside a rest area.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No Hole assigned at all, and a bride that is 'the river and its landscape' — not something visible you could identify.

CHEAPEST TEST Is there a proper-noun Hole on the Sweetwater approach? Does anything at Devil's Gate read as a face?

GATE **Passes:** Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; 'Return her face' technically implies a physical rotation; No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe; No high-clearance vehicle needed.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Sweetwater River 42.47, -107.50	Fishing river along the emigrant trail	1	✓ fits
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	Devil's Gate 42.4467, -107.2131	The ancient gates: a 370-ft granite cleft on the Oregon Trail	3	✓ fits
L12 <i>Return her face to find the place.</i>	South Pass 42.35, -108.88	Return: turn west at the Divide	1	✓ fits
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Split Rock (or Independence Rock) 42.4762, -107.5661	Double arcs on literal Sherman-type granite	2	✓ fits
L14 <i>Where secrets of the past still hold.</i>	Independence Rock 42.4936, -107.1319	5,000 carved emigrant names — secrets of the past still hold	2	✓ fits

11

Gates of the Mountains — Sleeping Giant / Beartooth (Helena, MT)

68

STANDING

MT · Lewis and Clark County, Holter Lake / Helena NF · ≈ 46.84, -111.91 (Gates; verify) · ≈ 3,700 ft

chain 18 (5 slots) poem 17 (7 fit · 1 fail) gate +15 (10✓ 0× 10 open) evidence 18.3 (7 facts mention it)

CASE The most literal 'ancient gates' in the West beside a Beartooth Mountain that is the Sleeping Giant ('his', alive or not 'depends on perspective'). Missouri fly-fishing below Holter. Upstream: Three Forks (three), the Big Hole (Hole), Wisdom — one river from the crowd's stanza 1–2 to this stanza 3. Below a mile. Montana grandfather. VERIFIED: Beartooth = Sleeping Giant, head east. But the Gates are limestone — 4:1 fails literally.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No bride at the Gates; or the site falling within the Mann Gulch memorial ground (grave markers).

CHEAPEST TEST Name every feature at the Gates and on the Sleeping Giant — anything female, a face, a veil? Check Holter Lake BLM sites for day fees and dog rules.

GATE **Passes:** Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; The Hole carries no man-made implication; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe; No high-clearance vehicle needed.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L03 <i>Wisdom waits in shadowed sight—</i>	Wisdom River → Missouri, upstream 45.92, -111.50	One river from the crowd's stanza 1 to this stanza 3	1	✓ fits
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Missouri below Holter Dam 46.99, -112.01	Blue-ribbon fly water	2	✓ fits
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Sleeping Giant / Beartooth Mountain 46.83, -112.02	A bear's tooth for ursa; a sleeping 'he', alive by perspective, head east	2	✓ fits
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	Gates of the Mountains 46.8446, -111.9130	The most literal ancient gates in the West (Lewis, 1805)	3	✓ fits
L11 <i>Her foot of three at twenty degree,</i>	Three Forks, Missouri headwaters (upstream) 45.926, -111.507	Foot of three: where three rivers make the Missouri	1	✓ fits

12 Hole-in-the-Wall — Outlaw Canyon (Kaycee, WY)

59

WY · Johnson County, BLM Middle Fork Powder · ≈ 43.47, -106.98 (Outlaw Cave CG; verify) · ≈ STANDING 5,600 ft

chain 16 (5 slots) poem 11 (5 fit · 1 fail) gate +12 (8✓ 0× 12 open) evidence 19.5 (25 facts mention it)

CASE Capital-H natural Hole that is itself a gate; blue-ribbon Middle Fork; fee-free BLM; petroglyphs and cairn line; Butch Cassidy as the 'he' whose living is a matter of perspective. Sandstone, far from Fenn ground.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT Granite: there is none in the Red Wall. Fenn: 200 miles from anywhere he is known to have searched.

CHEAPEST TEST Is there a Bighorn granite outcrop within a mile of the Middle Fork road? Did Posey search the Bighorns?

GATE **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7; The Hole carries no man-made implication; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L07 <i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	Hole-in-the-Wall 43.47, -106.98	Capital-H natural Hole that is itself a gap in the red wall	3	✓ fits

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Middle Fork Powder River 43.47, -106.98	Blue-ribbon water below Outlaw Cave	2	✓ fits
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Outlaw Cave / Hole-in-the-Wall Gang 43.47, -106.98	Butch Cassidy's realm; alive by legend	1	✓ fits
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	The red-wall gap as gate	The Hole is the gate; no named bride	1	✓ fits
L14 <i>Where secrets of the past still hold.</i>	Outlaw Cave petroglyphs and cairn line	Secrets of the past still hold	1	✓ fits

13 City of Rocks — Twin Sisters (Idaho, 42nd parallel)

40

ID · Cassia County, City of Rocks National Reserve · ≈ 42.07, -113.72 (verify) · ≈ 6,000 ft STANDING

chain 10 (3 slots) poem 1 (3 fit · 2 fail) gate +12 (8✓ 0× 12 open) evidence 16.5 (18 facts mention it)

CASE Literal granite, paired Twin Sisters, natural arches, emigrant axle-grease signatures on Register Rock, 'gateway' on the California Trail, free access, easy parking. Stanza 4 is the strongest on the board; stanzas 2–3 have nothing to grip.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No bear, star or Hole anywhere in the approach — if stanza 2–3 cannot be assigned within ~30 miles, it's a stanza-4 look-alike.

CHEAPEST TEST Map search for any 'Bear', 'Polaris', 'Hole' or 'Gate' feature within 30 miles; check whether the Reserve is on the printed map.

GATE **Passes:** Access free and available 24/7; Within about a mile of the car to identify the spot; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe; No high-clearance vehicle needed.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	Register Rock, California Trail gateway 42.07, -113.72	Emigrant gateway; no bride	1	✓ fits
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Twin Sisters granite 42.0525, -113.7278	Paired granite spires with natural arches	2	✓ fits
L14 <i>Where secrets of the past still hold.</i>	Register Rock axle-grease signatures 42.07, -113.72	Emigrant names still hold	2	✓ fits

14 Beartooth Highway / Beartooth Butte (MT/WY)

27

MT/WY · Custer-Gallatin / Shoshone NF · ≈ 44.95, -109.60 (verify) · ≈ 10,000 ft STANDING

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 6 (2 fit · 0 fail) gate +9 (6✓ 0× 14 open) evidence 12 (8 facts mention it)

CASE A literal Beartooth for ursa, granite plateau, inside the Fenn ring; but 10,000 ft, fee-adjacent (Yellowstone NE entrance), no water line and no Hole. Sep 6 2026 case for the EASTERN Beartooths: bear-named range with a real east half; Granite Peak (state high point); ~3.96-billion-year rock; free NF, paved US-212. Against: no gates, no bride, no book support (book names SW Montana, 200 mi west).

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No stanza 2.

CHEAPEST TEST Any spring/Hole pair along the Clarks Fork below the plateau?

GATE **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft); Access free and available 24/7; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

No lines placed.

15 Lemhi Pass / Sacagawea's return (MT/ID)

MT/ID · Continental Divide, Salmon-Challis / Beaverhead-Deerlodge NF · ≈ 44.97, -113.44 (verify) · ≈ 7,373 ft

27

STANDING

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 6 (2 fit · 0 fail) gate +9 (6✓ 0× 14 open) evidence 12 (26 facts mention it)

CASE Free Forest Service Sacajawea Memorial Area 0.2 mi below the pass; gravel but passenger-car. She was taken at Three Forks and returned here to her brother Cameahwait. The Divide is the map's edge. A reading more than a spot.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No water line near the pass; no Hole; no granite feature.

CHEAPEST TEST Map the pass for granite outcrops and any feature named for a bear or gate.

GATE **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe; No high-clearance vehicle needed.

No lines placed.

16 Tres Piedras / Ojo Caliente (NM)

NM · Taos County, Carson NF · ≈ 36.65, -105.97 (verify) · ≈ 8,000 ft

23

STANDING

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 12 (4 fit · 0 fail) gate +9 (6✓ 0× 14 open) evidence 2.4 (2 facts mention it)

CASE Granitic gneiss crags on Carson NF (free), 24 mi north of Ojo Caliente, where Posey searched for Fenn; Rio Grande Gorge (silent water) and blue-ribbon fishing nearby; petroglyphs on the gorge. North of the Santa Fe cutoff.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No bride, no Hole.

CHEAPEST TEST Any feature named Hole or bride between Ojo Caliente and Tres Piedras; check the SW corner private land.

GATE **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft); Access free and available 24/7; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

No lines placed.

17 Bear Lodge / Devils Tower — NE Wyoming (ursa as proper name)

WY · Crook County, Bear Lodge Mountains / Black Hills NF · ≈ 44.59, -104.72 (Devils Tower; verify) · ≈ 5,100 ft (tower summit)

21

STANDING

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 3 (1 fit · 0 fail) gate +6 (4✓ 0× 16 open) evidence 12 (12 facts mention it)

CASE Lead to chase first: Bear (ursa) + Lodge (realm). Inside Fenn's map; Wyoming law in the site disclaimer. Not checked for a bride or gates. Site must sit outside the fee monument to satisfy free/24-7 and no-buildings. Rock is phonolite, not granite.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No bride and no gates in five minutes of looking; phonolite not granite; the monument is a fee unit with a visitor center.

CHEAPEST TEST Search the Bear Lodge Mountains for anything named Bride, Gate, or a face; check whether Posey searched the Black Hills for Fenn.

GATE **Passes:** Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

No lines placed.

18 Big Springs / Henry's Fork — Island Park (ID)

ID · Fremont County, Caribou-Targhee NF · ≈ 44.50 , -111.26 (verify) · $\approx 6,400$ ft

20
STANDING

chain **0** (0 slots) poem **9** (3 fit · 0 fail) gate **+9** (6✓ 0× 14 open) evidence **2.4** (2 facts mention it)

CASE 120M gal/day of crystal-clear 52°F water; fishing prohibited at the spring, blue-ribbon below; Upper/Lower Mesa Falls downstream (a double); free NF, dogs; inside Posey's Fenn ring; Idaho on the 42 thread.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No Hole and no bear within the Henry's Fork corridor.

CHEAPEST TEST Search the Henry's Fork from Big Springs to Ashton for any feature named Hole or Bear; check the Mesa Falls granite/rhyolite.

GATE **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft); Access free and available 24/7; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

No lines placed.

19 Torrey Lake petroglyphs — Dubois (WY)

WY · Fremont County, Whiskey Basin WHMA · ≈ 43.45 , -109.55 (verify) · $\approx 7,800$ ft

18
STANDING

chain **0** (0 slots) poem **2** (2 fit · 1 fail) gate **+6** (4✓ 0× 16 open) evidence **9.6** (6 facts mention it)

CASE 175 Dinwoody-style petroglyphs incl. bighorn sheep (double-arc horns) 9–13 mi SE of Dubois; Wind River fishing; Union Pass = the Divide. Verified sandstone, not granite; guided visits recommended.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT Sandstone.

CHEAPEST TEST Are any of the boulders granitic erratics rather than sandstone?

GATE **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

No lines placed.

20 Heron Lake — north star & lost pole (NM)

NM · Rio Arriba County, Heron Lake SP / Carson NF · ≈ 36.70 , -106.70 (verify) · $\approx 7,200$ ft

17
STANDING

chain **0** (0 slots) poem **6** (2 fit · 0 fail) gate **+7.5** (5✓ 0× 15 open) evidence **3.6** (3 facts mention it)

CASE The book's 'our north star' and the lost-pole story. North of the Santa Fe cutoff; Ojo Caliente (Posey's Fenn search) 25 mi south. Fee state park — site would be on adjacent NF/BLM. Reservoir (dam not on an old map).

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No Hole, bride or granite within reach; fee park; a reservoir.

CHEAPEST TEST Anything named Bear, Gate or Bride within 30 mi? Granite outcrops on Carson NF nearby?

GATE **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft); Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

No lines placed.

21 Ennis / Sphinx Mountain (MT)

MT · Madison County, Custer-Gallatin NF · ≈ 45.13 , -111.48 (verify) · $\approx 10,876$ ft

15
STANDING

chain **0** (0 slots) poem **6** (2 fit · 0 fail) gate **+9** (6✓ 0× 14 open) evidence **0** (0 facts mention it)

CASE The Sphinx — a named face in the Madison Range — and the Helmet beside it; Madison fishing; Fenn corridor. No Hole, no bride, high.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No Hole; no bride.

CHEAPEST TEST —

GATE **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft); Access free and available 24/7; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

No lines placed.

22 Provo Canyon / Timpanogos — Bridal Veil Falls (UT)

15

UT · Utah County, Uinta-Wasatch-Cache NF · ≈ 40.34 , -111.60 (verify) · $\approx 4,600$ ft

STANDING

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 5 (3 fit · 1 fail) gate +7.5 (5✓ 0× 15 open) evidence 2.4 (2 facts mention it)

CASE Bridal Veil Falls (free county park, dogs) is the maiden's tears; Timpanogos's skyline is her sleeping profile from the canyon — a named face. Provo River blue-ribbon. Below a mile. Utah early-Fenn claim.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No Hole; the mountain is limestone; urban.

CHEAPEST TEST Any natural Hole in Provo Canyon (Cascade Springs? Deer Creek?); granite within a mile of a free pullout.

GATE **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

No lines placed.

23 High Uintas — Kings Peak / Bear River (UT)

15

UT · Summit County, Uinta-Wasatch-Cache NF · ≈ 40.78 , -110.37 (verify) · $\approx 13,528$ ft (Kings) STANDING

chain 0 (0 slots) poem -1 (1 fit · 1 fail) gate +4.5 (3✓ 0× 17 open) evidence 11.4 (7 facts mention it)

CASE Kings Peak = 'his realm'; the Bear River rises here ('ursa'); Red Castle; Christmas Meadows. Quartzite, not granite; Mirror Lake Highway has a fee; mostly above 11,000 ft.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT Elevation and rock type.

CHEAPEST TEST Any granite and any sub-11,000-ft candidate on the Bear River drainage?

GATE **Passes:** Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

No lines placed.

24 Vedauwoo / Pole Mountain (WY)

11

WY · Albany County, Medicine Bow NF · ≈ 41.16 , -105.37 (verify) · $\approx 8,000$ ft

STANDING

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 6 (2 fit · 0 fail) gate +4.5 (3✓ 0× 17 open) evidence 0 (0 facts mention it)

CASE Sherman granite blobs on the Pole Mountain unit ('cast your pole'); day fee at the main area; no water line; far from Fenn ground.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No water for stanza 2; no Fenn.

CHEAPEST TEST —

GATE **Passes:** Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

No lines placed.

25

Crazy Mountains (MT)

MT · Sweet Grass / Park counties · ≈ 46.02, -110.28 (verify) · ≈ 11,000 ft

5

STANDING

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 0 (0 fit · 0 fail) gate +4.5 (3✓ 0× 17 open) evidence 0 (0 facts mention it)

CASE Checked and nothing lands: no Hole, no bride, checkerboard private access, summits at 11,000.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT Nothing lands.

CHEAPEST TEST —

GATE **Passes:** Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe.

No lines placed.

26

Hidden Lake / Queener Mountain — Anaconda-Pintler (MT)

MT · Beaverhead County, Anaconda-Pintler Wilderness, N of Wisdom · ≈ 45.88, -113.30 (Storm Lake Pass; verify) · ≈ 8,500–9,000 ft

17

RULED OUT

chain 10 (5 slots) poem 18 (6 fit · 0 fail) gate -40 (6✓ 1× 13 open) evidence 19.5 (17 facts mention it)

CASE Hub-featured BOTG solve (two trips): Trout/Lamar Creek = silent flight; Queener Mountain (queen) = bride; Storm Lake Pass / Divide = ancient gates; triangular ridge at 20° NE of Trout Creek = foot of three; Waterton Valley CDT (6.73 mi) = return; Hidden Lake canyon walls = double arcs. Claims a 200-ft checkpoint area. Wilderness: free, dogs, no vehicles beyond trailhead; Pintler granite exists.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT 6.73 miles of CDT is not 'a mile from the car'; a wilderness lake basin is not 'a little ways off a trail'.

CHEAPEST TEST Is there a road-accessible approach to Hidden Lake within a mile? Is the Queener/Storm Lake rock granite?

GATE **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7; The Hole carries no man-made implication; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe. **Fails:** Within about a mile of the car to identify the spot.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L06 <i>Walk near waters' silent flight.</i>	Trout / Lamar Creek	Silent creek walk from the trailhead	1	✓ fits
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	Queener Mountain / Storm Lake Pass 46.05, -113.30	Queen = bride; the pass on the Divide = ancient gates	1	✓ fits
L11 <i>Her foot of three at twenty degree,</i>	Triangular ridge 20° NE of Trout Creek	Foot of three as a triangle at 20°	1	✓ fits
L12 <i>Return her face to find the place.</i>	Waterton Valley CDT (6.73 mi)	The return leg	1	unjudged
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Hidden Lake canyon walls 45.88, -113.30	Arcs in the canyon walls; Pintler granite	1	✓ fits

27

Bear Trap Canyon — Madison River (MT)

MT · Madison County, BLM Lee Metcalf Wilderness · ≈ 45.61, -111.60 (verify) · ≈ 4,900 ft

11

RULED OUT

chain 12 (4 slots) poem 12 (4 fit · 0 fail) gate -40 (6✓ 1× 13 open) evidence 18 (33 facts mention it)

CASE BLM's first wilderness; a literal Bear for ursae; Madison = Posey's Fenn corridor (within 75 mi of West Yellowstone); year-round fishing; Archean gneiss and granite walls; dogs; below a mile; the Sphinx (a face) east across the range.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT The whole canyon is the 9-mile Bear Trap trail; no Hole; no bride.

CHEAPEST TEST Is there off-trail granite at the canyon head (Trail Creek) within a mile of the road? Any Hole upstream short of Baker's Hole?

GATE **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft); Access free and available 24/7; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe. **Fails:** Not near any man-made trail — 'a little ways off'.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L06 <i>Walk near waters' silent flight.</i>	Madison River through Bear Trap Canyon 45.61, -111.60	Powerhouse trail along the river	1	✓ fits
L08 <i>I wait for you to cast your pole.</i>	Madison River 45.61, -111.60	Year-round fishing	2	✓ fits
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Bear Trap Canyon 45.61, -111.60	A literal Bear for ursa; the Sphinx (a face) east across the range	2	✓ fits
L13 <i>Double arcs on granite bold,</i>	Archean gneiss and granite canyon walls 45.61, -111.60	Bold rock but gneiss more than granite	1	✓ fits

28 Gold Basin / Tuk cirque — north foot (alternate)

10

UT · La Sal Mountains, Geyser Pass Rd → Gold Basin Rd · ≈ 38.47, -109.26 (verify on quad) · RULED OUT
≈ 10,500 ft

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 24 (8 fit · 0 fail) gate -40 (9✓ 1× 10 open) evidence 12 (11 facts mention it)

CASE Arc-shaped cirques on bold rock, but no named paired pools; talus, avalanche paths and creek per trip reports. Higher and more snowbound. ARCHIVED Sep 6 2026: removed with Tuk; kept so it is not re-argued.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT Same Hole problem as Medicine Lakes, plus a high, snowbound cirque with no named double feature and a long walk from any car.

CHEAPEST TEST Any named paired tarns in Gold Basin on the quad? If not, drop it.

GATE **Passes:** Not associated with man-made buildings; not near graves; Bride is visible, not alive, and follows from understanding the gates; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe. **Fails:** The Hole carries no man-made implication.

No lines placed.

29 Thousand Springs / Lost River Sinks (ID)

-17

ID · Gooding / Butte counties · ≈ 42.75, -114.85 (verify) · ≈ 3,000 ft

RULED OUT

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 6 (2 fit · 0 fail) gate -40 (3✓ 1× 16 open) evidence 12 (9 facts mention it)

CASE Springs bursting from the Snake River canyon wall (surge) fed by the Lost Rivers that sink into the plain (silent flight). The Sinks are on the INL, restricted; the springs are a fee state park.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT Restricted and fee.

CHEAPEST TEST —

GATE **Passes:** Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe. **Fails:** Access free and available 24/7.

No lines placed.

30 Devil's Slide / Gardiner (MT)

MT · Park County, roadside US-89 · ≈ 45.08 , -110.79 (verify) · $\approx 5,200$ ft

-20

RULED OUT

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 3 (1 fit · 0 fail) gate -40 (3✓ 1× 16 open) evidence 12 (11 facts mention it)

CASE Posey searched here for Fenn; a bold rock formation visible from the highway. Private land, roadside.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT Private.

CHEAPEST TEST —

GATE **Passes:** Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe. **Fails:** On publicly accessible land, not private property.

No lines placed.

31 Medicine Wheel — Bighorn Mountains (WY)

WY · Big Horn County, Bighorn NF · ≈ 44.83 , -107.92 (verify) · $\approx 9,640$ ft

-21

RULED OUT

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 2 (2 fit · 1 fail) gate -40 (3✓ 1× 16 open) evidence 12 (7 facts mention it)

CASE A stone circle (arcs) that is literally sacred and ancient; limestone; restricted access with a 1.5-mi walk; 9,640 ft.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT Limestone; restricted.

CHEAPEST TEST —

GATE **Passes:** Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe. **Fails:** Not near any man-made trail — 'a little ways off'.

No lines placed.

32 Blue Hole — Santa Rosa (NM)

NM · Guadalupe County, city park · ≈ 34.94 , -104.67 (verify) · $\approx 4,600$ ft

-27

RULED OUT

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 2 (2 fit · 1 fail) gate -40 (3✓ 1× 16 open) evidence 6 (4 facts mention it)

CASE Bell-shaped artesian sinkhole, 3,000 gal/min, 62°F, crystal clear, tied to the Pecos; north of the Santa Fe cutoff. A perfect 2:1 and a named Hole with nothing after it.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT City dive park with structures and a grate; no granite, no mountains, no bear.

CHEAPEST TEST Anything for stanzas 3–4 within 30 miles?

GATE **Passes:** Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe. **Fails:** Not associated with man-made buildings; not near graves.

No lines placed.

33 Sacajawea Peak — Bridger Range (MT)

MT · Gallatin County, Custer-Gallatin NF · ≈ 45.90 , -110.96 (verify) · $\approx 9,665$ ft

-27

RULED OUT

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 3 (1 fit · 0 fail) gate -40 (5✓ 1× 14 open) evidence 2.4 (1 facts mention it)

CASE A bride's name on the highest Bridger; free NF; near Bozeman. No Hole, no granite line, a trail summit.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT No Hole; trail.

CHEAPEST TEST —

GATE **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe. **Fails:** Not near any man-made trail — 'a little ways off'.

No lines placed.

34

Sister Superior / Castle Valley — Moab stanza 3 (superseded)

UT · Grand County, Castle Valley / BLM · ≈ 38.655, -109.375 (Rectory ridge; verify) · ≈ 6,600 ft (valley) · towers to 7,000 ft

-33

RULED OUT

chain 20 (7 slots) poem -3 (3 fit · 3 fail) gate -80 (5✓ 2× 13 open) evidence 22.5 (42 facts mention it)

CASE Sep 6 2026 working solve: Matrimony Spring (S2L1) → Colorado River on Potash Rd (S2L2) → canyon bend / culvert on the Gold Bar approach (S2L3, contested — the Hole has no man-made implication) → riverbank (S2L4 placeholder) → east from Jeep Arch into Castle Valley; realm = the valley, Castleton Tower the castle (S3L1) → Sister Superior on the Rectory ridge as the bride; gates = valley mouth between the Rectory ridge and Parriott Mesa (S3L2) → three towers on one pedestal (S3L3) → rotation readings on Sister Superior's face (S3L4). Stanza 4 empty since Tuk was removed. Superseded the same day: the Ursa East answer closes 'bear east' as a verb; Castle Valley is NW not east; SR-128 returns to the S2 start.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT Already wounded: ursa-as-verb closed by Posey's Ursa East answer; no granite; no bear naming; no stanza-4 candidate. Killed outright by any confirmation that the gates are a named crossing rather than a valley mouth.

CHEAPEST TEST Establish what 'Tomasaki' means; check whether any Castle Valley feature carries a bear name; if neither, close the region.

GATE **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed. **Fails:** The Hole carries no man-made implication; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find.

LINE	PLACE	READING	SURE	VERDICT
L05 <i>As hope surges, clear and bright,</i>	Matrimony Spring 38.575, -109.53	Marriage spring at the head of SR-128	2	✓ fits
L06 <i>Walk near waters' silent flight.</i>	Colorado River, Potash Road (SR-279) 38.57, -109.60	Walk near the silent river	2	✓ fits
L07 <i>Round the bend, past the Hole,</i>	Canyon bend / Gold Bar culvert 38.60, -109.62	Contested: the culvert is man-made	1	✗ fails
L09 <i>In ursa east his realm awaits;</i>	Castle Valley / Castleton Tower 38.65, -109.37	Realm = the valley a castle governs (direction conflict: NE of Moab, not east)	1	✗ fails
L10 <i>His bride stands guard at ancient gates.</i>	Sister Superior, Rectory ridge 38.655, -109.375	A nun is a bride of Christ; gates = the valley mouth	2	✓ fits
L11 <i>Her foot of three at twenty degree,</i>	Rectory towers on one pedestal 38.655, -109.375	Three formations on a common base (weak — more than three towers)	1	unjudged
L12 <i>Return her face to find the place.</i>	Sister Superior's face 38.655, -109.375	Rotation readings apply to the tower's face	1	unjudged

35 Pompeys Pillar (MT)

MT · Yellowstone County, BLM National Monument · ≈ 46.00, -108.00 (verify) · ≈ 2,900 ft

-36

RULED OUT

chain 0 (0 slots) poem -1 (1 fit · 1 fail) gate -40 (3✓ 1× 16 open) evidence 0 (0 facts mention it)

CASE Clark's 1806 signature carved in rock — 'secrets of the past still hold'. Sandstone; fee monument.**WHAT WOULD KILL IT** Sandstone; fee.**CHEAPEST TEST** —**GATE** **Passes:** Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe. **Fails:** Access free and available 24/7.

No lines placed.

36 Madison River / Harlequin Lake — West Yellowstone (Greer solve)

MT · Gallatin NF / Yellowstone boundary · ≈ 44.66, -111.10 (verify) · ≈ 6,700 ft

-50

RULED OUT

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 6 (2 fit · 0 fail) gate -80 (10✓ 2× 8 open) evidence 9 (6 facts mention it)

CASE Community full solve, Jul 2026: Baker's Hole → Boundary Trail → Three Brothers alignment → Harlequin Lake trailhead. Inside Fenn's map. No chest reported. Kept for comparison.**WHAT WOULD KILL IT** Inside Yellowstone: fee entry, no dogs on trails, and the route is the Boundary Trail. Three gates.**CHEAPEST TEST** Is any part of the endpoint outside the YNP boundary and off-trail? If not, it fails two gates.**GATE** **Passes:** Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft); The Hole carries no man-made implication; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Within about a mile of the car to identify the spot; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe; No high-clearance vehicle needed. **Fails:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Not near any man-made trail — 'a little ways off'.

No lines placed.

37 Rainbow Arch bridge — Warm Springs Conservation Area (MT)

MT · Deer Lodge County, Warm Springs WMA · ≈ 46.18, -112.78 (verify) · ≈ 4,800 ft

-62

RULED OUT

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 6 (2 fit · 0 fail) gate -80 (4✓ 2× 14 open) evidence 6 (4 facts mention it)

CASE Reddit field find: a double-arched stone bridge — two arcs in stone — 'matching coffee-cup handles in the documentary'. As a site it is a man-made structure and fails outright; as a 4:1 mark it survives only if the arcs are the checkpoint and the treasure sits elsewhere. Warm Springs = a surge. Below a mile.**WHAT WOULD KILL IT** A bridge is a man-made structure; the treasure is not associated with one.**CHEAPEST TEST** Is the bridge on public land and off-trail? Is there granite (not the bridge stone) within a mile?**GATE** **Passes:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe. **Fails:** Not associated with man-made buildings; not near graves; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication.

No lines placed.

38 Boiling River / Gardiner (MT)

MT · Park County, YNP north entrance · ≈ 44.99, -110.69 (verify) · ≈ 5,600 ft

-70

RULED OUT

chain 0 (0 slots) poem 3 (1 fit · 0 fail) gate -80 (3✓ 2× 15 open) evidence 2.4 (2 facts mention it)

CASE Posey searched here for Fenn; a hot river meeting a cold one (surge). Inside the park and closed since the 2022 flood.**WHAT WOULD KILL IT** Park, fee, dogs, closed.

CHEAPEST TEST —

GATE **Passes:** Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe. **Fails:** You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7.

No lines placed.

39 Medicine Lakes — south foot of Tukuhnikivatz (favored)**-108**

UT · La Sal Mountains, near La Sal Pass · ≈ 38.42, -109.24 (verify on quad) · ≈ 10,000 ft RULED OUT

chain **0** (0 slots) poem **27** (9 fit · 0 fail) gate **-160** (10✓ 4× 6 open) evidence **10.2** (6 facts mention it)

CASE Reading C endpoint. Named plural pair at Tuk's southern base; drivable pass with trailhead. Check standard-car access on La Sal Pass Road in dry season. Stanza 2 approach unchanged from the Moab start. VERIFIED: a trailhead with pit toilets at the end of a 4WD spur — fails three gates as a site. ARCHIVED Sep 6 2026: removed from the working solve when Tukuhnikivatz was dropped as the bride — kept so it is not re-argued.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT The stanza-2 Hole. It inherits the culvert, which Posey has directly denied. Also: no granite.

CHEAPEST TEST Find a natural, proper-noun Hole on or near the Moab approach; confirm La Sal Pass Rd in a standard car; check whether Posey ever searched for Fenn within 75 mi of Moab. Fenn gate: the overview says he looked in Utah early — find the source; if real, Moab clears it.

GATE **Passes:** Bride is visible, not alive, and follows from understanding the gates; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Within about a mile of the car to identify the spot; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe. **Fails:** Not associated with man-made buildings; not near graves; The Hole carries no man-made implication; Not near any man-made trail — 'a little ways off'; No high-clearance vehicle needed.

No lines placed.

40 Corona & Bowtie Arch — Potash Road (working solve)**-127**

UT · Moab / Gold Bar, BLM · ≈ 38.58, -109.62 (verify on quad) · ≈ 4,600 ft

RULED OUT

chain **0** (0 slots) poem **12** (4 fit · 0 fail) gate **-160** (9✓ 4× 7 open) evidence **7.2** (5 facts mention it)

CASE Stanza-4 site of the Moab / La Sal solve. Reached via SR-279 from the Matrimony Spring start; trail has bolted cable and ladder. Verdicts follow the §11 scoreboard: pinned lines fit, contested lines left unjudged so the objections stay visible. ARCHIVED Sep 6 2026: Corona + Bowtie removed from the working solve; kept so it is not re-argued.

WHAT WOULD KILL IT Already dead on three Posey statements: on a trail, culvert Hole, two man-made implications (culvert + ladder).

CHEAPEST TEST None needed — demoted. Keep for comparison only.

GATE **Passes:** Not associated with man-made buildings; not near graves; You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail; Access free and available 24/7; Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find; Within about a mile of the car to identify the spot; Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling; On publicly accessible land, not private property; Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe; No high-clearance vehicle needed. **Fails:** Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4; The Hole carries no man-made implication; Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication; Not near any man-made trail — 'a little ways off'.

No lines placed.

5

THE GATE — TWENTY RULES

Every solve is judged against these. Ranked by how many solves each rule has killed.

#	RULE	SOURCE	KILLS	PASS	OPEN
1	Not near any man-made trail — 'a little ways off'	Dillon	6	0	34
2	The Hole carries no man-made implication	Seekers Summit	4	12	24
3	Access free and available 24/7	Q&A	3	22	15
4	Not associated with man-made buildings; not near graves	Rules	3	5	32
5	Built on natural landscape; at most one man-made implication	Dillon	2	37	1
6	You can bring your dog — so not a no-dogs park trail	treasure.quest FAQ	2	28	10
7	Inside the printed map; American West; not many miles to find	Q&A	1	38	1
8	On publicly accessible land, not private property	Rules	1	18	21
9	No high-clearance vehicle needed	Rules	1	13	26
10	Stanzas 1–3 solvable from home; boots on the ground only at stanza 4	Q&A	1	11	28
11	Within about a mile of the car to identify the spot	Q&A	1	5	34
12	Not Colorado, not Oregon, not 75 mi south of Santa Fe	Seekers Summit	0	39	1
13	Not underwater, in a cave, mine or tunnel, or anywhere needing rappelling	Rules	0	18	22
14	No ropes, ladders, climbing or swimming skills needed	Rules	0	12	28
15	Within 75 mi of somewhere he searched for Fenn (walked back; soft)	Seekers Summit	0	11	29
16	Bride is visible, not alive, and follows from understanding the gates	Seekers Summit	0	6	34
17	Not at railroad tracks	Summit	0	2	38
18	'Return her face' technically implies a physical rotation	Seekers Summit	0	1	39
19	Below about a mile high? (soft — check his exact words)	community	0	0	40
20	Something must be manipulated to see it; a flashlight may help	Q&A	0	0	40

GATE MATRIX

✓ pass · ✕ fail · blank open. Columns are the rules in the order above.

SOLVE	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓		✓					
TOP 2 · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓			
Wisdom / Big Hole / Beaverhead Rock	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓		✓					
Sinks Canyon → Wind River front	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓						
Thermopolis				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓		✓					
Granite Creek / Jackson Hole	✓			✓	✓	✓	✓		✓		✓	✓		✓						
Twin Bridges	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓					✓				
TOP 3 · Jackson Hole	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓			

SOLVE	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
Pioneer Mountains		✓			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓							
Sweetwater River			✓		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓					✓	
Gates of the Mountains		✓			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓						
Hole-in-the-Wall		✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓							
City of Rocks			✓		✓			✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓						
Beartooth Highway / Beartooth Butte			✓		✓	✓	✓					✓			✓					
Lemhi Pass / Sacagawea's return			✓		✓	✓	✓		✓			✓								
Tres Piedras / Ojo Caliente			✓		✓	✓	✓					✓			✓					
Bear Lodge / Devils Tower					✓		✓					✓	✓							
Big Springs / Henry's Fork			✓		✓	✓	✓					✓			✓					
Torrey Lake petroglyphs					✓	✓	✓					✓								
Heron Lake					✓	✓	✓					✓			✓					
Ennis / Sphinx Mountain			✓		✓	✓	✓					✓			✓					
Provo Canyon / Timpanogos			✓		✓	✓	✓					✓								
High Uintas					✓		✓					✓								
Vedauwoo / Pole Mountain					✓		✓					✓								
Crazy Mountains					✓		✓					✓								
Hidden Lake / Queener Mountain			✓	✓		✓	✓	✓			×	✓								
Bear Trap Canyon	×		✓		✓	✓	✓					✓			✓					
Gold Basin / Tuk cirque		×	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓			✓				
Thousand Springs / Lost River Sinks			×		✓		✓					✓								
Devil's Slide / Gardiner					✓		✓	×				✓								
Medicine Wheel	×				✓		✓					✓								
Blue Hole				×	✓		✓					✓								
Sacajawea Peak	×		✓		✓	✓	✓					✓								
Sister Superior / Castle Valley		×	✓			✓	×	✓					✓	✓						
Pompeys Pillar			×		✓		✓					✓								
Madison River / Harlequin Lake	×	✓			✓	×	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓					
Rainbow Arch bridge			✓	×	×	✓	✓					✓								
Boiling River / Gardiner			×		✓	×	✓					✓								
Medicine Lakes	×	×	✓	×	✓	✓	✓	✓	×		✓	✓	✓	✓		✓				
Corona & Bowtie Arch	×	×	✓	✓	×	✓	✓	✓	✓	×	✓	✓	✓							

6 WHAT POSEY SAID

92 statements. Confirmed (in writing or the rules) first, then reported through a named source. Arrows show which poem lines each statement is matched to; ✕ marks a contradiction.

CONFIRMED · 35

i001 Hunt Items (the treasure, the checkpoint and any placed clue) are NOT underwater, on private property, in caves, mines or tunnels, anywhere that needs rappelling, associated with man-made buildings, near graves or grave markers, or in dangerous places.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest official rules · 2025-03-27 ✕L07 →L16

i002 All Hunt Items ARE more than 1 mile from anywhere Posey, his family or friends live, work or own property (including their businesses); on publicly accessible land anyone can visit; safe to get to.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest official rules · 2025-03-27 →L16

i003 You DON'T need climbing gear or ropes, permission to enter private land, swimming skills, ladders or climbing skills, or a high-clearance vehicle.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest official rules · 2025-03-27 ✕L13 →L16

i005 All essential clues are in the poem, free on treasure.quest. Five stanzas of four lines. At least 10 clues. Clues are in consecutive order, top to bottom (confirmed in website announcements).

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest announcements →L04

i007 No red herrings in the poem. No hidden codes in the website's source code.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L18

i022 Aug 1 2025: several searchers have solved at least the first two clues, and some have been within 200 feet of the checkpoint. Zero searchers have sent him a photo of the correct checkpoint. The checkpoint is not visible in Gold & Greed.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Posey on X, Aug 1 2025 · 2025-08-01 →L05 →L06

i141 Hunt status: on March 28, 2025, asked on X whether it had been found, Posey replied 'The treasure has NOT been found!' The site says 'check back frequently'. The report gives the hardcover as 236 pages (the master file says 220 — check which is right).

Posey statement · Confirmed · Posey on X, Mar 28 2025 (via report) · 2025-03-28 →L01

i150 Official FAQ (treasure.quest announcements): Are the clues in consecutive order? Yes. Is the treasure buried? 'If you know where to go, it wouldn't matter either way.' Exact spot or general area? 'If you've solved the poem in its entirety, you'll end up at an exact location.' How far from your car? 'You don't need to hike a great distance. You don't need to hike more than a mile to figure out where the treasure is at.' Do you have to pay to get in? 'No, not as of today.' The container is immediately recognizable, not a Fenn replica, and no knowledge of the Fenn hunt is needed. The whole treasure weighs 60 lb.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest announcements FAQ (via r/TreasureHunting, u/Advanced_Relation_79)

→L16 →L12 ✕L09

i151 Official FAQ: 'Can I bring my dog? If your dog is the outdoors type, absolutely!' Dogs are barred from trails and backcountry in Yellowstone and Grand Teton and most national parks; they are allowed on national forest and BLM land. Read with 'no fee, not as of today', the site is very unlikely to be inside a national park.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest announcements FAQ (via r/TreasureHunting, u/Advanced_Relation_79)

✕L16 →L16

i187 CORRECTION — railroad tracks. Dillon (6/21/25): 'Do you consider railroad tracks a man-made structure?' → 'I consider them to be a man-made structure. Yes.' Summit (3/28/26): 'Based on how the rules are described, railroad tracks are ruled out.' Also Dillon: 'I did not put it in very close proximity to any man-made trail... so it is a little ways off' — he didn't want a random hiker to stumble on it. So tracks are OUT as a site, not 'nearby'; my earlier fragment read was wrong. And: 'One clue arguably has a man-made implication, but the whole hunt could be solved using only natural structures depending on interpretation.'

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript) · 2026-03-28 ✕L16 →L13

i189 Not private property — reiterated emphatically June 2026 after reports of trespassing: 'the treasure is not on private property', already stated in rules, posts and interviews. Federal vs state land: 'No, but it's publicly accessible as of today' (Dillon). 'The focus is on legal accessibility of the final location, not convenience of access.'

Posey statement · Confirmed · Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up) · 2026-06 →L16

i191 Poem creation: 'I wrote the bulk of that poem in 6 hours or less. Purposely didn't finish the poem til the day the book went to print... I only tweaked two words tops.' (Dillon). Froggy: 'Forrest spent like 10 years... I came up with the bulk of that poem in about four to six hours.'

Posey statement · Confirmed · Dillon Q&A — Jun 21 2025 (THAP / JIBLE) · 2025-06-21 →L18

i192 'Virtually every line in the poem is helpful. So just because as hope surges is the first actionable clue, doesn't mean people should discount the earlier lines. They are helpful context.' (X Dark Matters). 'Is the poem an instruction manual, a map, or both?' → 'In a way, a map can be an instruction manual, so I guess, yeah.' (Sandal)

Posey statement · Confirmed · X Dark Matters — Sep 4 2025 (JIBLE) · 2025-09-04 →L01 →L04

i194 'The key to one direction lies in another' — this line is a hidden audio message decoded from the ARKADE song 'Beyond the Map's Edge' (Netflix); Justin confirmed the associated technical clue, not as the core geographic solution. At Summit: 'Does this relate to the azimuth?' → 'No.'

Posey statement · Confirmed · Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up) · 2026-04 →L12 ×L11 →L09

i195 Cipher solved and confirmed: MAGYAR (April 2026) — Hungarian; Tucker was a Vizsla, a Hungarian breed. 'The cipher is more than anything a nod to what the container is' (Sandal). Not in the poem, not in the book ('Who says the cipher is in the book?'). Basic math only. Solver: a woman overseas. Justin: MAGYAR does not give coordinates, a state or a region.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up) · 2026-04 →L20 ×L04

i196 Container: 'Who says it's a box?' (4/9/25). 'Targeted and deliberate modifications' to an existing object; some searchers have guessed it correctly; 'extremely recognizable — anybody who watched the series or read my book will know right away'; not a Fenn replica. The Tucker bronze statue (~70–80 lb, hollow) is NOT the treasure. The original Saddleback briefcase that carried the treasure, plus the Netflix coffee mugs, ship to the winner.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Treasure Hunt With Us podcast — Apr 9 2025 (THAP) · 2025-04-09 →L20 →L16

i197 Rearrangement and reading: 'Does the poem need to be read or rearranged other than as presented?' → 'I'm not going to rule that out.' Thematic vs literal → 'Probably roughly both in equal measure.' Anagrams → 'I haven't specified.' Homophones/wordplay for numbers → 'Yes' — kept 'in play'. Solve verifiability: between Sudoku and 'jump in the lake' — 'a reasonable person would say okay, seems reasonable'.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript) · 2026-03-28 →L04 →L11

i198 Multiple solves as safeguards: 'in case certain aspects of the mechanics don't work... there are other ways to approach it so that you end up finding it either way' (Sandal). 'There is an optimal solution and fallback paths... someone might not quite understand one clue, they could still limp along' (Dillon, Gypsy's Kiss).

Posey statement · Confirmed · Sandal Sanders livestream — Sep 27 2025 (JIBLE) · 2025-09-27 →L18

i199 Stanza 3 verbatim: 'Is return her face referring to the bride?' → punt (9/4/25); later 'her face belongs to her' → yes (Summit). 'Is the place in her face or her gaze?' → no clarity. 'Has the bride ever been alive?' → 'depends on how you define the term alive' (Sandal). 'Is bride the right word?' → 'No. I'm pretty pleased with that one.' 'Is double arcs a directional bearing?' → punt. 'Are there multiple meanings to castle?' → 'only one correct interpretation' (castle appears somewhere in the materials — locate it).

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript) · 2026-03-28 →L10 →L12
→L13

i200 Vantage point: 'There is a vantage point mentioned in your grandfather's memoir — did you incorporate that?' → 'There is a vantage point involved. But it's not that any of the clues are necessarily talking about that vantage point.' Grandpa FITZWATER (Montana fish-and-game warden, Dillon / Blacktail Deer Creek) wrote memoirs; Justin's favorite story: the poacher confronted at a cabin poker game.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript) · 2026-03-28 →L03 →L11

i201 Layer 5: 'It is true to say that layer five has some bearing on the treasure hunt.' Undefined publicly — likely an audio/mix layer (the song) or a map layer. Ankh in the legal section: not a clue, though the ankh may matter elsewhere. Dedication: 'layered and intentional... I am talking about a person... someone very special.' 'The Legal Lowdown' has no hints. Rancher 'Niven': 'an interesting character, that's about all I can say.' Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript) · 2026-03-28 →L04

i202 Two 'super obvious' Netflix hints: 'It's either episode two or three. It is a scene that does not have me in it. But it was a scene that I had some control over. If you rewatch it, it'll be pretty obvious.' (Dillon). By 9/27/25 he said people had since figured these out. Clues only 'where I had some notion of control, directly or indirectly'. The lawyer/Carl scene: zero clues. Checkpoint not visible in the series. At least five singular clues, some compound. 'Netflix hints guide you in the book.' Roman numerals on the clock make no difference. Clock count: 'the lower the number the better.'

Posey statement · Confirmed · Dillon Q&A — Jun 21 2025 (THAP / JIBLE) · 2025-06-21 →L01 →L04

i203 Hiding verbatim: two 2023 journeys totaling 9,000+ miles (first was reconnaissance), off-grid; 'no hint meant to be read into 9,000 miles'; at least four trips from the car, all within a 24-hour span, with a broken tibia, not his own vehicle; 'anonymous travel is very hard... my route was convoluted... I did it twice'; has never returned and has no plans to. Animal seen while hiding: mammalian, NOT a moose, first time seeing it in nature, 'if I said the animal it could have a pretty profound impact on the search area' — and separately he has confirmed seeing a wolverine in the wild.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript) · 2026-03-28 →L16 →L09

i204 Site verbatim: 'a place that is important to me, and a place that I've known about for quite some time'; meaningful for beauty, symbolism AND sentiment ('all of the above'); 'physical objects along the way — fair to say there are'; the finder 'will have come to know its personal lore and secrets — I think so'. 'Is there a significant clue visible standing 15 feet from the container?' → 'The most accurate answer is no.' Metal detector → 'probably not'. Digging → 'not something I'm willing to rule out'. Exterior of a structure → 'always a possibility'; a gazebo counts as a building. Not wheelchair accessible. 'If you're needing to drink many bottles of water, you're going too far.' 'Even a serious low rider would absolutely have made it' on BLM dirt roads.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript) · 2026-03-28 →L16 →L14 →L06

i205 Progress verbatim: 'Certainly the first stanza... at least a large portion, been solved. The second stanza, at least half of it' (9/4/25). 'Part of stanza 3 solved'; 'at least six clues' by the most-advanced searcher; 'people less than two miles... and certainly even less' (Dillon); 200 ft from the checkpoint (8/1/25); 'fairly close' several (X Marks); zero checkpoint photos; kitchen-sized area unreached; 'No group way off in left field. No group uber close.' 'Tangible progress... absolutely attainable... a matter of time.' Summit stats: 277,428 verify requests; 119,644 people '100% sure'; 1,221 bribe attempts; 80 blackmail; 19 tracking; 16 search-and-rescue operations.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript) · 2026-03-28 →L05 →L13

i206 Design philosophy verbatim: 'formalized hide-and-seek with confidence checkpoints'; 'the part of me that embraces childlike wonder' wrote the poem; designed for humans not AI ('an astronomical amount of thought'); won't say if buried because AI could use it; Disney Imagineering background (~a decade) — 'not just you go and get it — there's something more to it'; tiers: 'some easier things... and some more challenging'; no grid searching; 'take your treasure hat off and read the memoir as a memoir'; 'understanding the person who hid it is the clearest map'. Pep talk: 'The night is darkest before the light. If you are confident in the location in which you're searching, I see little reason to stray.' Finder psychology: Hurley from Lost. 42: 'The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy is a fantastic book.'

Posey statement · Confirmed · X Marks the Pod — pre-Summit, ~early 2026 (THAP) · 2026 →L17 →L20 →L01

i207 Logo: 'the angzarr symbol — I chose and modified it intentionally' (X Dark Matters). Angzarr is the Unicode glyph Ꞑ (U+237C, 'right angle with downwards zigzag arrow'), a symbol with no known origin — a right angle plus a zigzag arrow. 'I designed the logo intentionally and it has some meaning' (X Marks). TreasureNet: the logo traces Utah's northeast corner.

Posey statement · Confirmed · X Dark Matters — Sep 4 2025 (JIBLE) · 2025-09-04 →L11 →L12 →L04

i220 MW Sep 8 2025 — Posey's X post: Stanza 1 and 'at least PART of stanza 2' solved (the interview said 'half'; Jenny notes part ≠ half — a word or phrase, not a sentence). Searchers don't know without doubt until the checkpoint; Posey has not announced it found.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Posey on X, ~Sep 5 2025 (via MW) · 2025-09-05 →L05 ×L07

i224 Q: Does one need to be at the bride to identify her foot of three, or some distance away? Posey stalled, re-read it, then answered: No. You do not need to be at the bride — the foot of three should be identifiable from a distance or from a map.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit) · 2026-03-28 →L11

→L10

i225 Q: How far is 'her face' from 'the place'? Posey: probably not as far as many people think.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit) · 2026-03-28 →L12

i226 Q: How far is the treasure from the bride? Posey: a matter of perspective.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit) · 2026-03-28 →L10

i227 Q: Is 'east' a portion within one Ursa, or is there a west Ursa and an east Ursa? Posey: you only need to worry about Ursa East.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit) · 2026-03-28 →L09

i228 Q: Is 'ursa' lowercase deliberately? Posey: the poem was written deliberately; the choice not to capitalize was intentional. No further clarity offered.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit) · 2026-03-28 →L09

i229 Q: Are 'the place' and 'the sacred space' the same location? Posey: not necessarily.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit) · 2026-03-28 →L12

→L16

i230 Q: Does her face belong to the bride? Posey: yes (after hedging about two interpretations). Q: Is 'return her face' referring to the bride? Punted in September, answered yes at Seekers Summit.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit) · 2026-03-28 →L12

→L10

LIKELY / REPORTED · 57

i004 'If you need rope then it's not the right location.' Searchers are going too deep into wilderness, rappelling into caves and searching cliffsides. Nothing dangerous is required. Asked point blank where it is: on earth, in the American West, not a place you have to go many miles to find.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 →L16

i006 Asked at Seekers Summit whether the poem needs to be read or rearranged in any way other than as presented: 'I'm not going to rule that out.'

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 →L04 →L02

i008 A 'fair amount' can be solved from home. Boots on the ground are required for retrieval. If the poem is solved in its entirety, an exact location is given.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L12 →L16

i009 One cipher exists, plus one hint he describes as 'somewhat technical'; neither is critical to the solution. Asked whether the cipher sits in one section of the book or spans several: 'Who says the cipher is in the book?'

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 →L04 →L03

i010 Numbers are indirectly associated with the poem (wordplay, hidden in words) — confirmed yes; declined to address homophones specifically. There IS a distance element in following the clues.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 →L11 →L02

→L01

i011 The map is useful. The treasure is hidden within the printed map, not beyond its edge.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L16

i012 All clues are expected to stand the test of time; he will announce if something drastic changes.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L15 ×L09

i013 First actionable clue: 'As hope surges, clear and bright' (2:1). Last actionable clue: stanza four or five, depending on interpretation.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L05 →L01

i014 Boots on the ground becomes absolutely required at stanza four. Implication: stanzas 1 through 3 are intended to be solvable from home.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L13 ×L09 ×L10

i015 It is walking distance from 'waters' silent flight' through 'round the bend, past the Hole.'

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L06 →L07

i016 'No need to hike more than a mile to figure out where the treasure is at.' Searchers note this is not the same as 'to find it'.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L12 →L07

i017 'How far from the first clue to the last in miles' — he called this impossible to answer given how the clues are structured.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L05 →L11

i018 'By the time you're going to get the treasure you're not searching, you're retrieving.' Once you figure out exactly where it is, you will have sufficient time to plan how you wish to retrieve it.

Posey statement · Likely · X Marks the Pod (Sep 4 2025) · 2025-09-04 →L20 →L16

i019 Something will need to be manipulated in order to see the treasure; depending on conditions a flashlight could be helpful. Punted separately on whether you need to move any rocks.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L16 →L14

i020 Built-in checkpoint gives the reassuring feeling you aren't lost. It gives zero doubt you are trending right. You are at least halfway through the poem clues when you reach it. It is part of the poem, as a stage of the journey. Excellent chance you find the treasure if you're first to it.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L10 →L09 →L12

i021 The checkpoint is both something he placed AND something already there. Asked if it is tied to a topographic feature: 'there is some implication there.' Not something you need to worry about moving. Possible to be at it and not recognize it, depending how close you are.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 →L10 →L13

i023 'You'd be hard pressed to get all the way without seeing the checkpoint.' The audiobook adds a chapter containing the word 'checkpoint', widely read as confirming it cannot be identified from home.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L10 →L13

i024 The bride is not a person who is alive right now. Clarified intent: he does not want anyone thinking she is a living person you can interact with, to prevent searchers hassling real people. The bride is something visible. Someone has correctly identified the bride.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 →L10

i025 Her face does belong to the bride: yes. 'Return her face' does imply a physical rotation — 'the technically correct answer is yes.'

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 ×L12

i026 'Return her face to find the place' — the distance from her face to the place is 'probably not as far as many people might think.' Distance from the bride to the treasure: 'a matter of perspective.'

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 →L12

i027 You do not need to be at the bride to identify her foot of three.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 →L11

i028 It would be 'a little strange' to discover the bride without understanding the ancient gates.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 →L10

i029 Asked whether 'he' is living or was ever living: 'That depends on your perspective.'

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 →L09

i030 Only Ursa East matters; there is no separate west Ursa. The lowercase 'ursa' was deliberate. On an anagram reading such as 'use a star': 'the poem was written deliberately, so the choice of not capitalizing was intentional, but that's all the clarity I'm willing to provide.'

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 →L09

i031 Part of stanza 3 has been solved by searchers, at least in part. 'The place' (3:4) and 'the sacred space' (4:4) are not necessarily the same location.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 →L12 →L16

i032 The Hole carries no man-made implication — a direct 'no' at Seekers Summit. Punted on whether it corresponds to a place with 'hole' in its name (Jackson Hole, Big Hole River): 'an on the nose question.'

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 xL07

i033 Punted on whether 'double arcs on granite bold' is the clue with the man-made implication — widely read as a soft yes, given the Hole was a clean no. At Dillon, would not say whether the arcs exist naturally or were created: 'a strange question to answer since he knows what he knows.'

Posey statement · Likely · Dillon, MT book signing Q&A (Jun 21 2025) via Mysterious Writings · 2025-06-21 →L13

i034 Whether 'cast your pole' refers to a fishing pole: not specified.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L08

i035 Will not say yes or no on whether national parks are ruled out. Has not specified: whether the site predates his Fenn searches, whether the poem references Native American legends, whether there are golf references. Punted on whether he can view searchers near the treasure.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

i036 Colorado eliminated (Seekers Summit, intentional). Oregon eliminated (Seekers Summit, intentional).

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings · 2026-03-28 →L09

i037 Confirmed he had at some point searched for the Fenn chest within 75 miles of where he hid his own treasure — then walked it back, not wanting people to think he'd eliminated states, and questioned whether Fenn's site was even in the official Rocky Mountains.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L16

i039 Access to the location is free and available 24/7. It is NOT near any trail — deliberate, so it wouldn't be stumbled upon.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings xL13 →L16

i046 Netflix: he had no creative control and did not know scene order, framing or focus. He hid hints during filming that even the producers didn't know about. At least 5 singular clues plus compound clues requiring several scenes. Two hints he considers obvious remain unfound, in a scene he does not appear in but had some control over. Clock times 4:02 and 5:26 are eliminated as meaningful.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

i048 There are clues in the hunt's songs. One song contains what he called an extremely definitive clue.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

i049 Roughly 60 pounds including container. Mostly gold: bars, precious gems, rare coins, a meteorite, historical artifacts dating to 561 BC, items from the Forrest Fenn chest, and a Bitcoin wallet funded by book sales. Container immediately recognizable as his, not a Fenn replica. A separate Steward holds additional items.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings →L16

i050 Finders keepers. Finder may remain anonymous, but must come forward within 30 days to claim the Bitcoin portion. The complete solution will be revealed at the conclusion of the hunt.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

i076 Posey answers a monthly Featured Question through Mysterious Writings (since July 2026). Questions phrased specifically but not 'on the nose' have gotten real answers.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

i098 X Marks the Pod (Sep 2025): searchers are 'quite close'; the map is useful 'for a couple different reasons'; the BTME logo was intentionally designed to hold meaning. treasure.quest was changed on July 27, 2026 (details not captured).

Posey statement · Likely · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) – via web search summary →L04

i101 Dillon: the entire hunt is based on naturally occurring structures and landscapes; depending which of the multiple solution paths you take, one clue has a man-made implication. He confirmed there are multiple valid ways to solve it, and that people have been within two miles.

Posey statement · Likely · Dillon, MT Q&A (Jun 21 2025) – via user research →L13 ×L07 →L16

i116 Backtracking. Asked whether you ever return to previously trodden ground while following the poem path: if you knew the entirety of the solution the answer is no, but going through the natural progression of the hunt the answer is more like a yes. The clues stay in sequence; your feet don't.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A (via user research) →L12 →L11 ×L12

i117 Poem structure. Asked whether the poem is linear, several geographic points miles apart, or a hybrid, he declined — then offered that there are some great movies out there: Indiana Jones and National Treasure. Read as a nudge away from Fenn-style point-to-point walking toward convergence: an X from intersecting lines, or something you assemble rather than follow.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A (via user research) →L11 →L12 →L04 ×L07 →L02

i122 Reddit (u/PNW-OOTW quoting Posey): 'How far from your car do you need to go? You don't need to hike a great distance. You don't need to hike more than a mile to figure out where the treasure is at.' Commenter's read: with 'a fair amount' solvable from home, you won't be travelling around a bunch to solve the clues.

Posey statement · Likely · r/beyondthemapedge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/PNW-OOTW, quoting Posey) · 2026-08-23 →L16 →L13

i133 Cross-reference: Fenn's chest was found in Wyoming (Fenn confirmed the state, June 2020; the finder, Jack Stuef, never gave the spot). Posey bought that chest from Stuef and said he had at some point searched for it within 75 miles of where he hid his own. Wyoming and the West Yellowstone corridor were Posey's own Fenn search country. Read with the site disclaimer naming Wyoming law, the Jackson Hole, Sweetwater and Yellowstone-edge solves clear this gate easily; Moab is a stretch.

Posey statement · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 →L16 ×L09

i136 Posey has said that during his Fenn search he believes he was extremely close to the chest's location in Yellowstone — possibly within 10–15 feet — and missed it. Fenn's chest was found in Wyoming in June 2020 by Jack Stuef. Posey later tried to buy the whole lot (\$1.3M reported) to re-hide it; the deal fell through and he acquired several pieces at auction.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026) →L16 ×L09

i137 The container is a Saddleback Leather 16-inch 'Grandfather' briefcase, about 60 lb loaded — not a chest. Contents: PAMP Suisse kilo gold bars, gold flakes and dust, coins across eras, large loose emeralds, rubies and amethysts, Fenn's jewel-encrusted dragon bracelet, artifacts from the Kushan, Crusader, Byzantine and Buyid periods, a Lydian coin (~561 BC), a meteorite, and a Bitcoin wallet that grows with book sales.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026) ×L04 →L16

i138 Posey's grandfather was reportedly a fish-and-game warden in Montana, where Posey spent summers exploring (one forum notes an obituary calling the grandfather a lifelong New Mexico resident). Community discussion says Posey owns property in Montana — the rules put every hunt item more than a mile from anywhere he, family or friends own property. The site is 'in a place that's dear to my heart' and 'surrounded by significance'.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026) →L16 →L08 ×L16

i139 He made multiple trips (four, per one account) to hide the treasure, some designed to obscure the destination, and aimed to leave no digital footprint of the journey. He filmed a description of the treasure for Netflix only just before release so production staff had no advantage.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026) →L18

i140 Rules restated in the report: no specialized knowledge needed; no dangerous water crossings; not associated with any structure; accessible 24/7 with no fee (the report reads this as likely excluding fee-entry National Parks); hints in the Netflix series 'guide you in the book'; the website map's missing state capital and misspellings are accidental; no hidden messages in site code.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026) →L16 ×L06 →L04

i147 Posey on the map: 'I chose the landmarks to be labeled, but the map was designed by a third party. Any incorrect names, positions, and elevations are not intentional.' Read carefully: the SELECTION of labeled landmarks is his; names, positions and elevations are the designer's. Which features got a label is the signal; where they sit and what number they carry is noise.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey (quoted in user research) →L04 ×L01 →L09

i160 The 75-mile exchange, as transcribed (Seekers Summit, Mar 28 2026). Q: 'Is the location where you hid your treasure within 75 miles of a place where you searched for the Forrest Fenn chest?' A: 'I searched a lot of places, guys. Uh, so yeah, I mean it's true to say that at some point I had searched for the Fenn treasure within that 75 mile radius. Yeah.' Follow-up: when he first started, his interpretation of the Rocky Mountains was 'incredibly broad — any mountain with rocks.'

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit transcript via Mysterious Writings (relayed by Google AI overview) · 2026-09 →L16 ×L09

i173 VERIFIED — Posey's summers were at the family cabin in Montana where his grandfather was a fish-and-game warden; he explored the nearby hills with a metal detector. The rules put every hunt item more than a mile from property his family owns, so the cabin bounds the site from inside as well as outside: 'dear to my heart', but not within a mile of the cabin.

Posey statement · Likely · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude) · 2026-09-05 →L16 ×L16

i179 Hub constraints table (Posey, per the hub): the site is below 11,000 ft; clues may cross state lines; the location is less than a mile from a car; access 24/7, no fee; not in a pay park, national-park fee area or restricted zone. 'The treasure is absolutely hidden somewhere on the map that I've published.'

Posey statement · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary · 2026 →L16 →L09 ×L13

i181 Netflix, per the hub: the clocks are confirmed relevant, and Posey called 4:19 on the Netflix clock 'a little uncanny'. Number 42 confirmed relevant at Seekers Summit 2026 with no public decode. (Our file has 4:02 and 5:26 eliminated — the clock as an object is in, those two times are out.)

Posey statement · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary · 2026-03 →L01 →L11

i185 Hub interview index (dates): Cowlazars & KPro YouTube (very early, shortly after launch); Froggy YouTube (early); Treasure Hunt With Us YouTube (Apr 9 2025); Sandal TikTok/YouTube livestream (around National Public Lands Day, late Sep 2025); X Marks the Pod (pre-Summit, late 2025/early 2026); Seekers Summit (Mar 28 2026). The hub holds 233 interview Q&As and 295 book ('JIBLE') entries. The hunt as Posey describes it: 'formalized hide-and-seek with confidence checkpoints — I wanted to give a way for people to gain confidence as opposed to losing confidence as they work through clues.'

Posey statement · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary · 2025-04-09 →L10

i190 Hunt status: a separate marked-book prize was found in July 2026; Justin clarified the marked book was found, 'not the treasure (yet)'. A Treasure Hunt With Us meet-and-greet is scheduled for Sep 12 2026 in POLARIS, Montana — event news, not a stated clue, but the venue is the community's ursa town.

Posey statement · Likely · Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up) · 2026-07 →L09

i193 'From beginning to end of the poem... it will inherently create some sort of shape.' (JIBLE, Distances). Read with 'each clue is not meant to convey great distance' (Summit) and the Indiana Jones / National Treasure nudge: the clues trace a figure, not a march.

Posey statement · Likely · JIBLE 4.0 (jessinthwest / hi-imerica, upd. 9/30/25) via THAP hub · 2025 →L11 →L12 →L09

i219 MW Sep 8 2025 — the 'right questions' from the X Q&A. On AI vs human: 'creating a puzzle for an intellect that dwarfs our own is a paradox... I really wanted to design something that embraces the core of what it means to be human... astronomical amount of thought'; he won't divulge the tactics. On distance: asked for the distance from the first actionable clue to the treasure — 'just by virtue of going through the process of formulating that question, you might find the answer.' On backtracking: 'If you knew the entirety of the solution, then the answer is no. But if you go through the natural progression, the answer is more like a yes.' On structure: 'Indiana Jones and National Treasure.' Checkpoint: 'a natural part of the treasure journey... There is a chance you could bypass it, but boy the odds are astronomically low.' Jenny's read: the checkpoint may only be found by an action once on location.

Posey statement · Likely · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text · 2025-09-08 [→L12](#) [→L11](#) [→L13](#)

7 EVIDENCE BY LINE

Every fact matched to each poem line, with the reason for the match. Strongest confidence first. Long facts are shortened here; the fact id (i001...) finds the full text in sections 6 and 8.

L01 Can you find what lives in time,

35 facts · 3 against

SUPPORTS · w2 · i041

Intentional differences between hardcover and digital, and he said the differences hold insights. Hardcover has two more images than digital, on pages 4 and 117. Page 90 does not exist — pages run 89 to 91 inside chapter 9. Page ...

Missing and unnumbered pages are number play — 'what lives in time' may be a count.

Book text · Confirmed · Beyond the Map's Edge (hardcover)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i141

Hunt status: on March 28, 2025, asked on X whether it had been found, Posey replied 'The treasure has NOT been found!' The site says 'check back frequently'. The report gives the hardcover as 236 pages (the master file says 220 — ...

If page count is a number that matters, 220 vs 236 needs settling.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Posey on X, Mar 28 2025 (via report)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i164

VERIFIED — Lewis named the Big Hole River the 'Wisdom' on Aug 6 1805 (with the Philanthropy, now the Ruby) for Jefferson's virtues; fur trappers later renamed it the Big Hole, 'hole' being their word for a mountain valley. The ...

A name that lives in time.

Book text · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i192

'Virtually every line in the poem is helpful. So just because as hope surges is the first actionable clue, doesn't mean people should discount the earlier lines. They are helpful context.' (X Dark Matters). 'Is the poem an ...

Stanza 1 is context, not filler.

Posey statement · Confirmed · X Dark Matters — Sep 4 2025 (JIBLE)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i202

Two 'super obvious' Netflix hints: 'It's either episode two or three. It is a scene that does not have me in it. But it was a scene that I had some control over. If you rewatch it, it'll be pretty obvious.' (Dillon). By 9/27/25 ...

Clocks are 'part of the cipher'; time is important.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Dillon Q&A — Jun 21 2025 (THAP / JIBLE)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i206

Design philosophy verbatim: 'formalized hide-and-seek with confidence checkpoints'; 'the part of me that embraces childlike wonder' wrote the poem; designed for humans not AI ('an astronomical amount of thought'); won't say if ...

42 → Hitchhiker's Guide: the answer to everything.

Posey statement · Confirmed · X Marks the Pod — pre-Summit, ~early 2026 (THAP)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i218

VERIFIED from the poem text: 'Hole' is the 42nd word (Can-you-find-what-lives-in-time = 7; +5 = 12; +5 = 17; +8 = 25; +6 = 31; +5 = 36; Round-the-bend-past-the = 41; Hole = 42). 42 is confirmed relevant by Posey. The only ...

42 is the answer.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Poem word count (verified by Claude) — flagged by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i010

Numbers are indirectly associated with the poem (wordplay, hidden in words) — confirmed yes; declined to address homophones specifically. There IS a distance element in following the clues.

'Lives in time' — hours, dates, clock numbers.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i013

First actionable clue: 'As hope surges, clear and bright' (2:1). Last actionable clue: stanza four or five, depending on interpretation.

Stanza 1 is instruction, not a place — consistent with the stanza-1 reading.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i043

'The Concrete Kiss': the Big Hill speed-bump line says Idaho in hardcover (p. 43) but Utah in the audiobook. The hill illustration is on page 42. Idaho and Utah share the 42nd parallel.

Another indirect number.

Book text · Likely · Audiobook vs hardcover comparison

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i147

Posey on the map: 'I chose the landmarks to be labeled, but the map was designed by a third party. Any incorrect names, positions, and elevations are not intentional.' Read carefully: the SELECTION of labeled landmarks is his; ...

Cuts against building on elevation numbers (Gannett, Shasta) — those are the designer's.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey (quoted in user research)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i149

Territories as they stood before statehood (a period table for the map): California unorganized 1848 → state 1850 (31st); Oregon Terr. 1848 → 1859 (33rd); Utah Terr. 1850 → 1896 (45th); New Mexico Terr. 1850 → 1912 (47th); ...

Ordinals and dates — the numbers that live in time.

Book text · Likely · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i181

Netflix, per the hub: the clocks are confirmed relevant, and Posey called 4:19 on the Netflix clock 'a little uncanny'. Number 42 confirmed relevant at Seekers Summit 2026 with no public decode. (Our file has 4:02 and 5:26 ...

A clock over his head, and a time he called uncanny: 4:19.

Posey statement · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i182

Book, per the hub: the only explicit 'bride' in the book is a photo caption — 'From left: Grandpa Posey, Mom and Dad (aka the bride and groom), Grandma Posey, and Grandma Clements in September of 1979.' A photograph is a physical ...

17 steps, 18–20 keys, 1979 — numbers in the book.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i209

Book verbatim, motifs: dedication 'thank you for being my north star'; 'Like four points of a compass, I've dedicated this treasure to four departed souls' (book order is authoritative, per Justin); Prologue opens 'Grid searching ...

North star, time, Lydia to outer space.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w2 · i222

MW Sep 8 2025 — 'The Bronze Beast' chapter (Tucker, Novelty Hill, Washington state) is laced with Hitchhiker's Guide allusions: 'quietly contemplate the meaning of life', 'decode the secrets of the universe', 'solved the world's ...

42 planted in the book by allusion and by setting.

Book text · Likely · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text

SUPPORTS · w1 · i064

Stanza 1 reading: 'time' literally (clock, date, hours); 'measured rhyme' = counting words, syllables, positions; 1:3 and 5:3 are the poem's only two em dashes — a pairing that brackets the poem.

Literal time.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w1 · i086

Community: the 'technical' hint is Alt+42 on the numpad, which types an asterisk — a STAR. Ties the recurring 42 (page 42 hill illustration, Idaho/Utah 42nd parallel, peaks-in-order count) to 'use a star'.

42 as a number that 'lives in time' across book, audiobook and map.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i091

Community: the safe combination shown in Gold & Greed reads as 44.26 N 110.5 W — Heart Lake, Yellowstone. Most treat it as a starting point or easter egg rather than the site.

Numbers hidden in the documentary, if the safe is a clue.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i093

Community: the 'extremely definitive' song hint is thought to be in 'Beyond the Map's Edge' by Arkade (the Netflix track). Candidates: the X on the album cover, the cracked-desert landscape, or the number 27. Audiobook tracks ...

27 as another indirect number (the book launched March 27).

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i099

Netflix interview backdrop: Posey sits in front of computer wallpapers (identified as Lake Louise, Colorado, Wyoming, and Utah near the Colorado River) under a giant clock. Searchers treat the wallpapers and clock as the hidden ...

A clock over his head for 'what lives in time'.

Community claim · Unverified · Moviedelic Netflix-clue roundup — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i103

Wisdom/Big Hole supporting reads: 'what lives in time' and 'flowing through each measured rhyme' as the river itself, each clue a point along it, with 'like a river's steady flow' closing the loop in stanza 5. The cover's torn ...

River-as-time reading.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i108

The 42 theory, consolidated: 42 on the truck taillight, the clock at 4:02, the page-42 hill illustration, the Idaho → Utah audiobook swap across the 42nd parallel, and the Alaska peak ordering. Feeds Montana, Wyoming and Idaho ...

A number that recurs across every medium — if anything 'lives in time', 42 is the candidate.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i108

The 42 theory, consolidated: 42 on the truck taillight, the clock at 4:02, the page-42 hill illustration, the Idaho → Utah audiobook swap across the 42nd parallel, and the Alaska peak ordering. Feeds Montana, Wyoming and Idaho ...

The clock reading of 42 was explicitly eliminated.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i113

Stanza 5, reading 4 — callback to stanza 1 (weighted highest). 'What lives in time' opens the poem; 'what you seek, you already know' closes it. A river is a standard answer to what lives in time and flows through measure. The ...

'What lives in time' = the river; stanza 1 is the answer, not a step.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i118

The word 'find' appears exactly twice in the poem: 1:1 ('Can you find what lives in time') and 3:4 ('Return her face to find the place'). If stanza 1 is the reading method, the two uses may be pointing at each other.

'Find' here is answered at 3:4.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i121

Reddit (u/Senior_Muscle_8829): each stanza puts you somewhere — levels in a game, or checkpoints you know are right — and the last few stanzas are where your area is dialed in and you go boots-on-the-ground to 'convey the said ...

Has stanza 1 placing you somewhere, against the stanza-1-is-method reading.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/Senior_Muscle_8829)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i128

City of Rocks, Idaho (~42.07°N — the parallel the 42 clues point at). Actual granite, so 'granite bold' is literal. California Trail landmark where emigrants wrote their names on the rock in axle grease, still legible: secrets of ...

On the 42nd parallel.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i143

The map as a time anchor. Read the book's map not as modern geography but as a historical lens: place names changed, rivers and creeks were relabeled, section lines drawn later, towns existed before boundaries were final. The map ...

'What lives in time' — the map itself is anchored to a moment in time.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i144

Time-warp anomalies on the map: Wyoming was part of Dakota Territory until 1868 (no Wyoming Territory yet in 1864). Salem, Oregon is missing (fixed in the errata) — and Salem was only confirmed as Oregon's capital in 1864. ...

Dates and ordinals living in time.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i146

Mountains and measurement: Mount Shasta was widely held to be California's highest peak in the 1850s–early 1860s; on July 6, 1864 the California Geological Survey named Mount Whitney the highest in California and the contiguous ...

July 6, 1864 — a date that would fix the map's moment.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i152

Rule 42 (r/beyondthemapledge, 33 up): at the end of Gold & Greed Posey quotes Lewis Carroll. In Alice, the King invokes Rule 42: 'All persons more than a mile high to leave the court.' Reading 1: eliminates locations above a mile ...

A 42 that is not a clock time — survives the 4:02/5:26 elimination.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapledge, ~Jan 2026 (u/DesertCloak)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i155

What are 'double arcs'? Candidates that are literal shapes, not place names: a HEART (two arcs — 'a place that's dear to my heart', Heart Lake in the safe combination, a hunt dedicated to four dead, lovers' carvings on rock); ...

Heart Lake, from the Netflix safe, is 'heart' twice.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i215

Mysterious Writings, 'Top 10 New Clues Found in Beyond the Map's Edge' (running list): (1) the book cover's torn outline matches the Big Hole River watershed, river through mountains; (2) hardcover-only images on pp. 4 and 117 → ...

42 on the Alaska inset as a latitude floor: above 42°N. Every standing site on the board is above it; the Moab corridor (38.6°) is not.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack — Top 10 New Clues (via search summary)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i107

Alaska — the minority position (one Substack writer). Alaska appears on Posey's map and Hawaii does not; the Alaska section carries nine labeled peaks with elevations, more than any other state, and ordering them by height yields ...

The peak ordering is another route to 42.

Community claim · Disputed · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

L02 Flowing through each measured rhyme?

11 facts · 0 against

SUPPORTS · w2 · i041

Intentional differences between hardcover and digital, and he said the differences hold insights. Hardcover has two more images than digital, on pages 4 and 117. Page 90 does not exist — pages run 89 to 91 inside chapter 9. Page ...

'Measured rhyme' — page numbers 4, 90, 117, 156 are candidates for the measure.

Book text · Confirmed · Beyond the Map's Edge (hardcover)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i218

VERIFIED from the poem text: 'Hole' is the 42nd word (Can-you-find-what-lives-in-time = 7; +5 = 12; +5 = 17; +8 = 25; +6 = 31; +5 = 36; Round-the-bend-past-the = 41; Hole = 42). 42 is confirmed relevant by Posey. The only ...

'Measured rhyme' — counting words is the measure.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Poem word count (verified by Claude) — flagged by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i006

Asked at Seekers Summit whether the poem needs to be read or rearranged in any way other than as presented: 'I'm not going to rule that out.'

'Measured rhyme' invites counting or re-ordering.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i010

Numbers are indirectly associated with the poem (wordplay, hidden in words) — confirmed yes; declined to address homophones specifically. There IS a distance element in following the clues.

'Measured rhyme' — counting produces the indirect numbers.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i117

Poem structure. Asked whether the poem is linear, several geographic points miles apart, or a hybrid, he declined — then offered that there are some great movies out there: Indiana Jones and National Treasure. Read as a nudge ...

Measured rhyme as the assembly instructions.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A (via user research)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i214

Numbers in the materials (hub): 42 (truck, Hitchhiker's), 4:19 clock, 17 steps (Brandon counting Shadow Feet the raccoon), 18–20 keys on the rancher's ring, 1979 (wedding photo), 113 (117–4), 6.73 mi, 111 (explicitly ...

The measured numbers in play.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w1 · i064

Stanza 1 reading: 'time' literally (clock, date, hours); 'measured rhyme' = counting words, syllables, positions; 1:3 and 5:3 are the poem's only two em dashes — a pairing that brackets the poem.

Counting method.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w2 · i103

Wisdom/Big Hole supporting reads: 'what lives in time' and 'flowing through each measured rhyme' as the river itself, each clue a point along it, with 'like a river's steady flow' closing the loop in stanza 5. The cover's torn ...

Clues as measured points along the river.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i113

Stanza 5, reading 4 — callback to stanza 1 (weighted highest). 'What lives in time' opens the poem; 'what you seek, you already know' closes it. A river is a standard answer to what lives in time and flows through measure. The ...

Flowing through measured rhyme — the river runs through the poem's structure.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i143

The map as a time anchor. Read the book's map not as modern geography but as a historical lens: place names changed, rivers and creeks were relabeled, section lines drawn later, towns existed before boundaries were final. The map ...

Measured rhyme — the map's measurements belong to a period.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i146

Mountains and measurement: Mount Shasta was widely held to be California's highest peak in the 1850s–early 1860s; on July 6, 1864 the California Geological Survey named Mount Whitney the highest in California and the contiguous ...

Measured rhyme — elevations and prominences as the measure.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

L03 Wisdom waits in shadowed sight—

20 facts · 1 against

SUPPORTS · w3 · i164

VERIFIED — Lewis named the Big Hole River the 'Wisdom' on Aug 6 1805 (with the Philanthropy, now the Ruby) for Jefferson's virtues; fur trappers later renamed it the Big Hole, 'hole' being their word for a mountain valley. The ...

Wisdom is the Big Hole River's original name — an old-map name waiting under the new one.

Book text · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i200

Vantage point: 'There is a vantage point mentioned in your grandfather's memoir — did you incorporate that?' → 'There is a vantage point involved. But it's not that any of the clues are necessarily talking about that vantage ...

'Shadowed sight' — a sight line from a vantage point.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i009

One cipher exists, plus one hint he describes as 'somewhat technical'; neither is critical to the solution. Asked whether the cipher sits in one section of the book or spans several: 'Who says the cipher is in the book?'

'Shadowed sight' — something hidden in plain view.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i149

Territories as they stood before statehood (a period table for the map): California unorganized 1848 → state 1850 (31st); Oregon Terr. 1848 → 1859 (33rd); Utah Terr. 1850 → 1896 (45th); New Mexico Terr. 1850 → 1912 (47th); ...

Montana Territory: May 26, 1864. Nevada statehood: October 31, 1864. Two 1864 events on the map's own year.

Book text · Likely · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i183

Book gazetteer, per the hub: places named in the memoir — Dillon, Big Hole Valley, Beaverhead Valley, Wisdom (in the Grasshopper Valley chapter), Polaris MT (explicitly named), Pioneer Mountains, Crystal Park, Bannack, Blacktail ...

Wisdom is in the book, in the Grasshopper Valley chapter.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i208

Book verbatim, structure: chapters Seinfeld-style. Named: The Gracie Grail (Gracie's Antiques, Dillon — 'an arched entryway crowned with brick', 'the iron gate seemed to politely suggest this place had boundaries', a door that ...

'With wisdom as your compass.'

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w1 · i211

Book geography verbatim: 'the Big Hole's crystal waters'; Grasshopper Valley 'flanked by the Big Hole Valley'; 'At night, the sky in Grasshopper Valley is so star-spangled... thumbing through your mental Rolodex for ...

Binoculars and faraway views — sight.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i240

Against reading the haystack swap as a pointer: he removed the word, and an omission has no direction — 'he avoided it because it gives the place away' and 'because it is irrelevant' are equally available. 'Football field' may be ...

The haystack swap does not point anywhere

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026

SUPPORTS · w2 · i064

Stanza 1 reading: 'time' literally (clock, date, hours); 'measured rhyme' = counting words, syllables, positions; 1:3 and 5:3 are the poem's only two em dashes — a pairing that brackets the poem.

One of two em dashes.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w2 · i087

Community (Southwest Montana cluster): Polaris, Montana — a town named for the North Star, Beaverhead County — as 'his realm'; Beaverhead Rock near Twin Bridges (the landmark Sacagawea recognised as home) as the bride; the ...

'Wisdom waits' as a literal place name.

Community claim · Unverified · Southwest Montana tourism blog — via web search summary; Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w3 · i102

Wisdom, Montana / Big Hole Valley — the community's dominant theory since launch week. 'Wisdom waits in shadowed sight' = the town of Wisdom in the Big Hole Valley. 'Past the Hole' with a capital H = the Big Hole River or Valley; ...

A literal place name for 'Wisdom', in the same valley as the Hole.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i104

Polaris, Montana companion: 'in ursa east' = Polaris, the North Star in Ursa Minor, married to the town of Polaris on the Pioneer Scenic Byway in the Beaverhead; the bride is then a north-star location on the map. Supporters cite ...

Heron Lake as a 'north star' motif in the book (p. 33).

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i105

Wyoming / Sweetwater — the most complete published line-by-line (TreasureNet, Apr 2026). Starts from the site's legal disclaimer specifying Wyoming law governs the property; claims the site logo traces Utah's northeast corner. ...

Dawn shadow reading.

Community claim · Unverified · TreasureNet full walkthrough, Apr 2026 — via user research

SUPPORTS · w3 · i111

Stanza 5, reading 2 — structural bookend. 5:3 carries the second of only two em dashes in the poem; the first is 1:3. Same position, third line, in the two stanzas that are not location clues. If the cipher has a frame, those two ...

The opening bracket — same line position, same mark.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i144

Time-warp anomalies on the map: Wyoming was part of Dakota Territory until 1868 (no Wyoming Territory yet in 1864). Salem, Oregon is missing (fixed in the errata) — and Salem was only confirmed as Oregon's capital in 1864. ...

Washington/Montana 42nd is a hidden 42 that the 4:02/5:26 elimination does not touch.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i158

New composite — Gates of the Mountains / Sleeping Giant / Beartooth (Helena, MT). The Gates of the Mountains on the Missouri is the most literal 'ancient gates' in the West (Lewis & Clark, 1805). The ridge north of Helena called ...

Wisdom on the Big Hole feeds the same river.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i184

Hub theories for the gates and bride: Storm Lake Pass on the Continental Divide (Anaconda-Pintler, above the Big Hole) as the 'gate'; Beaverhead Rock; Queener Mountain (queen = bride) in the Big Hole area; Bridal Veil Falls / ...

Wisdom shadowed by its mountains — a literal 'shadowed sight'.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary

SUPPORTS · w3 · i217

Cross-reference on the Twin Bridges reading: at Twin Bridges, Montana the Big Hole, the Beaverhead and the Ruby join to form the Jefferson. Lewis named those three forks in 1805 for Jefferson's virtues — Wisdom (Big Hole), ...

The Wisdom River (Big Hole) ends here.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i221

MW Sep 8 2025 — word notes on 2:3–2:4. 'Round the bend': is 'Round' a name? Bend, Oregon (now eliminated); the Tucker poem p. 213 'took half my soul around the bend'; p. 149 'Tucker and Jennie rounded the bend'; p. 177 'Rounding ...

A pole's shadow is a shadowed sight — 1:3 and 2:4 may be one instrument.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text

SUPPORTS · w1 · i239

Haystack theory: in the Netflix documentary Posey said 'needle in a football field' instead of 'needle in a haystack'; the Big Hole Valley around Wisdom is called the land of 10,000 haystacks. Community inference — Posey has ...

Land of 10,000 haystacks around Wisdom, MT

Community claim · Unverified · Community inference (session notes Sep 6 2026)

L04 For those who read these words just right.

23 facts · 2 against

SUPPORTS · w1 · i005

All essential clues are in the poem, free on treasure.quest. Five stanzas of four lines. At least 10 clues. Clues are in consecutive order, top to bottom (confirmed in website announcements).

Consecutive order is itself a reading rule.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest announcements

SUPPORTS · w1 · i192

'Virtually every line in the poem is helpful. So just because as hope surges is the first actionable clue, doesn't mean people should discount the earlier lines. They are helpful context.' (X Dark Matters). 'Is the poem an ...

The poem is a map.

Posey statement · Confirmed · X Dark Matters — Sep 4 2025 (JIBLE)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i195

Cipher solved and confirmed: MAGYAR (April 2026) — Hungarian; Tucker was a Vizsla, a Hungarian breed. 'The cipher is more than anything a nod to what the container is' (Sandal). Not in the poem, not in the book ('Who says the ...

Stanza 1 is not the cipher.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i197

Rearrangement and reading: 'Does the poem need to be read or rearranged other than as presented?' → 'I'm not going to rule that out.' Thematic vs literal → 'Probably roughly both in equal measure.' Anagrams → 'I haven't ...

Both literal and thematic, and a non-linear read is not ruled out.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i201

Layer 5: 'It is true to say that layer five has some bearing on the treasure hunt.' Undefined publicly — likely an audio/mix layer (the song) or a map layer. Ankh in the legal section: not a clue, though the ankh may matter ...

Layers to read just right.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i202

Two 'super obvious' Netflix hints: 'It's either episode two or three. It is a scene that does not have me in it. But it was a scene that I had some control over. If you rewatch it, it'll be pretty obvious.' (Dillon). By 9/27/25 ...

Series → book → poem.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Dillon Q&A — Jun 21 2025 (THAP / JIBLE)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i207

Logo: 'the angzarr symbol — I chose and modified it intentionally' (X Dark Matters). Angzarr is the Unicode glyph ₮ (U+237C, 'right angle with downwards zigzag arrow'), a symbol with no known origin — a right angle plus a zigzag ...

The logo is a thing to read.

Posey statement · Confirmed · X Dark Matters — Sep 4 2025 (JIBLE)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i006

Asked at Seekers Summit whether the poem needs to be read or rearranged in any way other than as presented: 'I'm not going to rule that out.'

'Read these words just right' may mean a non-linear reading — column, count, or rearrangement.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i009

One cipher exists, plus one hint he describes as 'somewhat technical'; neither is critical to the solution. Asked whether the cipher sits in one section of the book or spans several: 'Who says the cipher is in the book?'

Stanza 1 reads as the reading rule — the cipher may live in the poem itself, not the book.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i044

Audiobook Acknowledgements add a sentence: the difference between reality and fantasy is not a wall but a map waiting to be drawn.

'Read these words just right' — the map is to be drawn from the words.

Book text · Likely · Audiobook vs hardcover comparison

SUPPORTS · w1 · i098

X Marks the Pod (Sep 2025): searchers are 'quite close'; the map is useful 'for a couple different reasons'; the BTME logo was intentionally designed to hold meaning. treasure.quest was changed on July 27, 2026 (details not captured).

The logo is another thing to 'read just right'.

Posey statement · Likely · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i117

Poem structure. Asked whether the poem is linear, several geographic points miles apart, or a hybrid, he declined — then offered that there are some great movies out there: Indiana Jones and National Treasure. Read as a nudge ...

'Read these words just right' — assembly, not a walk.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A (via user research)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i137

The container is a Saddleback Leather 16-inch 'Grandfather' briefcase, about 60 lb loaded — not a chest. Contents: PAMP Suisse kilo gold bars, gold flakes and dust, coins across eras, large loose emeralds, rubies and amethysts, ...

Undercuts the MAGYAR-means-chest cipher reading — the container is a leather briefcase.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i140

Rules restated in the report: no specialized knowledge needed; no dangerous water crossings; not associated with any structure; accessible 24/7 with no fee (the report reads this as likely excluding fee-entry National Parks); ...

Netflix hints guide the book, the book guides the poem — a chain, and the poem is the last link.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i147

Posey on the map: 'I chose the landmarks to be labeled, but the map was designed by a third party. Any incorrect names, positions, and elevations are not intentional.' Read carefully: the SELECTION of labeled landmarks is his; ...

The list of labeled landmarks is a curated list — read it as such.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey (quoted in user research)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i209

Book verbatim, motifs: dedication 'thank you for being my north star'; 'Like four points of a compass, I've dedicated this treasure to four departed souls' (book order is authoritative, per Justin); Prologue opens 'Grid searching ...

Between the lines of the acknowledgments — read just right.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w1 · i092

Community: the cipher was solved on the MW Discord (Mooshee85 and Rose) — it reads MAGYAR. It is not in the poem and is a nod to the container, read as hinting the container is a CHEST. Not needed for the solve.

Confirms the cipher lives outside the poem; stanza 1 is not the cipher.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i103

Wisdom/Big Hole supporting reads: 'what lives in time' and 'flowing through each measured rhyme' as the river itself, each clue a point along it, with 'like a river's steady flow' closing the loop in stanza 5. The cover's torn ...

Cover outline and cut-off M as things to read just right.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i105

Wyoming / Sweetwater — the most complete published line-by-line (TreasureNet, Apr 2026). Starts from the site's legal disclaimer specifying Wyoming law governs the property; claims the site logo traces Utah's northeast corner. ...

The logo tracing Utah's NE corner is a Utah pointer hiding in a Wyoming solve — worth checking independently.

Community claim · Unverified · TreasureNet full walkthrough, Apr 2026 — via user research

SUPPORTS · w1 · i111

Stanza 5, reading 2 — structural bookend. 5:3 carries the second of only two em dashes in the poem; the first is 1:3. Same position, third line, in the two stanzas that are not location clues. If the cipher has a frame, those two ...

Frame as the thing you must 'read just right'.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i143

The map as a time anchor. Read the book's map not as modern geography but as a historical lens: place names changed, rivers and creeks were relabeled, section lines drawn later, towns existed before boundaries were final. The map ...

'Read these words just right' — read the map in its own period, not ours.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i148

Alaska as legend or key rather than location. 1825: Treaty of Saint Petersburg set a vague Russia–Britain boundary; 1867: the US bought Alaska with that boundary undefined. Alaska stands apart on the map and may function as the ...

Alaska as the key you read the rest by.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i215

Mysterious Writings, 'Top 10 New Clues Found in Beyond the Map's Edge' (running list): (1) the book cover's torn outline matches the Big Hole River watershed, river through mountains; (2) hardcover-only images on pp. 4 and 117 → ...

Background books in the documentary as a reading list.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack – Top 10 New Clues (via search summary)

L05 As hope surges, clear and bright,

23 facts · 1 against

SUPPORTS · w2 · i022

Aug 1 2025: several searchers have solved at least the first two clues, and some have been within 200 feet of the checkpoint. Zero searchers have sent him a photo of the correct checkpoint. The checkpoint is not visible in Gold & Greed.

The first two clues (2:1, 2:2) are being solved correctly by multiple people.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Posey on X, Aug 1 2025

SUPPORTS · w3 · i163

VERIFIED — Sinks Canyon, Lander WY: the Middle Fork of the Popo Agie disappears into a limestone cavern ('the Sinks') and reappears about a quarter mile downstream at 'the Rise', a clear pool of huge trout, after ~2 hours ...

The Rise: water surging up out of the ground, clear and bright, full of fish.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i205

Progress verbatim: 'Certainly the first stanza... at least a large portion, been solved. The second stanza, at least half of it' (9/4/25). 'Part of stanza 3 solved'; 'at least six clues' by the most-advanced searcher; 'people less ...

Stanza 1 and half of stanza 2 are solved by the crowd — whatever 2:1–2:2 are, they are findable.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson – Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i220

MW Sep 8 2025 — Posey's X post: Stanza 1 and 'at least PART of stanza 2' solved (the interview said 'half'; Jenny notes part ≠ half — a word or phrase, not a sentence). Searchers don't know without doubt until the checkpoint; ...

Part of stanza 2 is solved — 2:1 at least.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Posey on X, ~Sep 5 2025 (via MW)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i013

First actionable clue: 'As hope surges, clear and bright' (2:1). Last actionable clue: stanza four or five, depending on interpretation.

The starting point is this line. Everything before it is method.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i017

'How far from the first clue to the last in miles' — he called this impossible to answer given how the clues are structured.

First-to-last is not a straight line — the route may fold back, or use a bearing rather than a path.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i211

Book geography verbatim: 'the Big Hole's crystal waters'; Grasshopper Valley 'flanked by the Big Hole Valley'; 'At night, the sky in Grasshopper Valley is so star-spangled... thumbing through your mental Rolodex for ...

Oxygen-rich water flowing into Clark Canyon — a surge.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w3 · i053

Matrimony Spring at the junction of US-191 and SR-128 north of Moab: cold, clear, flows 365 days a year, likely sourced from the La Sals ~30 miles southeast. Local legend: couples who drink from it marry; drinking marries you to ...

Clear, bright, surging water at the start of the route.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w1 · i054

The spring's outflow is piped through a culvert under SR-128 into the Colorado — the water in 2:1 physically becomes the water in 2:2. North on 191, cross the Colorado on the highway bridge; SR-279 branches left about two miles ...

The spring feeds the river.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w1 · i112

Stanza 5, reading 3 — literal river. 'Like a river's steady flow' confirms that a river runs through the whole solve, naming the thread rather than adding a clue. The Big Hole camp uses this; so does the Colorado read. Under this ...

The route is water from the first clue on.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i119

Reddit (u/GreenEyes7141018, 13 up / 48 comments): what if the hunt is like National Treasure — each stanza is one location, and at that location is a clue giving the next. Offered to explain two Posey quotes: 'the key to one ...

Stanza 2 as location one.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/GreenEyes7141018)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i129

Granite Creek / Jackson Hole, Wyoming. 'The Hole' capitalized reads as Jackson Hole, and Posey called the hole-in-the-name question on the nose rather than shutting it down. Granite Hot Springs sits up Granite Creek off the ...

A hot spring surging clear in a drainage named Granite.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i129

Granite Creek / Jackson Hole, Wyoming. 'The Hole' capitalized reads as Jackson Hole, and Posey called the hole-in-the-name question on the nose rather than shutting it down. Granite Hot Springs sits up Granite Creek off the ...

The pool itself is man-made — fine as a waypoint, not as a hunt item.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i130

Pioneer Mountains, Montana — the Wisdom theory run through Polaris instead of the town. Elkhorn Hot Springs supplies the surge, Polaris supplies ursa and the north star, the Big Hole River supplies the fishing and the Hole. The ...

Elkhorn Hot Springs as the surge.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i157

New composite — Thermopolis / Wind River Canyon / Wedding of the Waters (WY). Big Spring in Hot Springs State Park: the world's largest mineral hot spring, surging, free, 24/7 ('hope surges, clear and bright'). Wind River Canyon ...

Big Spring: a hot spring that surges, free and open.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i161

Posey's Fenn search footprint, as compiled by the community: the epicenter was the west and north sides of Yellowstone — the Madison River corridor including Nine Mile Hole (Fenn's favorite fishing spot) and Madison Junction ...

Ojo Caliente, Boiling River, Iron Springs: he searched warm water for Fenn — 'hope surges, clear and bright' as a spring is in character.

Community claim · Unverified · Google AI overview citing Reddit r/JustinPoseysTreasure + Mysterious Writings (machine summary — verify)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i162

Cross-reference on the footprint: the free / 24-7 / dogs gate puts the site outside the park, but the Fenn epicenter is the park's west and north edges. The overlap is the ring of national forest just outside: Hebgen Lake and the ...

Big Springs surges gin-clear from the ground.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i176

Scan result — Blue Hole, Santa Rosa NM: a bell-shaped artesian sinkhole, 3,000 gal/min, 62°F, crystal clear, tied to the Pecos; north of the Santa Fe cutoff. Against: a city dive park with structures and a grate; no granite, no ...

Surges clear and bright.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i177

Scan result — Big Springs / Henry's Fork (Island Park, ID): 120 million gallons a day of crystal-clear 52°F water; fishing prohibited at the spring, great below; free national forest, dogs; Upper and Lower Mesa Falls downstream; ...

Surge.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i188

Fenn footprint per Treasure Among Us: Madison Junction, Nine Mile Hole, Hebgen Lake, Yellowstone, SINKS CANYON, Grand Teton, San Juan Mountains. If accurate, Sinks Canyon (Lander, WY) was itself a Posey Fenn-search location — the ...

Sinks Canyon is in his own Fenn footprint.

Community claim · Unverified · Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i212

Hub community theories (all speculation): Hope Creek NE of Wisdom in the Anaconda-Pintler ('hope surges'); Lamar / Trout Creek; the Hidden Lake / Queener Mountain BOTG solve (Storm Lake Pass = gates, Queener = bride, triangular ...

Hope Creek by name.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w1 · i223

Heron Lake, New Mexico (Rio Arriba County, ~36.7°N — north of the Santa Fe cutoff; 7,200 ft; a reservoir that the old-map theory would omit). In the book: p. 33 'Heron Lake being our north star', the lost-pole story ('I wait for ...

Ojo Caliente's warm surge 25 miles south.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude) from MW + book references

SUPPORTS · w2 · i242

Sister Superior solve (Castle Valley, Moab): the Rectory ridge runs Castleton Tower, the Rectory, the Priest and Nuns, Sister Superior, the Convent — a nun is a bride of Christ. Gates = the valley mouth flanked by the Rectory ...

Matrimony Spring heads the SR-128 naming chain

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — working solve

L06 Walk near waters' silent flight.**19 facts · 4 against****SUPPORTS · w2 · i022**

Aug 1 2025: several searchers have solved at least the first two clues, and some have been within 200 feet of the checkpoint. Zero searchers have sent him a photo of the correct checkpoint. The checkpoint is not visible in Gold & Greed.

Same — 2:2 is solvable and has been solved.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Posey on X, Aug 1 2025

SUPPORTS · w3 · i163

VERIFIED — Sinks Canyon, Lander WY: the Middle Fork of the Popo Agie disappears into a limestone cavern ('the Sinks') and reappears about a quarter mile downstream at 'the Rise', a clear pool of huge trout, after ~2 hours ...

Between the Rise and the Sinks the river is underground — water in silent flight, and the two are a quarter-mile walk apart, exactly Posey's 'walking distance from 2:2 to 2:3'.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i204

Site verbatim: 'a place that is important to me, and a place that I've known about for quite some time'; meaningful for beauty, symbolism AND sentiment ('all of the above'); 'physical objects along the way — fair to say there ...

BLM dirt road access.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i210

Tucker poem (p. 213, Mountain Memory) — confirmed helpful: 'Tucker, once my earthly friend, / Took half my soul around the bend'; 'In the mountain's hushed solitude, where the air is crisp and the trees stand in silent reverence, ...

'Trees stand in silent reverence' — silence at the water.

Book text · Confirmed · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w3 · i015

It is walking distance from 'waters' silent flight' through 'round the bend, past the Hole.'

2:2 and 2:3 are close together on the ground.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i069

Direction of travel: nothing in 2:2 specifies bank, downstream, or the choice of SR-279 over SR-128, which also follows the Colorado from the same junction. The turn onto 279 is currently chosen retroactively by the destination.

The line does not pick the road; the destination does.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Master file §12 — constraints to reconcile

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i140

Rules restated in the report: no specialized knowledge needed; no dangerous water crossings; not associated with any structure; accessible 24/7 with no fee (the report reads this as likely excluding fee-entry National Parks); ...

No dangerous water crossings: any reading that fords a river to reach the site is out.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i054

The spring's outflow is piped through a culvert under SR-128 into the Colorado — the water in 2:1 physically becomes the water in 2:2. North on 191, cross the Colorado on the highway bridge; SR-279 branches left about two miles ...

Continuity of water from 2:1 to 2:2.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w2 · i055

The Colorado River along SR-279 (Potash Road) is 'waters' silent flight' — a big, quiet river moving through the canyon.

Silent, flowing water you walk near.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w1 · i099

Netflix interview backdrop: Posey sits in front of computer wallpapers (identified as Lake Louise, Colorado, Wyoming, and Utah near the Colorado River) under a giant clock. Searchers treat the wallpapers and clock as the hidden ...

A Utah / Colorado River wallpaper puts the Potash corridor on screen.

Community claim · Unverified · Moviedelic Netflix-clue roundup — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i105

Wyoming / Sweetwater — the most complete published line-by-line (TreasureNet, Apr 2026). Starts from the site's legal disclaimer specifying Wyoming law governs the property; claims the site logo traces Utah's northeast corner. ...

Sweetwater as the water.

Community claim · Unverified · TreasureNet full walkthrough, Apr 2026 — via user research

SUPPORTS · w2 · i112

Stanza 5, reading 3 — literal river. 'Like a river's steady flow' confirms that a river runs through the whole solve, naming the thread rather than adding a clue. The Big Hole camp uses this; so does the Colorado read. Under this ...

Retro-confirms 'waters' silent flight' as a river you stayed with.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i126

Checks on Bear Lodge from what I know, unverified on the ground: Devils Tower National Monument charges an entrance fee and the rock is phonolite porphyry, not granite; the Belle Fourche River bends past the base ('waters' silent ...

The Belle Fourche bends around the tower.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i129

Granite Creek / Jackson Hole, Wyoming. 'The Hole' capitalized reads as Jackson Hole, and Posey called the hole-in-the-name question on the nose rather than shutting it down. Granite Hot Springs sits up Granite Creek off the ...

Granite Creek / Hoback as the water.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i129

Granite Creek / Jackson Hole, Wyoming. 'The Hole' capitalized reads as Jackson Hole, and Posey called the hole-in-the-name question on the nose rather than shutting it down. Granite Hot Springs sits up Granite Creek off the ...

Long gravel road; check standard-car access.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i145

Where are the dams? Major reservoirs are missing from the map though obvious on any modern sheet: Hoover / Lake Mead, Glen Canyon / Lake Powell, Fort Peck, Oroville, Grand Coulee. Rivers are drawn as if never dammed — pre-dam cartography.

'Waters' silent flight' on a river as it ran before the dams — the map's water, not today's.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i157

New composite — Thermopolis / Wind River Canyon / Wedding of the Waters (WY). Big Spring in Hot Springs State Park: the world's largest mineral hot spring, surging, free, 24/7 ('hope surges, clear and bright'). Wind River Canyon ...

Owl Creek Mountains — silent flight, by name.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i158

New composite — Gates of the Mountains / Sleeping Giant / Beartooth (Helena, MT). The Gates of the Mountains on the Missouri is the most literal 'ancient gates' in the West (Lewis & Clark, 1805). The ridge north of Helena called ...

Wisdom → Three Forks → Gates is ~150 river miles; only works if stanzas 1–3 are worked from the map.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i162

Cross-reference on the footprint: the free / 24-7 / dogs gate puts the site outside the park, but the Fenn epicenter is the park's west and north edges. The overlap is the ring of national forest just outside: Hebgen Lake and the ...

Henry's Fork below the spring — silent water.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

L07 Round the bend, past the Hole,

47 facts · 18 against

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i001

Hunt Items (the treasure, the checkpoint and any placed clue) are NOT underwater, on private property, in caves, mines or tunnels, anywhere that needs rappelling, associated with man-made buildings, near graves or grave markers, ...

A culvert is tunnel-shaped. The Hole reading has to argue it is a route feature you pass, not a place a hunt item sits.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest official rules

SUPPORTS · w3 · i163

VERIFIED — Sinks Canyon, Lander WY: the Middle Fork of the Popo Agie disappears into a limestone cavern ('the Sinks') and reappears about a quarter mile downstream at 'the Rise', a clear pool of huge trout, after ~2 hours ...

The Sinks is a natural Hole, capital-H on every map, and not man-made.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i164

VERIFIED — Lewis named the Big Hole River the 'Wisdom' on Aug 6 1805 (with the Philanthropy, now the Ruby) for Jefferson's virtues; fur trappers later renamed it the Big Hole, 'hole' being their word for a mountain valley. The ...

The same river is the Hole; 1:3 and 2:3 name one river twice.

Book text · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i210

Tucker poem (p. 213, Mountain Memory) — confirmed helpful: 'Tucker, once my earthly friend, / Took half my soul around the bend'; 'In the mountain's hushed solitude, where the air is crisp and the trees stand in silent reverence, ...

'Around the bend' is Tucker's crossing — the poem's bend is a river bend AND the passage beyond.

Book text · Confirmed · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w3 · i218

VERIFIED from the poem text: 'Hole' is the 42nd word (Can-you-find-what-lives-in-time = 7; +5 = 12; +5 = 17; +8 = 25; +6 = 31; +5 = 36; Round-the-bend-past-the = 41; Hole = 42). 42 is confirmed relevant by Posey. The only ...

42 → the Hole. The number Posey confirmed lands on the line the community has 'solved'.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Poem word count (verified by Claude) — flagged by Mysterious Writings

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i220

MW Sep 8 2025 — Posey's X post: Stanza 1 and 'at least PART of stanza 2' solved (the interview said 'half'; Jenny notes part ≠ half — a word or phrase, not a sentence). Searchers don't know without doubt until the checkpoint; ...

'Part', not 'half': the Hole may not be among the solved words after all.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Posey on X, ~Sep 5 2025 (via MW)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i015

It is walking distance from 'waters' silent flight' through 'round the bend, past the Hole.'

The Hole is within a walk of the water.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i016

'No need to hike more than a mile to figure out where the treasure is at.' Searchers note this is not the same as 'to find it'.

The walk from the water past the Hole is under a mile.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

CONTRADICTS · w3 · i032

The Hole carries no man-made implication — a direct 'no' at Seekers Summit. Punted on whether it corresponds to a place with 'hole' in its name (Jackson Hole, Big Hole River): 'an on the nose question.'

The culvert reading requires this 'no' to be misleading. A natural hole, or a place-name Hole, fits the answer.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i070

Derivation order: the solve was built outward from Jeep Arch rather than forward from the poem. Stanza 5 explicitly warns against tangled, twisted finds.

The Hole was chosen because Jeep Arch was already the target.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Master file §12 – constraints to reconcile

CONTRADICTS · w3 · i101

Dillon: the entire hunt is based on naturally occurring structures and landscapes; depending which of the multiple solution paths you take, one clue has a man-made implication. He confirmed there are multiple valid ways to solve ...

A culvert is a man-made route feature in a hunt built on natural landscape.

Posey statement · Likely · Dillon, MT Q&A (Jun 21 2025) – via user research

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i117

Poem structure. Asked whether the poem is linear, several geographic points miles apart, or a hybrid, he declined — then offered that there are some great movies out there: Indiana Jones and National Treasure. Read as a nudge ...

Weakens any reading that needs a strict walking chain from the water past the Hole to the site.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A (via user research)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i123

Reddit (u/Theroguehippie1): reread the question he was asked. The 'not more than a mile' answer was about distance from your car to figure out where the treasure is — it says nothing about whether the clues convey distances at ...

Corrects an over-read: the under-a-mile figure is car-to-vantage, not water-to-Hole. Clue-to-clue distance is still unconstrained.

Objection / constraint · Likely · r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/Theroguehippie1)

CONTRADICTS · w3 · i134

Cross-reference: the capital-H Hole is the single most discriminating fact on the board. Posey gave a direct 'no' to a man-made Hole and called the place-name question on the nose. Every solve that survives that pair has a ...

The Moab stanza-2 has no Hole that survives the two Posey statements.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i134

Cross-reference: the capital-H Hole is the single most discriminating fact on the board. Posey gave a direct 'no' to a man-made Hole and called the place-name question on the nose. Every solve that survives that pair has a ...

Jackson Hole, Big Hole and Baker's Hole all do.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i183

Book gazetteer, per the hub: places named in the memoir — Dillon, Big Hole Valley, Beaverhead Valley, Wisdom (in the Grasshopper Valley chapter), Polaris MT (explicitly named), Pioneer Mountains, Crystal Park, Bannack, Blacktail ...

Big Hole Valley named.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i222

MW Sep 8 2025 — 'The Bronze Beast' chapter (Tucker, Novelty Hill, Washington state) is laced with Hitchhiker's Guide allusions: 'quietly contemplate the meaning of life', 'decode the secrets of the universe', 'solved the world's ...

Everything 42 points at the 42nd word.

Book text · Likely · Mysterious Writings Substack – 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text

SUPPORTS · w2 · i235

Tucker thread: Posey's Vizsla Tucker, trained by hide-and-seek on trails, appears throughout the Netflix documentary; the dog illustrated beneath the treasure poem in the book is a Vizsla. The memorial poem 'Mountain Memory' (p. ...

'Around the bend' appears in the Tucker poem

Book text · Likely · Beyond the Map's Edge p. 213 'Mountain Memory' + Netflix (session notes Sep 6 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i056

The canyon bend, then the large culvert on the Gold Bar approach to Jeep Arch, is 'round the bend, past the Hole.' Argument: Posey's exclusion language is 'man-made buildings', which leaves a culvert available as a passable route feature.

A literal bend then a literal hole on the approach to the arch.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w1 · i072

Ask: Does the Hole refer to something you pass through?

Would settle the culvert reading.

Question to ask · Unverified · Master file §13 — open questions

SUPPORTS · w2 · i087

Community (Southwest Montana cluster): Polaris, Montana — a town named for the North Star, Beaverhead County — as 'his realm'; Beaverhead Rock near Twin Bridges (the landmark Sacagawea recognised as home) as the bride; the ...

The Big Hole River is the most-cited 'Hole' outside Utah.

Community claim · Unverified · Southwest Montana tourism blog — via web search summary; Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i088

Community: Big Hole River as 'the Hole' and 'cast your pole' as fishing. Posey punted on whether the Hole is a place with 'hole' in its name (Jackson Hole, Big Hole), calling it 'an on the nose question' — which searchers read as ...

A natural, named Hole satisfies the direct 'not man-made'.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i089

Community: Hole 'N The Rock, the roadside attraction south of Moab in San Juan County, as 'the Hole'; Corona and Bowtie Arch west of Moab as the 'double arcs' — the most-cited Utah reading online.

Hole 'N The Rock is man-made (a blasted home) and a commercial attraction — fails the direct 'no'.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i090

Full solve (Justin Greer, Jul 2026): Madison River, West Yellowstone. Start at Baker's Hole ('the Hole'), follow the Boundary Trail near the water, round the bend, face east toward the Madison Valley. The Three Brothers peaks ...

Baker's Hole — a named natural Hole on the water.

Community claim · Unverified · Justin Greer, 'The Treasure I Found Along the Madison — A Full Solve' (Jul 31 2026) — via web search summary

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i095

Community (fringe, Arizona): the Birthing Cave near Sedona (a half-spherical hole) as the Hole; Woo Ranch at the base of Bear Mountain ('ursa') in an alcove next to the Palatki Heritage Site — 'beyond the map's edge' of the ...

A cave is a rule-excluded location for hunt items.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w3 · i102

Wisdom, Montana / Big Hole Valley — the community's dominant theory since launch week. 'Wisdom waits in shadowed sight' = the town of Wisdom in the Big Hole Valley. 'Past the Hole' with a capital H = the Big Hole River or Valley; ...

The only capitalized common noun — a proper-noun Hole. Natural, so it survives the direct 'not man-made'.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i102

Wisdom, Montana / Big Hole Valley — the community's dominant theory since launch week. 'Wisdom waits in shadowed sight' = the town of Wisdom in the Big Hole Valley. 'Past the Hole' with a capital H = the Big Hole River or Valley; ...

Posey called 'is it a place with hole in its name' an on-the-nose question rather than answering.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i120

Reddit (u/PNW-OOTW, 9 up): Posey said in an interview that the poem isn't meant to convey a great distance.

Water → bend → Hole is short.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/PNW-OOTW)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i124

The structure probably isn't a walk. He wouldn't say whether the poem is linear or several points miles apart, then mentioned Indiana Jones and National Treasure — both about an object or device that reveals a location when ...

If stanza 3 is a construction, the stanza-2 walk does not need to lead physically into it — weakens Jeep Arch as a hinge.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i128

City of Rocks, Idaho (~42.07°N — the parallel the 42 clues point at). Actual granite, so 'granite bold' is literal. California Trail landmark where emigrants wrote their names on the rock in axle grease, still legible: secrets of ...

No Hole.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i129

Granite Creek / Jackson Hole, Wyoming. 'The Hole' capitalized reads as Jackson Hole, and Posey called the hole-in-the-name question on the nose rather than shutting it down. Granite Hot Springs sits up Granite Creek off the ...

A capital-H, proper-noun, natural Hole that Posey called on the nose.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i130

Pioneer Mountains, Montana — the Wisdom theory run through Polaris instead of the town. Elkhorn Hot Springs supplies the surge, Polaris supplies ursa and the north star, the Big Hole River supplies the fishing and the Hole. The ...

Big Hole: the capital-H Hole.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i131

Cross-reference: the Tetons are literally 'her' and literally 'three'. 'Les Trois Tétons' — the Grand, Middle and South Teton — were named by French trappers for a woman's breasts. 'Her foot of three' would then be the foot of ...

Jackson Hole as the Hole, one valley over.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i154

Checkpoint = the double arcs. Cross-referencing five statements: the checkpoint is something he placed AND something already there; it has 'some implication' of a topographic feature; the audiobook calls it 'carved in stone'; one ...

If 4:1 is the one man-made implication, the Hole cannot be another — the culvert is doubly dead.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i157

New composite — Thermopolis / Wind River Canyon / Wedding of the Waters (WY). Big Spring in Hot Springs State Park: the world's largest mineral hot spring, surging, free, 24/7 ('hope surges, clear and bright'). Wind River Canyon ...

No natural Hole found yet; the tunnels are man-made.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i158

New composite — Gates of the Mountains / Sleeping Giant / Beartooth (Helena, MT). The Gates of the Mountains on the Missouri is the most literal 'ancient gates' in the West (Lewis & Clark, 1805). The ridge north of Helena called ...

The Big Hole River, natural and capital-H.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i161

Posey's Fenn search footprint, as compiled by the community: the epicenter was the west and north sides of Yellowstone — the Madison River corridor including Nine Mile Hole (Fenn's favorite fishing spot) and Madison Junction ...

Nine Mile Hole and the Firehole: capital-H, natural Holes in his own Fenn country — though both sit inside the park.

Community claim · Unverified · Google AI overview citing Reddit r/JustinPoseysTreasure + Mysterious Writings (machine summary – verify)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i162

Cross-reference on the footprint: the free / 24-7 / dogs gate puts the site outside the park, but the Fenn epicenter is the park's west and north edges. The overlap is the ring of national forest just outside: Hebgen Lake and the ...

No Hole found on the Henry's Fork yet.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i174

Scan result — Hole-in-the-Wall (Kaycee, WY): a natural gap in the Red Wall, capital-H on every map; BLM, fee-free Outlaw Cave campground; Middle Fork Powder blue-ribbon; Rock Art Cave petroglyphs and an ancient cairn line. 'His ...

A capital-H natural Hole that is also a gate.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i175

Scan result — Provo Canyon / Timpanogos (UT): Bridal Veil Falls (free county park, dogs) is the maiden's tears in the Timpanogos legend; the mountain's skyline is her sleeping profile from the canyon — a named 'her face'. The ...

No Hole.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i176

Scan result — Blue Hole, Santa Rosa NM: a bell-shaped artesian sinkhole, 3,000 gal/min, 62°F, crystal clear, tied to the Pecos; north of the Santa Fe cutoff. Against: a city dive park with structures and a grate; no granite, no ...

A Hole by name.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i177

Scan result — Big Springs / Henry's Fork (Island Park, ID): 120 million gallons a day of crystal-clear 52°F water; fishing prohibited at the spring, great below; free national forest, dogs; Upper and Lower Mesa Falls downstream; ...

No Hole.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i180

Hub progress board: the Hole (2:3) is 'confirmed solved by the community'; the Bride (3:2) has been identified; at least 6 clues solved by the most-advanced searcher; part of stanza 3 solved; the technical clue solved by one ...

If the community has the Hole, it is a named natural place — the crowd's Big Hole reading is the one the hub counts as solved.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i216

Mysterious Writings, 'Justin Posey's Poem: Round the bend, past the Hole...' (Jenny Kile): the line read as a curve in the river and then past the Big Hole River; a specific theory places it where the Beaverhead and Big Hole flow ...

Past the Big Hole — where it ends, at the Jefferson.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack – 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (via search summary)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i216

Mysterious Writings, 'Justin Posey's Poem: Round the bend, past the Hole...' (Jenny Kile): the line read as a curve in the river and then past the Big Hole River; a specific theory places it where the Beaverhead and Big Hole flow ...

Bend as Tucker's 'after' — the line is a river bend and a passage.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (via search summary)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i217

Cross-reference on the Twin Bridges reading: at Twin Bridges, Montana the Big Hole, the Beaverhead and the Ruby join to form the Jefferson.

Lewis named those three forks in 1805 for Jefferson's virtues — Wisdom (Big Hole), ...

Past the Hole — past where the Big Hole ends.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i221

MW Sep 8 2025 — word notes on 2:3–2:4. 'Round the bend': is 'Round' a name? Bend, Oregon (now eliminated); the Tucker poem p. 213 'took half my soul around the bend'; p. 149 'Tucker and Jennie rounded the bend'; p. 177 'Rounding ...

Three 'bend' passages in the book, two of them fishing scenes with anglers across the water.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text

L08 I wait for you to cast your pole.

21 facts · 2 against

SUPPORTS · w2 · i163

VERIFIED — Sinks Canyon, Lander WY: the Middle Fork of the Popo Agie disappears into a limestone cavern ('the Sinks') and reappears about a quarter mile downstream at 'the Rise', a clear pool of huge trout, after ~2 hours ...

'I wait for you to cast your pole' — the pool of giant trout you may not fish; the poem's 'I' waits where you cannot cast.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i210

Tucker poem (p. 213, Mountain Memory) — confirmed helpful: 'Tucker, once my earthly friend, / Took half my soul around the bend'; 'In the mountain's hushed solitude, where the air is crisp and the trees stand in silent reverence, ...

'I cast my line into a babbling brook' in the mountain's hushed solitude — small water, not a big river.

Book text · Confirmed · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w1 · i034

Whether 'cast your pole' refers to a fishing pole: not specified.

Fishing is the plain reading but unconfirmed — a survey pole, a flagpole or a bearing 'pole' remain open.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i138

Posey's grandfather was reportedly a fish-and-game warden in Montana, where Posey spent summers exploring (one forum notes an obituary calling the grandfather a lifelong New Mexico resident). Community discussion says Posey owns ...

A fish-and-game warden's grandson casting a pole.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i235

Tucker thread: Posey's Vizsla Tucker, trained by hide-and-seek on trails, appears throughout the Netflix documentary; the dog illustrated beneath the treasure poem in the book is a Vizsla. The memorial poem 'Mountain Memory' (p. ...

Casting a line into a brook mirrors 'cast your pole'

Book text · Likely · Beyond the Map's Edge p. 213 'Mountain Memory' + Netflix (session notes Sep 6 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i087

Community (Southwest Montana cluster): Polaris, Montana — a town named for the North Star, Beaverhead County — as 'his realm'; Beaverhead Rock near Twin Bridges (the landmark Sacagawea recognised as home) as the bride; the ...

Blue-ribbon fly-fishing water for 'cast your pole'.

Community claim · Unverified · Southwest Montana tourism blog – via web search summary; Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) – via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i088

Community: Big Hole River as 'the Hole' and 'cast your pole' as fishing. Posey punted on whether the Hole is a place with 'hole' in its name (Jackson Hole, Big Hole), calling it 'an on the nose question' — which searchers read as ...

Fishing reading.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) – via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i105

Wyoming / Sweetwater — the most complete published line-by-line (TreasureNet, Apr 2026). Starts from the site's legal disclaimer specifying Wyoming law governs the property; claims the site logo traces Utah's northeast corner. ...

Legendary fishing ground for the pole.

Community claim · Unverified · TreasureNet full walkthrough, Apr 2026 – via user research

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i128

City of Rocks, Idaho (~42.07°N — the parallel the 42 clues point at). Actual granite, so 'granite bold' is literal. California Trail landmark where emigrants wrote their names on the rock in axle grease, still legible: secrets of ...

No fishing water to speak of.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i129

Granite Creek / Jackson Hole, Wyoming. 'The Hole' capitalized reads as Jackson Hole, and Posey called the hole-in-the-name question on the nose rather than shutting it down. Granite Hot Springs sits up Granite Creek off the ...

Hoback and Snake: serious fishing.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i130

Pioneer Mountains, Montana — the Wisdom theory run through Polaris instead of the town. Elkhorn Hot Springs supplies the surge, Polaris supplies ursa and the north star, the Big Hole River supplies the fishing and the Hole. The ...

Blue-ribbon fishing.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i156

'Cast your pole' → 'in ursa' is one navigational step, not two. The pole is the pole star; Polaris sits in Ursa Minor. 2:4 tells you to fix north, 3:1 tells you which bear ('only Ursa East matters, no west to consider' — a ...

Pole = pole star; the line ends stanza 2 by giving you north.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i157

New composite — Thermopolis / Wind River Canyon / Wedding of the Waters (WY). Big Spring in Hot Springs State Park: the world's largest mineral hot spring, surging, free, 24/7 ('hope surges, clear and bright'). Wind River Canyon ...

Wedding of the Waters is a fishing access site.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i158

New composite — Gates of the Mountains / Sleeping Giant / Beartooth (Helena, MT). The Gates of the Mountains on the Missouri is the most literal 'ancient gates' in the West (Lewis & Clark, 1805). The ridge north of Helena called ...

Missouri below Holter: blue-ribbon.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i162

Cross-reference on the footprint: the free / 24-7 / dogs gate puts the site outside the park, but the Fenn epicenter is the park's west and north edges. The overlap is the ring of national forest just outside: Hebgen Lake and the ...

Henry's Fork: legendary fly water.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i177

Scan result — Big Springs / Henry's Fork (Island Park, ID): 120 million gallons a day of crystal-clear 52°F water; fishing prohibited at the spring, great below; free national forest, dogs; Upper and Lower Mesa Falls downstream; ...

Waits where you cannot cast, like the Rise.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i216

Mysterious Writings, 'Justin Posey's Poem: Round the bend, past the Hole...' (Jenny Kile): the line read as a curve in the river and then past the Big Hole River; a specific theory places it where the Beaverhead and Big Hole flow ...

Fishing.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (via search summary)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i221

MW Sep 8 2025 — word notes on 2:3–2:4. 'Round the bend': is 'Round' a name? Bend, Oregon (now eliminated); the Tucker poem p. 213 'took half my soul around the bend'; p. 149 'Tucker and Jennie rounded the bend'; p. 177 'Rounding ...

'Cast your pole' = the lost-pole story at Heron Lake, and/or a pole casting a shadow — a gnomon gives a bearing, tying 2:4 to 'twenty degree' and 'shadowed sight'.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text

SUPPORTS · w3 · i223

Heron Lake, New Mexico (Rio Arriba County, ~36.7°N — north of the Santa Fe cutoff; 7,200 ft; a reservoir that the old-map theory would omit). In the book: p. 33 'Heron Lake being our north star', the lost-pole story ('I wait for ...

The book's own 'I' with a lost pole.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude) from MW + book references

SUPPORTS · w1 · i238

Ask / read: the 'Mountain Memory' chapter (p. 213) and the chapter that introduces Tucker — is the fishing location named? If it names a place, work that place against the poem; if it deliberately withholds the place, that is ...

Could produce a real fishing place

Question to ask · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — next actions

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i237

Tucker Creek DROPPED: a fan-analysis site claimed a 'Tucker Creek' in the Big Hole drainage. It does not appear in Montana geographic name records (GNIS) for that drainage. Unverified and removed from the working file — the ...

A named 'Tucker Creek' cannot be relied on

Objection / constraint · Disputed · Fan-analysis site (untraced) vs GNIS check, Sep 6 2026

L09 In ursa east his realm awaits;

63 facts · 21 against

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i150

Official FAQ (treasure.quest announcements): Are the clues in consecutive order? Yes. Is the treasure buried? 'If you know where to go, it wouldn't matter either way.' Exact spot or general area? 'If you've solved the poem in its ...

'No Fenn knowledge needed' — the 75-mile Fenn statement is a constraint on the site, not a clue in the poem.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest announcements FAQ (via r/TreasureHunting, u/Advanced_Relation_79)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i165

VERIFIED — The Sleeping Giant north of Helena is Beartooth Mountain (6,792 ft) on the maps; it lies west of the Missouri and Holter Lake, head to the EAST, feet to the west; the Gates of the Mountains are nearby. But the Gates ...

The bear's head points east — 'in ursa east' reads off the mountain itself.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i170

VERIFIED — Lemhi Pass (7,373 ft, Continental Divide, MT/ID): gravel but passenger-car OK; Sacajawea Memorial Area is a free Forest Service site 0.2 mi south of the pass. Sacagawea was taken by Hidatsa raiders near Three Forks ...

Cameahwait's realm across the pass.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i171

VERIFIED — Jackson Hole's Sleeping Indian (Sheep Mountain, Gros Ventre Range) is a chief lying on his back with headdress, obvious from the west, on the EAST edge of the Hole. Posey's 'whether he is living depends on your ...

A sleeping 'he' east of the Hole; the Tetons are 'she' west of it — the poem's pair on one valley.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i194

'The key to one direction lies in another' — this line is a hidden audio message decoded from the ARKADE song 'Beyond the Map's Edge' (Netflix); Justin confirmed the associated technical clue, not as the core geographic solution. ...

One direction (ursa east) keyed by another.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i203

Hiding verbatim: two 2023 journeys totaling 9,000+ miles (first was reconnaissance), off-grid; 'no hint meant to be read into 9,000 miles'; at least four trips from the car, all within a 24-hour span, with a broken tibia, not his ...

If the animal is a wolverine, the search area is high mountain country — Winds, Tetons, Beartooths, Pintlers, Glacier — not desert canyon.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i227

Q: Is 'east' a portion within one Ursa, or is there a west Ursa and an east Ursa? Posey: you only need to worry about Ursa East.

'Ursa East' is treated as a thing with an east part — a place, not a heading verb

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i228

Q: Is 'ursa' lowercase deliberately? Posey: the poem was written deliberately; the choice not to capitalize was intentional. No further clarity offered.

Lowercase ursa is deliberate — a common noun doing place work

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i012

All clues are expected to stand the test of time; he will announce if something drastic changes.

Argues against building 'his realm' on a contested Ute translation of Waas — a durable clue would not hinge on hedged etymology.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i014

Boots on the ground becomes absolutely required at stanza four. Implication: stanzas 1 through 3 are intended to be solvable from home.

The working solve anchors stanza 3 on standing at Jeep Arch. If stanzas 1–3 are armchair-solvable, the La Sals should fall out of the map and poem alone.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i020

Built-in checkpoint gives the reassuring feeling you aren't lost. It gives zero doubt you are trending right. You are at least halfway through the poem clues when you reach it. It is part of the poem, as a stage of the journey. ...

Or the checkpoint is where 'his realm' begins.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i029

Asked whether 'he' is living or was ever living: 'That depends on your perspective.'

Compatible with a mountain named for a person (Waas the Ute chief), a personified feature, or a figure of legend.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w3 · i030

Only Ursa East matters; there is no separate west Ursa. The lowercase 'ursa' was deliberate. On an anagram reading such as 'use a star': 'the poem was written deliberately, so the choice of not capitalizing was intentional, but ...

Lowercase ursa points away from a proper name (Ursa Major) toward a common noun or wordplay — 'bear east' as a heading, or an anagram.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i036

Colorado eliminated (Seekers Summit, intentional). Oregon eliminated (Seekers Summit, intentional).

The La Sals are on the Utah side of the state line — adjacent to Colorado but outside it.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i067

Ursa: no bear-related naming exists among the La Sal peaks (Waas, Peale, Mellenthin, Tukuahnivatz, South Mountain) or the local drainages (Mill Creek, Pack Creek). The nearest bear name, Bears Ears, is ~70 miles southwest — the ...

'Ursa east' has no bear to point at in the La Sals; the reading relies entirely on 'bear' as a verb.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Master file §12 – constraints to reconcile

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i071

Waas etymology: the 'man' translation is hedged in sources; the Ute chief attribution is better supported. Clues should stand the test of time, which argues against building on a contested translation.

'His realm' as 'man mountain' rests on a hedged translation.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Master file §12 – constraints to reconcile

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i133

Cross-reference: Fenn's chest was found in Wyoming (Fenn confirmed the state, June 2020; the finder, Jack Stuef, never gave the spot). Posey bought that chest from Stuef and said he had at some point searched for it within 75 ...

The La Sals clear it only if Posey searched for Fenn in the Four Corners, which nothing on record says.

Posey statement · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i136

Posey has said that during his Fenn search he believes he was extremely close to the chest's location in Yellowstone — possibly within 10–15 feet — and missed it. Fenn's chest was found in Wyoming in June 2020 by Jack Stuef. ...

The La Sals are ~450 miles from Yellowstone; nothing on record puts a Fenn search of his in the Four Corners.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i147

Posey on the map: 'I chose the landmarks to be labeled, but the map was designed by a third party. Any incorrect names, positions, and elevations are not intentional.' Read carefully: the SELECTION of labeled landmarks is his; ...

A labeled peak named for a person or a bear is a chosen label.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey (quoted in user research)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i160

The 75-mile exchange, as transcribed (Seekers Summit, Mar 28 2026). Q: 'Is the location where you hid your treasure within 75 miles of a place where you searched for the Forrest Fenn chest?' A: 'I searched a lot of places, guys. ...

Weaker than the community uses it: it does not confine the hunt to Fenn's four states.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit transcript via Mysterious Writings (relayed by Google AI overview)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i179

Hub constraints table (Posey, per the hub): the site is below 11,000 ft; clues may cross state lines; the location is less than a mile from a car; access 24/7, no fee; not in a pay park, national-park fee area or restricted zone. ...

Clues may cross state lines — a construction that starts in one state and lands in another is allowed.

Posey statement · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w3 · i183

Book gazetteer, per the hub: places named in the memoir — Dillon, Big Hole Valley, Beaverhead Valley, Wisdom (in the Grasshopper Valley chapter), Polaris MT (explicitly named), Pioneer Mountains, Crystal Park, Bannack, Blacktail ...

Polaris is named in the book itself.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i190

Hunt status: a separate marked-book prize was found in July 2026; Justin clarified the marked book was found, 'not the treasure (yet)'. A Treasure Hunt With Us meet-and-greet is scheduled for Sep 12 2026 in POLARIS, Montana — ...

He is going to Polaris. Event logistics, not a clue — but note it.

Posey statement · Likely · Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i193

'From beginning to end of the poem... it will inherently create some sort of shape.' (JIBLE, Distances). Read with 'each clue is not meant to convey great distance' (Summit) and the Indiana Jones / National Treasure nudge: the ...

Ursa as a direction, drawing a leg of the shape.

Posey statement · Likely · JIBLE 4.0 (jessinthwest / hi-imerica, upd. 9/30/25) via THAP hub

SUPPORTS · w2 · i209

Book verbatim, motifs: dedication 'thank you for being my north star'; 'Like four points of a compass, I've dedicated this treasure to four departed souls' (book order is authoritative, per Justin); Prologue opens 'Grid searching ...

'Ursine' on p. 116 — ursa = bear in his own usage; a bronze bear 'stood guard'.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w3 · i211

Book geography verbatim: 'the Big Hole's crystal waters'; Grasshopper Valley 'flanked by the Big Hole Valley'; 'At night, the sky in Grasshopper Valley is so star-spangled... thumbing through your mental Rolodex for ...

Constellations named over Grasshopper Valley, where Polaris the town sits.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

CONTRADICTS · w3 · i231

Analysis of the Ursa East answer: the question 'is there a west ursa and an east ursa?' only makes sense if ursa names something. If it were 'bear east' as a heading verb there would be no west version to ask about. With the ...

'Bear east' as a verb is closed by the Ursa East answer

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — analysis of confirmed Q&A

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i243

Unresolved conflicts in the Sister Superior solve: direction — Castle Valley is northwest of Waas/Manns and northeast of Moab, not east; sequence — Castle Valley opens off SR-128 at the same junction as Matrimony Spring (S2L1), ...

Castle Valley is not east

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026

SUPPORTS · w2 · i057

'Bear east' read as a heading instruction; from Jeep Arch the La Sals lie east. 'His realm' = Mount Waas (12,306 ft), Grand County high point, named by the Hayden Survey for a local Ute chief; 'Waas' also reported (hedged) to ...

A named 'his' summit due east of the stanza-2 endpoint.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w2 · i085

Community: 'URSA EAST' anagrams to 'USE A STAR' — a nod to navigating by Polaris, which sits in Ursa Minor. Identified on the MW Discord in early 2026. Posey, asked about it: the lowercase was intentional, 'but that's all the ...

A wordplay reading that explains the deliberate lowercase.

Community claim · Unverified · MW Discord, early 2026 — via web search summary

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i085

Community: 'URSA EAST' anagrams to 'USE A STAR' — a nod to navigating by Polaris, which sits in Ursa Minor. Identified on the MW Discord in early 2026. Posey, asked about it: the lowercase was intentional, 'but that's all the ...

Cuts against 'bear east' as a heading — if ursa is an anagram, it is not a direction.

Community claim · Unverified · MW Discord, early 2026 — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i086

Community: the 'technical' hint is Alt+42 on the numpad, which types an asterisk — a STAR. Ties the recurring 42 (page 42 hill illustration, Idaho/Utah 42nd parallel, peaks-in-order count) to 'use a star'.

Reinforces a star reading of ursa.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i087

Community (Southwest Montana cluster): Polaris, Montana — a town named for the North Star, Beaverhead County — as 'his realm'; Beaverhead Rock near Twin Bridges (the landmark Sacagawea recognised as home) as the bride; the ...

A realm named for the star in the bear.

Community claim · Unverified · Southwest Montana tourism blog — via web search summary; Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i095

Community (fringe, Arizona): the Birthing Cave near Sedona (a half-spherical hole) as the Hole; Woo Ranch at the base of Bear Mountain ('ursa') in an alcove next to the Palatki Heritage Site — 'beyond the map's edge' of the ...

A literal Bear Mountain.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

CONTRADICTS · w3 · i097

Community inference from the 75-mile Fenn statement: Fenn's 2013 map covered only Montana, Wyoming, Colorado and New Mexico. With Colorado eliminated and south-of-Santa-Fe out, many searchers now confine the hunt to MT, WY and ...

If the Fenn-map inference holds, the La Sals are out entirely.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i103

Wisdom/Big Hole supporting reads: 'what lives in time' and 'flowing through each measured rhyme' as the river itself, each clue a point along it, with 'like a river's steady flow' closing the loop in stanza 5. The cover's torn ...

Nothing in the Wisdom cluster gives a bear or a star for 'ursa' — the theory leans on Polaris to supply it.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i104

Polaris, Montana companion: 'in ursa east' = Polaris, the North Star in Ursa Minor, married to the town of Polaris on the Pioneer Scenic Byway in the Beaverhead; the bride is then a north-star location on the map. Supporters cite ...

Star-in-the-bear → a place named Polaris, east of the Big Hole.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i106

Sweetwater walkthrough, stanza 3–4: 'ursa east' as a heading — Highway 220 northeast along the river to the ancient gates = Devil's Gate on the Sweetwater. 'Her foot of three' = three landmarks east of Devil's Gate. 'Return her ...

Bear east as a heading — the same verb reading as my solve, on a different river.

Community claim · Unverified · TreasureNet full walkthrough, Apr 2026 — via user research

SUPPORTS · w1 · i119

Reddit (u/GreenEyes7141018, 13 up / 48 comments): what if the hunt is like National Treasure — each stanza is one location, and at that location is a clue giving the next. Offered to explain two Posey quotes: 'the key to one ...

Ursa east as one direction whose key is elsewhere.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapsedge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/GreenEyes7141018)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i119

Reddit (u/GreenEyes7141018, 13 up / 48 comments): what if the hunt is like National Treasure — each stanza is one location, and at that location is a clue giving the next. Offered to explain two Posey quotes: 'the key to one ...

Stanza 3 as location two.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapsedge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/GreenEyes7141018)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i124

The structure probably isn't a walk. He wouldn't say whether the poem is linear or several points miles apart, then mentioned Indiana Jones and National Treasure — both about an object or device that reveals a location when ...

Stanza 3 as the construction: realm, bride, gates, foot, face are the parts of the device.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i125

'Ursa east' as a proper name, not a constellation. Only Ursa East matters, there is no west to consider, and the lowercase was deliberate — that reads like a place name disguised by decapitalizing. Test first: Bear Lodge. Devils ...

Bear (ursa) + Lodge (realm): a double-confirmed proper name, disguised by lowercase, east of most of the map.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i125

'Ursa east' as a proper name, not a constellation. Only Ursa East matters, there is no west to consider, and the lowercase was deliberate — that reads like a place name disguised by decapitalizing. Test first: Bear Lodge. Devils ...

Ursa East as 'the east of the Bear Lodge range' leaves 'no west Ursa' slightly odd — the range has a west side.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i128

City of Rocks, Idaho (~42.07°N — the parallel the 42 clues point at). Actual granite, so 'granite bold' is literal. California Trail landmark where emigrants wrote their names on the rock in axle grease, still legible: secrets of ...

No bear, no star.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i130

Pioneer Mountains, Montana — the Wisdom theory run through Polaris instead of the town. Elkhorn Hot Springs supplies the surge, Polaris supplies ursa and the north star, the Big Hole River supplies the fishing and the Hole. The ...

Polaris: the star in the bear, as a place.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i144

Time-warp anomalies on the map: Wyoming was part of Dakota Territory until 1868 (no Wyoming Territory yet in 1864). Salem, Oregon is missing (fixed in the errata) — and Salem was only confirmed as Oregon's capital in 1864. ...

Wyoming inside Dakota Territory in 1864 — 'ursa east' on an 1864 map is a different sheet.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i156

'Cast your pole' → 'in ursa' is one navigational step, not two. The pole is the pole star; Polaris sits in Ursa Minor. 2:4 tells you to fix north, 3:1 tells you which bear ('only Ursa East matters, no west to consider' — a ...

'In ursa, east' = east of the bear's pointer = a bearing east of north; explains 'no west Ursa' and the lowercase.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i156

'Cast your pole' → 'in ursa' is one navigational step, not two. The pole is the pole star; Polaris sits in Ursa Minor. 2:4 tells you to fix north, 3:1 tells you which bear ('only Ursa East matters, no west to consider' — a ...

Kills every place-name bear (Bear Lodge, Bear Mountain, Beartooth) if right.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i157

New composite — Thermopolis / Wind River Canyon / Wedding of the Waters (WY). Big Spring in Hot Springs State Park: the world's largest mineral hot spring, surging, free, 24/7 ('hope surges, clear and bright'). Wind River Canyon ...

No bear.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i158

New composite — Gates of the Mountains / Sleeping Giant / Beartooth (Helena, MT). The Gates of the Mountains on the Missouri is the most literal 'ancient gates' in the West (Lewis & Clark, 1805). The ridge north of Helena called ...

Beartooth Mountain IS the Sleeping Giant — bear and 'his' on one feature, east of which lie the Gates.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i161

Posey's Fenn search footprint, as compiled by the community: the epicenter was the west and north sides of Yellowstone — the Madison River corridor including Nine Mile Hole (Fenn's favorite fishing spot) and Madison Junction ...

If he looked in Utah early, Moab clears the Fenn gate after all — 'at some point' is doing the work.

Community claim · Unverified · Google AI overview citing Reddit r/JustinPoseysTreasure + Mysterious Writings (machine summary – verify)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i162

Cross-reference on the footprint: the free / 24-7 / dogs gate puts the site outside the park, but the Fenn epicenter is the park's west and north edges. The overlap is the ring of national forest just outside: Hebgen Lake and the ...

No bear or star beyond the pole-star reading.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i174

Scan result — Hole-in-the-Wall (Kaycee, WY): a natural gap in the Red Wall, capital-H on every map; BLM, fee-free Outlaw Cave campground; Middle Fork Powder blue-ribbon; Rock Art Cave petroglyphs and an ancient cairn line. 'His ...

A 'he' whose living status is genuinely a matter of perspective.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i180

Hub progress board: the Hole (2:3) is 'confirmed solved by the community'; the Bride (3:2) has been identified; at least 6 clues solved by the most-advanced searcher; part of stanza 3 solved; the technical clue solved by one ...

Ursa still open for everyone.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i215

Mysterious Writings, 'Top 10 New Clues Found in Beyond the Map's Edge' (running list): (1) the book cover's torn outline matches the Big Hole River watershed, river through mountains; (2) hardcover-only images on pp. 4 and 117 → ...

*Alt+42 → * → star → Polaris.*

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack – Top 10 New Clues (via search summary)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i217

Cross-reference on the Twin Bridges reading: at Twin Bridges, Montana the Big Hole, the Beaverhead and the Ruby join to form the Jefferson. Lewis named those three forks in 1805 for Jefferson's virtues — Wisdom (Big Hole), ...

The Jefferson is a 'his'; the Tobacco Root batholith east of it is granite.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i217

Cross-reference on the Twin Bridges reading: at Twin Bridges, Montana the Big Hole, the Beaverhead and the Ruby join to form the Jefferson. Lewis named those three forks in 1805 for Jefferson's virtues — Wisdom (Big Hole), ...
Still no bear except by the pole-star reading.
My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i221

MW Sep 8 2025 — word notes on 2:3–2:4. 'Round the bend': is 'Round' a name? Bend, Oregon (now eliminated); the Tucker poem p. 213 'took half my soul around the bend'; p. 149 'Tucker and Jennie rounded the bend'; p. 177 'Rounding ...
Pole → North Pole → Polaris → ursa.
Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text

SUPPORTS · w2 · i223

Heron Lake, New Mexico (Rio Arriba County, ~36.7°N — north of the Santa Fe cutoff; 7,200 ft; a reservoir that the old-map theory would omit). In the book: p. 33 'Heron Lake being our north star', the lost-pole story ('I wait for ...
'Our north star' in the book.
My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude) from MW + book references

SUPPORTS · w1 · i241

La Sal name hooks (peaks visible looking south: Peale, Mellenthin, South Mountain, Tukuhtnikivat, Haystack, Manns, Waas, Castle Mountain, La Sal Peak): Castle Mountain is a better 'realm' candidate than Waas (a realm is what a ...
Castle Mountain as 'his realm'
My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — La Sal screenshot

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i241

La Sal name hooks (peaks visible looking south: Peale, Mellenthin, South Mountain, Tukuhtnikivat, Haystack, Manns, Waas, Castle Mountain, La Sal Peak): Castle Mountain is a better 'realm' candidate than Waas (a realm is what a ...
No bear naming in the La Sals
My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — La Sal screenshot

SUPPORTS · w2 · i246

Eastern Beartooths case: a bear-named range with a real east half; granitic against the volcanic Absarokas; Granite Peak is the state high point; rock dated ~3.96 billion years, so 'secrets of the past still hold' and 'beyond the ...
Bear-named range with an east half
My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — regions compared

SUPPORTS · w2 · i247

Pioneer Mountains / Big Hole / Beaverhead case: by far the strongest book support (Dillon signing; Wisdom, Big Hole, Polaris, Pioneers, Bannack, Crystal Park, Blacktail Deer Creek, Clark Canyon, Red Rock River); Pioneer batholith ...
East Pioneers = an east half of a range
My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — regions compared

L10 His bride stands guard at ancient gates.

50 facts · 6 against

SUPPORTS · w2 · i165

VERIFIED — The Sleeping Giant north of Helena is Beartooth Mountain (6,792 ft) on the maps; it lies west of the Missouri and Holter Lake, head to the EAST, feet to the west; the Gates of the Mountains are nearby. But the Gates ...
Literal gates, but no bride found.
Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i168

VERIFIED — Thermopolis: Hot Springs State Park is free but open 6 am–10 pm, so the site itself cannot be in the park; leashed dogs allowed on park trails. The Wedding of the Waters is 5 miles south, a Game & Fish public access ...

A named bride at the mouth of an age-signed canyon.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i169

VERIFIED — Beaverhead Rock State Park: the landmark 'may be viewed and photographed from a distance but is not directly accessible'; non-residents pay \$8 per vehicle. Clark's bearings confirm it as the feature Sacagawea named. As ...

A bride you can see and not touch — matching the wording of Posey's answer.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i171

VERIFIED — Jackson Hole's Sleeping Indian (Sheep Mountain, Gros Ventre Range) is a chief lying on his back with headdress, obvious from the west, on the EAST edge of the Hole. Posey's 'whether he is living depends on your ...

Bride and groom flank the gates of the Hole.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i199

Stanza 3 verbatim: 'Is return her face referring to the bride?' → punt (9/4/25); later 'her face belongs to her' → yes (Summit). 'Is the place in her face or her gaze?' → no clarity. 'Has the bride ever been alive?' → 'depends on ...

'Bride' is the exact word he wanted.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i224

Q: Does one need to be at the bride to identify her foot of three, or some distance away? Posey stalled, re-read it, then answered: No. You do not need to be at the bride — the foot of three should be identifiable from a distance ...

The bride is seen, not climbed to

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i226

Q: How far is the treasure from the bride? Posey: a matter of perspective.

Bride-to-treasure distance is deliberately ambiguous

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i230

Q: Does her face belong to the bride? Posey: yes (after hedging about two interpretations). Q: Is 'return her face' referring to the bride? Punted in September, answered yes at Seekers Summit.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i014

Boots on the ground becomes absolutely required at stanza four. Implication: stanzas 1 through 3 are intended to be solvable from home.

Same armchair objection: the bride should be identifiable from home.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i020

Built-in checkpoint gives the reassuring feeling you aren't lost. It gives zero doubt you are trending right. You are at least halfway through the poem clues when you reach it. It is part of the poem, as a stage of the journey. ...

Halfway through twenty lines lands in stanza 3 — 'ancient gates' is the natural checkpoint reading.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i021

The checkpoint is both something he placed AND something already there. Asked if it is tied to a topographic feature: 'there is some implication there.' Not something you need to worry about moving. Possible to be at it and not ...

A placed mark on an existing landform — a gate that was already there, marked by him.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i023

'You'd be hard pressed to get all the way without seeing the checkpoint.' The audiobook adds a chapter containing the word 'checkpoint', widely read as confirming it cannot be identified from home.

The checkpoint sits on the route, seen in passing.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w3 · i024

The bride is not a person who is alive right now. Clarified intent: he does not want anyone thinking she is a living person you can interact with, to prevent searchers hassling real people. The bride is something visible. Someone ...

She is a visible, identifiable thing — a landform, monument or image fits; a living person does not.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w3 · i028

It would be 'a little strange' to discover the bride without understanding the ancient gates.

The gates come with or before the bride; understanding them is how you confirm her.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i094

Audiobook bonus chapter 'Los Camarones Calientes', set at Lukeville on the Arizona border, gives a 'Border Crossing Commandment – Lukeville Edition. Rule #1 – Carved in stone – never shall wheel touch checkpoint soil. Foot ...

'Carved in stone' at the checkpoint — the gates as carved or marked rock, reached on foot.

Book text · Likely · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) – via web search summary

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i159

Rule-outs from the statements we hold. City of Rocks: 2:1–2:2 must be a pair several searchers have solved, within walking distance of 2:3 — the Reserve has no water worth a line, so stanza 2 cannot be assigned there. Sweetwater: ...

Sweetwater's bride is not a thing.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i182

Book, per the hub: the only explicit 'bride' in the book is a photo caption — 'From left: Grandpa Posey, Mom and Dad (aka the bride and groom), Grandma Posey, and Grandma Clements in September of 1979.' A photograph is a physical ...

The book's one bride is his mother in a 1979 wedding photo — 'his' bride, and a face you can physically turn.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i185

Hub interview index (dates): Cowlazars & KPro YouTube (very early, shortly after launch); Froggy YouTube (early); Treasure Hunt With Us YouTube (Apr 9 2025); Sandal TikTok/YouTube livestream (around National Public Lands Day, ...

Confidence checkpoint at or past the midpoint.

Posey statement · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i208

Book verbatim, structure: chapters Seinfeld-style. Named: The Gracie Grail (Gracie's Antiques, Dillon — 'an arched entryway crowned with brick', 'the iron gate seemed to politely suggest this place had boundaries', a door that ...

An arched entry and an iron gate in the Dillon chapter — gates in his own words.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com – BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w2 · i232

Analysis: the gates are the anchor, not the bride. Gates come first (Posey), so they are the more findable, probably named or well-known thing; the bride is what you spot once you are looking at them. Solves that find a bride and ...

Identify the gates first; derive the bride

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i243

Unresolved conflicts in the Sister Superior solve: direction — Castle Valley is northwest of Waas/Manns and northeast of Moab, not east; sequence — Castle Valley opens off SR-128 at the same junction as Matrimony Spring (S2L1), ...

Stanza 3 loops back to the stanza-2 start

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026

SUPPORTS · w1 · i052

Speculation: 'not a person who is alive right now' plus a hunt dedicated to four late loved ones — the bride could honor a dedicatee (a memorial, a named or personal feature) rather than be a landform.

An alternative bride that satisfies 'not alive' and 'visible' without a mountain.

My own theory · Unverified · My own theory

SUPPORTS · w1 · i053

Matrimony Spring at the junction of US-191 and SR-128 north of Moab: cold, clear, flows 365 days a year, likely sourced from the La Sals ~30 miles southeast. Local legend: couples who drink from it marry; drinking marries you to ...

Plants the bride motif three lines early.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w2 · i058

Mount Tukuhiwikivatz as the bride to the man-mountain, standing at the gates of the range. 'Ancient gates' not pinned to a specific feature.

A paired peak for the paired line.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i068

The bride clarification — volunteering twice that she is not a living person and not someone you can interact with — only makes sense if the bride reads as person-shaped. Counterweight: he also said the bride is visible, and that ...

Cuts against a mountain-bride: nobody worries about searchers hassling a peak.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · Master file §12 — constraints to reconcile

SUPPORTS · w1 · i074

Ask: Is the bride a natural feature or something made?

Mountain vs monument vs image.

Question to ask · Unverified · Master file §13 — open questions

SUPPORTS · w2 · i087

Community (Southwest Montana cluster): Polaris, Montana — a town named for the North Star, Beaverhead County — as 'his realm'; Beaverhead Rock near Twin Bridges (the landmark Sacagawea recognised as home) as the bride; the ...

A famous, visible, not-alive bride at a gateway landform.

Community claim · Unverified · Southwest Montana tourism blog — via web search summary; Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i096

Community: other bride candidates in circulation — Bridal Veil Falls (Provo Canyon, UT; also Shoshone NF, WY), Queener Mountain (queen = bride), Spica as companion to Arcturus (the bear-guard star), and Sophia ('Wisdom') as the ...

The field of brides is wide; none has been confirmed publicly.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i104

Polaris, Montana companion: 'in ursa east' = Polaris, the North Star in Ursa Minor, married to the town of Polaris on the Pioneer Scenic Byway in the Beaverhead; the bride is then a north-star location on the map. Supporters cite ...

Bride as a map location rather than a person or landform.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i106

Sweetwater walkthrough, stanza 3–4: 'ursa east' as a heading — Highway 220 northeast along the river to the ancient gates = Devil's Gate on the Sweetwater. 'Her foot of three' = three landmarks east of Devil's Gate. 'Return her ...

Devil's Gate is a literal, ancient, named gate on the Oregon Trail.

Community claim · Unverified · TreasureNet full walkthrough, Apr 2026 – via user research

SUPPORTS · w2 · i124

The structure probably isn't a walk. He wouldn't say whether the poem is linear or several points miles apart, then mentioned Indiana Jones and National Treasure — both about an object or device that reveals a location when ...

Same.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i125

'Ursa east' as a proper name, not a constellation. Only Ursa East matters, there is no west to consider, and the lowercase was deliberate — that reads like a place name disguised by decapitalizing. Test first: Bear Lodge. Devils ...

Devils Tower is a sacred site with a gate-like base; a bride feature is unverified.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i128

City of Rocks, Idaho (~42.07°N — the parallel the 42 clues point at). Actual granite, so 'granite bold' is literal. California Trail landmark where emigrants wrote their names on the rock in axle grease, still legible: secrets of ...

Emigrants called it a gateway.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i130

Pioneer Mountains, Montana — the Wisdom theory run through Polaris instead of the town. Elkhorn Hot Springs supplies the surge, Polaris supplies ursa and the north star, the Big Hole River supplies the fishing and the Hole. The ...

No bride adjacent — Beaverhead Rock is ~40 miles off.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i131

Cross-reference: the Tetons are literally 'her' and literally 'three'. 'Les Trois Tétens' — the Grand, Middle and South Teton — were named by French trappers for a woman's breasts. 'Her foot of three' would then be the foot of ...

The bride as the Tetons: visible, not alive, and the range is a gate into the Hole.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i154

Checkpoint = the double arcs. Cross-referencing five statements: the checkpoint is something he placed AND something already there; it has 'some implication' of a topographic feature; the audiobook calls it 'carved in stone'; one ...

Alternative: the checkpoint is the gates, 'at least halfway' — 3:2 is clue 6 of ~10.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i157

New composite — Thermopolis / Wind River Canyon / Wedding of the Waters (WY). Big Spring in Hot Springs State Park: the world's largest mineral hot spring, surging, free, 24/7 ('hope surges, clear and bright'). Wind River Canyon ...

'Wedding of the Waters' at the mouth of a canyon signed by geological age: a bride at ancient gates, both literal.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i158

New composite — Gates of the Mountains / Sleeping Giant / Beartooth (Helena, MT). The Gates of the Mountains on the Missouri is the most literal 'ancient gates' in the West (Lewis & Clark, 1805). The ridge north of Helena called ...

The Gates of the Mountains: named, ancient, literal.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i158

New composite — Gates of the Mountains / Sleeping Giant / Beartooth (Helena, MT). The Gates of the Mountains on the Missouri is the most literal 'ancient gates' in the West (Lewis & Clark, 1805). The ridge north of Helena called ...

No bride identified at the Gates.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i174

Scan result — Hole-in-the-Wall (Kaycee, WY): a natural gap in the Red Wall, capital-H on every map; BLM, fee-free Outlaw Cave campground; Middle Fork Powder blue-ribbon; Rock Art Cave petroglyphs and an ancient cairn line. 'His ...

The Hole is literally an ancient gate.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i175

Scan result — Provo Canyon / Timpanogos (UT): Bridal Veil Falls (free county park, dogs) is the maiden's tears in the Timpanogos legend; the mountain's skyline is her sleeping profile from the canyon — a named 'her face'. The ...

A named bride.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i180

Hub progress board: the Hole (2:3) is 'confirmed solved by the community'; the Bride (3:2) has been identified; at least 6 clues solved by the most-advanced searcher; part of stanza 3 solved; the technical clue solved by one ...

Bride identified.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i184

Hub theories for the gates and bride: Storm Lake Pass on the Continental Divide (Anaconda-Pintler, above the Big Hole) as the 'gate'; Beaverhead Rock; Queener Mountain (queen = bride) in the Big Hole area; Bridal Veil Falls / ...

Storm Lake Pass and Queener Mountain put gates and bride inside the Big Hole itself.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i212

Hub community theories (all speculation): Hope Creek NE of Wisdom in the Anaconda-Pintler ('hope surges'); Lamar / Trout Creek; the Hidden Lake / Queener Mountain BOTG solve (Storm Lake Pass = gates, Queener = bride, triangular ...

Storm Lake Pass and Queener Mountain — gate and bride in one drainage.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com – BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w3 · i217

Cross-reference on the Twin Bridges reading: at Twin Bridges, Montana the Big Hole, the Beaverhead and the Ruby join to form the Jefferson. Lewis named those three forks in 1805 for Jefferson's virtues — Wisdom (Big Hole), ...

Beaverhead Rock, Sacagawea's landmark, visible-only, twelve miles from the three.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i234

Gates-as-passage reframe: 'ancient gates' as a valley or pass used as a crossing route long ago, rather than a formation with 'gate' in its name. Fits gates-before-bride (a historic crossing is identified first; the bride is the ...

Gates = a historic passage; bride = the landform over it

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (Josh's reframe)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i242

Sister Superior solve (Castle Valley, Moab): the Rectory ridge runs Castleton Tower, the Rectory, the Priest and Nuns, Sister Superior, the Convent — a nun is a bride of Christ. Gates = the valley mouth flanked by the Rectory ...

Sister Superior as the bride; valley mouth as gates

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — working solve

SUPPORTS · w1 · i245

Ask / look up: what does 'Tomasaki' mean (Mount Tomasaki, adjacent to Manns and Waas, a Ute name like Waas), and is it male or female?

Unworkable as a bride or realm until established. Also Mount Laurel (12,271 ft; laurel = ...

Possible bride name, unverified

Question to ask · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026

SUPPORTS · w1 · i247

Pioneer Mountains / Big Hole / Beaverhead case: by far the strongest book support (Dillon signing; Wisdom, Big Hole, Polaris, Pioneers, Bannack, Crystal Park, Blacktail Deer Creek, Clark Canyon, Red Rock River); Pioneer batholith ...

Ancient passes as gates candidates

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — regions compared

SUPPORTS · w1 · i248

Ask: which historic pass has a named landform standing over it that could read as a bride? First question in a while that runs forward from the poem rather than backward from a place. Also: check whether the East Pioneers have ...

Question to ask · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — next actions

L11 Her foot of three at twenty degree,

38 facts · 4 against

SUPPORTS · w1 · i168

VERIFIED — Thermopolis: Hot Springs State Park is free but open 6 am–10 pm, so the site itself cannot be in the park; leashed dogs allowed on park trails. The Wedding of the Waters is 5 miles south, a Game & Fish public access ...

Three tunnels at the foot of the canyon.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i170

VERIFIED — Lemhi Pass (7,373 ft, Continental Divide, MT/ID): gravel but passenger-car OK; Sacajawea Memorial Area is a free Forest Service site 0.2 mi south of the pass. Sacagawea was taken by Hidatsa raiders near Three Forks ...

Three Forks is where she was taken — 'her foot of three'.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i194

'The key to one direction lies in another' — this line is a hidden audio message decoded from the ARKADE song 'Beyond the Map's Edge' (Netflix); Justin confirmed the associated technical clue, not as the core geographic solution. ...

Not the azimuth, he says — so not simply 'take a compass bearing'.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i197

Rearrangement and reading: 'Does the poem need to be read or rearranged other than as presented?' → 'I'm not going to rule that out.' Thematic vs literal → 'Probably roughly both in equal measure.' Anagrams → 'I haven't ...

Numbers may hide in words.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i200

Vantage point: 'There is a vantage point mentioned in your grandfather's memoir — did you incorporate that?' → 'There is a vantage point involved. But it's not that any of the clues are necessarily talking about that vantage ...

'Foot of three at twenty degree' identified from a distance — from the vantage point.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i207

Logo: 'the anzarr symbol — I chose and modified it intentionally' (X Dark Matters). Anzarr is the Unicode glyph ⍼ (U+237C, 'right angle with downwards zigzag arrow'), a symbol with no known origin — a right angle plus a zigzag ...

A right angle in the logo — an angle is a bearing; twenty degrees is an angle.

Posey statement · Confirmed · X Dark Matters – Sep 4 2025 (JIBLE)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i210

Tucker poem (p. 213, Mountain Memory) — confirmed helpful: 'Tucker, once my earthly friend, / Took half my soul around the bend'; 'In the mountain's hushed solitude, where the air is crisp and the trees stand in silent reverence, ...

A three-legged dog: a foot of three.

Book text · Confirmed · treasurehuntamusementpark.com – BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w3 · i224

Q: Does one need to be at the bride to identify her foot of three, or some distance away? Posey stalled, re-read it, then answered: No. You do not need to be at the bride — the foot of three should be identifiable from a distance ...

Foot of three reads from a distance; rules out small on-site measurements

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i010

Numbers are indirectly associated with the poem (wordplay, hidden in words) — confirmed yes; declined to address homophones specifically. There IS a distance element in following the clues.

The one explicit number line: three and twenty. A distance element likely lives here.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i017

'How far from the first clue to the last in miles' — he called this impossible to answer given how the clues are structured.

A bearing-and-distance step would make first-to-last mileage meaningless.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i027

You do not need to be at the bride to identify her foot of three.

Foot of three is derivable remotely — from a map, a name, or a shape — consistent with stanza 3 being armchair-solvable.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i116

Backtracking. Asked whether you ever return to previously trodden ground while following the poem path: if you knew the entirety of the solution the answer is no, but going through the natural progression of the hunt the answer ...

A bearing taken from one point and walked from another is exactly the kind of loop this describes.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A (via user research)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i117

Poem structure. Asked whether the poem is linear, several geographic points miles apart, or a hybrid, he declined — then offered that there are some great movies out there: Indiana Jones and National Treasure. Read as a nudge ...

A bearing with no origin makes sense if it is one of two lines whose intersection is the X — the origin is supplied by another clue.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A (via user research)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i181

Netflix, per the hub: the clocks are confirmed relevant, and Posey called 4:19 on the Netflix clock 'a little uncanny'. Number 42 confirmed relevant at Seekers Summit 2026 with no public decode. (Our file has 4:02 and 5:26 ...

4:19 — four and nineteen, another indirect number to test against 'three at twenty'.

Posey statement · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w3 · i193

'From beginning to end of the poem... it will inherently create some sort of shape.' (JIBLE, Distances). Read with 'each clue is not meant to convey great distance' (Summit) and the Indiana Jones / National Treasure nudge: the ...

A shape needs lines: the bearing is one of them.

Posey statement · Likely · JIBLE 4.0 (jessinthewest / hi-imerica, upd. 9/30/25) via THAP hub

SUPPORTS · w1 · i208

Book verbatim, structure: chapters Seinfeld-style. Named: The Gracie Grail (Gracie's Antiques, Dillon — 'an arched entryway crowned with brick', 'the iron gate seemed to politely suggest this place had boundaries', a door that ...

A 'curious confluence' — waters meeting.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w1 · i209

Book verbatim, motifs: dedication 'thank you for being my north star'; 'Like four points of a compass, I've dedicated this treasure to four departed souls' (book order is authoritative, per Justin); Prologue opens 'Grid searching ...

A protractor in the stirrups — angles are a family trait.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w1 · i214

Numbers in the materials (hub): 42 (truck, Hitchhiker's), 4:19 clock, 17 steps (Brandon counting Shadow Feet the raccoon), 18–20 keys on the rancher's ring, 1979 (wedding photo), 113 (117–4), 6.73 mi, 111 (explicitly ...

20 sits in '18–20 keys' and 'twenty degree'.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w2 · i219

MW Sep 8 2025 — the 'right questions' from the X Q&A. On AI vs human: 'creating a puzzle for an intellect that dwarfs our own is a paradox... I really wanted to design something that embraces the core of what it means to be human... ...

Same.

Posey statement · Likely · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i244

'Foot of three' weakness admitted: the Rectory ridge has more than three named towers; getting to three requires picking an unjustified subgroup — fitting a number to a place. Readings left open: foot as a unit (three feet at a ...

Tower-counting is number-fitting

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026

SUPPORTS · w1 · i059

Tukuhnikivat's three-sided pyramid form is 'her foot of three'; twenty degrees is taken from her foot.

Shape reading of 'three'; the bearing reading of 'twenty degree'.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w1 · i075

Ask: Is 'her foot of three' a measurement, a bearing, or a shape? Does 'twenty degree' refer to a compass bearing?

Decides how the number line is used.

Question to ask · Unverified · Master file §13 — open questions

SUPPORTS · w1 · i079

Reading C — reverse the face on the map. Her face is the mountain's aspect; returning it means reversing which direction that face looks, done on paper. North face reversed gives the south side. Preserves the rotation, stays ...

Frees 'twenty degree' to attach to the foot.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i090

Full solve (Justin Greer, Jul 2026): Madison River, West Yellowstone. Start at Baker's Hole ('the Hole'), follow the Boundary Trail near the water, round the bend, face east toward the Madison Valley. The Three Brothers peaks ...

'Foot of three' as three aligned peaks giving a bearing.

Community claim · Unverified · Justin Greer, 'The Treasure I Found Along the Madison – A Full Solve' (Jul 31 2026) – via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i106

Sweetwater walkthrough, stanza 3–4: 'ursa east' as a heading — Highway 220 northeast along the river to the ancient gates = Devil's Gate on the Sweetwater. 'Her foot of three' = three landmarks east of Devil's Gate. 'Return her ...

Three landmarks as the foot of three.

Community claim · Unverified · TreasureNet full walkthrough, Apr 2026 – via user research

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i120

Reddit (u/PNW-OOTW, 9 up): Posey said in an interview that the poem isn't meant to convey a great distance.

A 20°/200° line run for miles from a summit would be a great distance.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapsedge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/PNW-OOTW)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i121

Reddit (u/Senior_Muscle_8829): each stanza puts you somewhere — levels in a game, or checkpoints you know are right — and the last few stanzas are where your area is dialed in and you go boots-on-the-ground to 'convey the said ...

The distance element lives in the late stanzas.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapsedge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/Senior_Muscle_8829)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i124

The structure probably isn't a walk. He wouldn't say whether the poem is linear or several points miles apart, then mentioned Indiana Jones and National Treasure — both about an object or device that reveals a location when ...

An origin-less bearing is a construction line, not a walking instruction.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i127

'Foot of three' is probably a measurement, not a shape. Three feet is a yard. Or 'three at twenty' reads as degrees and minutes: 3°20'. Stop trying to make it describe a mountain's geometry.

Measurement reading: a yard, or 3°20' — both are the kind of indirect number Posey confirmed.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i127

'Foot of three' is probably a measurement, not a shape. Three feet is a yard. Or 'three at twenty' reads as degrees and minutes: 3°20'. Stop trying to make it describe a mountain's geometry.

Against the Tukuñnikivat̚ three-sided-pyramid shape reading.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i131

Cross-reference: the Tetons are literally 'her' and literally 'three'. 'Les Trois Tétens' — the Grand, Middle and South Teton — were named by French trappers for a woman's breasts. 'Her foot of three' would then be the foot of ...

'Her foot of three' as the foot of the Three Tetons — the bride line, the three line and the 'her' all land on one named feature.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i146

Mountains and measurement: Mount Shasta was widely held to be California's highest peak in the 1850s–early 1860s; on July 6, 1864 the California Geological Survey named Mount Whitney the highest in California and the contiguous ...

A number given as a different kind of measure (prominence for elevation) is the sort of indirection Posey confirmed.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i156

'Cast your pole' → 'in ursa' is one navigational step, not two. The pole is the pole star; Polaris sits in Ursa Minor. 2:4 tells you to fix north, 3:1 tells you which bear ('only Ursa East matters, no west to consider' — a ...

Twenty degrees = 20° east of north — 3:1 restated as a number.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i158

New composite — Gates of the Mountains / Sleeping Giant / Beartooth (Helena, MT). The Gates of the Mountains on the Missouri is the most literal 'ancient gates' in the West (Lewis & Clark, 1805). The ridge north of Helena called ...

Three Forks: the Missouri's foot is three rivers.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i215

Mysterious Writings, 'Top 10 New Clues Found in Beyond the Map's Edge' (running list): (1) the book cover's torn outline matches the Big Hole River watershed, river through mountains; (2) hardcover-only images on pp. 4 and 117 → ...

44–26–1–11 as a coordinate pair: numbers indirectly encoded, as he confirmed.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack — Top 10 New Clues (via search summary)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i217

Cross-reference on the Twin Bridges reading: at Twin Bridges, Montana the Big Hole, the Beaverhead and the Ruby join to form the Jefferson. Lewis named those three forks in 1805 for Jefferson's virtues — Wisdom (Big Hole), ...

Three named rivers make one at Twin Bridges — a foot of three in his own Montana.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i221

MW Sep 8 2025 — word notes on 2:3–2:4. 'Round the bend': is 'Round' a name? Bend, Oregon (now eliminated); the Tucker poem p. 213 'took half my soul around the bend'; p. 149 'Tucker and Jennie rounded the bend'; p. 177 'Rounding ...

A shadow at a known time gives an angle.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text

SUPPORTS · w1 · i242

Sister Superior solve (Castle Valley, Moab): the Rectory ridge runs Castleton Tower, the Rectory, the Priest and Nuns, Sister Superior, the Convent — a nun is a bride of Christ. Gates = the valley mouth flanked by the Rectory ...

Three towers on one pedestal

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — working solve

L12 Return her face to find the place.

46 facts · 7 against

SUPPORTS · w1 · i150

Official FAQ (treasure.quest announcements): Are the clues in consecutive order? Yes. Is the treasure buried? 'If you know where to go, it wouldn't matter either way.' Exact spot or general area? 'If you've solved the poem in its ...

Exact location at the end of the poem.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest announcements FAQ (via r/TreasureHunting, u/Advanced_Relation_79)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i170

VERIFIED — Lemhi Pass (7,373 ft, Continental Divide, MT/ID): gravel but passenger-car OK; Sacajawea Memorial Area is a free Forest Service site 0.2 mi south of the pass. Sacagawea was taken by Hidatsa raiders near Three Forks ...

Her return, on the map's edge (the Divide).

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i194

'The key to one direction lies in another' — this line is a hidden audio message decoded from the ARKADE song 'Beyond the Map's Edge' (Netflix); Justin confirmed the associated technical clue, not as the core geographic solution. ...

The song's message is a direction-reversal instruction — 'return her face' in other words.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i199

Stanza 3 verbatim: 'Is return her face referring to the bride?' → punt (9/4/25); later 'her face belongs to her' → yes (Summit). 'Is the place in her face or her gaze?' → no clarity. 'Has the bride ever been alive?' → 'depends on ...

Her face is hers; place-in-face vs gaze left open.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i207

Logo: 'the angzarr symbol — I chose and modified it intentionally' (X Dark Matters). Angzarr is the Unicode glyph ⌵ (U+237C, 'right angle with downwards zigzag arrow'), a symbol with no known origin — a right angle plus a zigzag ...

A zigzag arrow that turns back: return.

Posey statement · Confirmed · X Dark Matters — Sep 4 2025 (JIBLE)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i225

Q: How far is 'her face' from 'the place'? Posey: probably not as far as many people think.

Face and place are close

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i229

Q: Are 'the place' and 'the sacred space' the same location? Posey: not necessarily.

Stanza 3 ends somewhere that may not be the treasure

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i230

Q: Does her face belong to the bride? Posey: yes (after hedging about two interpretations). Q: Is 'return her face' referring to the bride? Punted in September, answered yes at Seekers Summit.

Her face = the bride's face

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i008

A 'fair amount' can be solved from home. Boots on the ground are required for retrieval. If the poem is solved in its entirety, an exact location is given.

'Find the place' — the poem resolves to an exact spot, not a region.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i016

'No need to hike more than a mile to figure out where the treasure is at.' Searchers note this is not the same as 'to find it'.

'Find the place' — knowing where is a short walk; retrieving may be separate.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i020

Built-in checkpoint gives the reassuring feeling you aren't lost. It gives zero doubt you are trending right. You are at least halfway through the poem clues when you reach it. It is part of the poem, as a stage of the journey. ...

'Find the place' could be the checkpoint, with the sacred space beyond it.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i025

Her face does belong to the bride: yes. 'Return her face' does imply a physical rotation — 'the technically correct answer is yes.'

A mountain cannot be physically rotated. The Tukuñnikivat̚z facing-reversal reading needs a rotatable object — a map, an image, a carving.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i026

'Return her face to find the place' — the distance from her face to the place is 'probably not as far as many people might think.' Distance from the bride to the treasure: 'a matter of perspective.'

The place is near the face. A 200° bearing running miles from a summit is probably too far.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i031

Part of stanza 3 has been solved by searchers, at least in part. 'The place' (3:4) and 'the sacred space' (4:4) are not necessarily the same location.

'The place' is a real, distinct waypoint.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w3 · i116

Backtracking. Asked whether you ever return to previously trodden ground while following the poem path: if you knew the entirety of the solution the answer is no, but going through the natural progression of the hunt the answer ...

Direct support for 'return her face' = turn around and go back (Reading B) — a loop that does not break consecutive clue order.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A (via user research)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i116

Backtracking. Asked whether you ever return to previously trodden ground while following the poem path: if you knew the entirety of the solution the answer is no, but going through the natural progression of the hunt the answer ...

Cuts slightly against Reading C: a map-only reversal never puts your feet on trodden ground.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A (via user research)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i117

Poem structure. Asked whether the poem is linear, several geographic points miles apart, or a hybrid, he declined — then offered that there are some great movies out there: Indiana Jones and National Treasure. Read as a nudge ...

Return her face as the second line of the X.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A (via user research)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i123

Reddit (u/Theroguehippie1): reread the question he was asked. The 'not more than a mile' answer was about distance from your car to figure out where the treasure is — it says nothing about whether the clues convey distances at ...

'Figure out where' is not 'retrieve' — the place you identify within a mile of the car may not be where you end up.

Objection / constraint · Likely · r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/Theroguehippie1)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i182

Book, per the hub: the only explicit 'bride' in the book is a photo caption — 'From left: Grandpa Posey, Mom and Dad (aka the bride and groom), Grandma Posey, and Grandma Clements in September of 1979.' A photograph is a physical ...

Return her face: rotate the photograph. Satisfies 'technically a physical rotation' without moving a mountain.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i193

'From beginning to end of the poem... it will inherently create some sort of shape.' (JIBLE, Distances). Read with 'each clue is not meant to convey great distance' (Summit) and the Indiana Jones / National Treasure nudge: the ...

Return = the shape closes.

Posey statement · Likely · JIBLE 4.0 (jessinthewest / hi-imerica, upd. 9/30/25) via THAP hub

SUPPORTS · w2 · i208

Book verbatim, structure: chapters Seinfeld-style. Named: The Gracie Grail (Gracie's Antiques, Dillon — 'an arched entryway crowned with brick', 'the iron gate seemed to politely suggest this place had boundaries', a door that ...

'Lift and turn' — a rotation mechanic he wrote down.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w2 · i219

MW Sep 8 2025 — the 'right questions' from the X Q&A. On AI vs human: 'creating a puzzle for an intellect that dwarfs our own is a paradox... I really wanted to design something that embraces the core of what it means to be human... ...

'Formulating the distance question finds the answer' — the poem's own distance step (foot of three / twenty degree / return) IS the distance.

Posey statement · Likely · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i236

Lost-dog-poster checkpoint theory REJECTED: it fails three of Posey's statements. The checkpoint is both something he placed AND something already there (a poster is only placed); clues must stand the test of time (paper outdoors ...

A poster cannot be the checkpoint

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026

SUPPORTS · w1 · i042

Cover: the M in 'Map's' is cut short. Searchers propose the cover aperture matches a watershed or terrain outline; the working solve proposes Jeep Arch rotated 90°. Posey has said the interior map was designed by a third party ...

If the cover is her face, the rotation reading finally has an object that can be 'returned'.

Community claim · Unverified · Searcher observation + Beyond the Map's Edge (hardcover)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i060

Tukuhnikivat is usually translated as roughly 'where the sun sets last' — a direction-facing name. Reverse her facing: 20 becomes 200.

'Return her face' as reversing a bearing.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w1 · i073

Ask: Did you have any input on the book's cover art?

Decides whether the cover can be the bride's face.

Question to ask · Unverified · Master file §13 — open questions

SUPPORTS · w2 · i077

Reading A — back bearing. 'Twenty degree' is a compass bearing and 'return' reverses it: $20 + 180 = 200$. Standard surveying practice for working backward from a landmark to your own position.

Uses the confirmed distance element, the confirmed indirect numbers, and the confirmed physical rotation.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i077

Reading A — back bearing. 'Twenty degree' is a compass bearing and 'return' reverses it: $20 + 180 = 200$. Standard surveying practice for working backward from a landmark to your own position.

Still needs an origin, so it yields a line across the map, not a point.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i078

Reading B — go to the face and turn around. Walk to her face, reverse your own facing. 'Return' in its plain sense, which suits stanza 5's warning against clever readings; satisfies the rotation; fits 'her face is probably not as ...

Plainest reading; honours the rotation and the short-distance statement.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i078

Reading B — go to the face and turn around. Walk to her face, reverse your own facing. 'Return' in its plain sense, which suits stanza 5's warning against clever readings; satisfies the rotation; fits 'her face is probably not as ...

Strands 'twenty degree', which then has to attach to 'her foot of three'. And standing at the north face and turning around faces you away from the north basin.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i079

Reading C — reverse the face on the map. Her face is the mountain's aspect; returning it means reversing which direction that face looks, done on paper. North face reversed gives the south side. Preserves the rotation, stays ...

The only reading that currently produces a named place: Medicine Lakes.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i079

Reading C — reverse the face on the map. Her face is the mountain's aspect; returning it means reversing which direction that face looks, done on paper. North face reversed gives the south side. Preserves the rotation, stays ...

Most abstract of the three.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i080

Medicine Lakes, south side of Tukuñnikivatz near La Sal Pass: a named plural pair at Tuk's southern base. Trip accounts describe descending the peak with the Medicine Lakes reflecting below. The name is already plural, so ...

Reverse the north face and you land here.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i090

Full solve (Justin Greer, Jul 2026): Madison River, West Yellowstone. Start at Baker's Hole ('the Hole'), follow the Boundary Trail near the water, round the bend, face east toward the Madison Valley. The Three Brothers peaks ...

'Return' as returning along the same trail.

Community claim · Unverified · Justin Greer, 'The Treasure I Found Along the Madison — A Full Solve' (Jul 31 2026) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i106

Sweetwater walkthrough, stanza 3–4: 'ursa east' as a heading — Highway 220 northeast along the river to the ancient gates = Devil's Gate on the Sweetwater. 'Her foot of three' = three landmarks east of Devil's Gate. 'Return her ...

Turn around and go back — Reading B, independently reached.

Community claim · Unverified · TreasureNet full walkthrough, Apr 2026 — via user research

SUPPORTS · w2 · i118

The word 'find' appears exactly twice in the poem: 1:1 ('Can you find what lives in time') and 3:4 ('Return her face to find the place'). If stanza 1 is the reading method, the two uses may be pointing at each other.

'Find the place' echoes 1:1 — the place may be what lives in time, or be found the way stanza 1 says to read.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i119

Reddit (u/GreenEyes7141018, 13 up / 48 comments): what if the hunt is like National Treasure — each stanza is one location, and at that location is a clue giving the next. Offered to explain two Posey quotes: 'the key to one ...

'The key to one direction lies in another' reads as a direction reversed or derived from another direction — return her face.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/GreenEyes7141018)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i120

Reddit (u/PNW-OOTW, 9 up): Posey said in an interview that the poem isn't meant to convey a great distance.

Face to place is short — consistent with 'not as far as many think'.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/PNW-OOTW)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i124

The structure probably isn't a walk. He wouldn't say whether the poem is linear or several points miles apart, then mentioned Indiana Jones and National Treasure — both about an object or device that reveals a location when ...

Rotation as orienting a device or map, not turning your body — the Staff of Ra / Silence Dogood reading.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i127

'Foot of three' is probably a measurement, not a shape. Three feet is a yard. Or 'three at twenty' reads as degrees and minutes: 3°20'. Stop trying to make it describe a mountain's geometry.

A measured offset from the face gives the place — short, as he said.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i142

The report's own read of the mile statement: 'not more than a mile to figure out where the treasure is at' plus 'clues lead to the exact location' implies a final step — the mile takes you to the vicinity (perhaps the checkpoint) ...

'Find the place' as the observation step after the walk.

Community claim · Unverified · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i156

'Cast your pole' → 'in ursa' is one navigational step, not two. The pole is the pole star; Polaris sits in Ursa Minor. 2:4 tells you to fix north, 3:1 tells you which bear ('only Ursa East matters, no west to consider' — a ...

Return = the back-bearing, 200°.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i172

Lead — Alaska Basin. If 'return her face' turns the Tetons' famous east face around, the west side of the range is Teton Canyon and Alaska Basin (Jedediah Smith Wilderness, Caribou-Targhee NF, Idaho): free, dogs allowed, granite. ...

The reversed face lands on a basin named Alaska.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i175

Scan result — Provo Canyon / Timpanogos (UT): Bridal Veil Falls (free county park, dogs) is the maiden's tears in the Timpanogos legend; the mountain's skyline is her sleeping profile from the canyon — a named 'her face'. The ...

A named face.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i212

Hub community theories (all speculation): Hope Creek NE of Wisdom in the Anaconda-Pintler ('hope surges'); Lamar / Trout Creek; the Hidden Lake / Queener Mountain BOTG solve (Storm Lake Pass = gates, Queener = bride, triangular ...

6.73 mi with a decimal 'jump' — a hub reading of the distance element.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w2 · i233

Analysis: there are two destinations in the back half. 'The place' and 'the sacred space' are not necessarily the same. Stanza 3 ends somewhere; stanza 4 is somewhere else. Since the checkpoint sits at least halfway through the ...

'The place' may be the checkpoint

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026

L13 Double arcs on granite bold,

59 facts · 20 against

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i003

You DON'T need climbing gear or ropes, permission to enter private land, swimming skills, ladders or climbing skills, or a high-clearance vehicle.

The Corona Arch trail has a bolted ladder and safety cables. Not disqualifying — the rule says you don't need them, not that none exist — but it is an official statement pointing away from that trail.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest official rules

CONTRADICTS · w3 · i165

VERIFIED — The Sleeping Giant north of Helena is Beartooth Mountain (6,792 ft) on the maps; it lies west of the Missouri and Holter Lake, head to the EAST, feet to the west; the Gates of the Mountains are nearby. But the Gates ...

Limestone, not granite — the Gates cannot carry 4:1 literally.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w3 · i166

VERIFIED — Medicine Lakes (La Sals): reached by FR 238 off La Sal Pass Road, ~350 yards of road that 'requires a high-clearance 4-wheel-drive vehicle'; it is a trailhead and camping area with pit toilets and stocked rainbow ...

A trailhead with toilets is not 'not near any trail' or clear of structures.

Objection / constraint · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i167

VERIFIED — Torrey Lake petroglyphs (Dubois) are on sandstone boulders, not granite; a guided visit is recommended. Drop as a granite site.

Sandstone.

Objection / constraint · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i168

VERIFIED — Thermopolis: Hot Springs State Park is free but open 6 am–10 pm, so the site itself cannot be in the park; leashed dogs allowed on park trails. The Wedding of the Waters is 5 miles south, a Game & Fish public access ...

Granite at the north end, literal.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i178

Scan result — Independence Rock (WY): granite dome with 5,000+ emigrant names carved or greased on; no fee; dogs; 5 miles from Devil's Gate. Better stanza 4 than Split Rock for the Sweetwater solve ('secrets of the past still ...

Granite.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i187

CORRECTION — railroad tracks. Dillon (6/21/25): 'Do you consider railroad tracks a man-made structure?' → 'I consider them to be a man-made structure. Yes.' Summit (3/28/26): 'Based on how the rules are described, railroad tracks ...

The one man-made implication is optional — a natural-only path exists.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i199

Stanza 3 verbatim: 'Is return her face referring to the bride?' → punt (9/4/25); later 'her face belongs to her' → yes (Summit). 'Is the place in her face or her gaze?' → no clarity. 'Has the bride ever been alive?' → 'depends on ...

Double arcs as a bearing was not denied.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i205

Progress verbatim: 'Certainly the first stanza... at least a large portion, been solved. The second stanza, at least half of it' (9/4/25). 'Part of stanza 3 solved'; 'at least six clues' by the most-advanced searcher; 'people less ...

Within 200 ft of the checkpoint without recognizing it: small or unremarkable up close.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i014

Boots on the ground becomes absolutely required at stanza four. Implication: stanzas 1 through 3 are intended to be solvable from home.

Stanza 4 is where you must physically stand.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i021

The checkpoint is both something he placed AND something already there. Asked if it is tied to a topographic feature: 'there is some implication there.' Not something you need to worry about moving. Possible to be at it and not ...

'Double arcs on granite' could be marks he made on existing rock.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i023

'You'd be hard pressed to get all the way without seeing the checkpoint.' The audiobook adds a chapter containing the word 'checkpoint', widely read as confirming it cannot be identified from home.

If it can't be identified from home, it may be the first stanza-4 element.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i033

Punted on whether 'double arcs on granite bold' is the clue with the man-made implication — widely read as a soft yes, given the Hole was a clean no. At Dillon, would not say whether the arcs exist naturally or were created: 'a ...

If anything in the poem is man-made, this is the leading candidate: carved, built or placed arcs on rock.

Posey statement · Likely · Dillon, MT book signing Q&A (Jun 21 2025) via Mysterious Writings

CONTRADICTS · w3 · i039

Access to the location is free and available 24/7. It is NOT near any trail — deliberate, so it wouldn't be stumbled upon.

Corona and Bowtie Arch sit on a maintained, popular trail. The double arcs may be on-trail, but the sacred space is off it.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

CONTRADICTS · w3 · i066

Granite: Moab is sandstone; the La Sals are laccolithic intrusive rock. Neither is granite.

The poem says granite. Sandstone arches are not granite; if 'granite' is literal, Corona/Bowtie fail.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Master file §12 – constraints to reconcile

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i081

Constraint on Medicine Lakes: the La Sal Pass Road is rough. One climber reported a high-clearance Subaru failing in a wet year, with rangers suggesting a modified 4x4. Posey's rules say no high-clearance vehicle is needed. ...

An official rule points away from the favored basin unless a standard-car approach exists.

Objection / constraint · Likely · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i083

Constraint on Gold Basin: no named paired pools located there. Trip reports describe talus, avalanche paths and creek, not lakes. Unnamed tarns may exist but are unconfirmed. Higher and more snowbound than Medicine Lakes.

'Double' has nothing named to attach to on the north side.

Objection / constraint · Likely · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i094

Audiobook bonus chapter 'Los Camarones Calientes', set at Lukeville on the Arizona border, gives a 'Border Crossing Commandment – Lukeville Edition. Rule #1 – Carved in stone – never shall wheel touch checkpoint soil. Foot ...

Carved in stone is the man-made reading of arcs on rock.

Book text · Likely · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) – via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w3 · i101

Dillon: the entire hunt is based on naturally occurring structures and landscapes; depending which of the multiple solution paths you take, one clue has a man-made implication. He confirmed there are multiple valid ways to solve ...

Endorses the move from Corona Arch and the culvert to glacial pools: natural landscape first, one man-made implication at most, path-dependent.

Posey statement · Likely · Dillon, MT Q&A (Jun 21 2025) – via user research

SUPPORTS · w1 · i122

Reddit (u/PNW-00TW quoting Posey): 'How far from your car do you need to go? You don't need to hike a great distance. You don't need to hike more than a mile to figure out where the treasure is at.' Commenter's read: with 'a fair ...

Medicine Lakes at La Sal Pass is the kind of place this describes.

Posey statement · Likely · r/beyondthemap's edge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/PNW-00TW, quoting Posey)

CONTRADICTS · w3 · i135

Cross-reference: 'granite' is literal in every rival solve and figurative only in the La Sals. Split Rock, City of Rocks, the Pioneers and the Teton core are granite; Moab is sandstone, the La Sals laccolith, Devils Tower ...

La Sal and Devils Tower readings need 'granite' to be loose; four rivals do not.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i135

Cross-reference: 'granite' is literal in every rival solve and figurative only in the La Sals. Split Rock, City of Rocks, the Pioneers and the Teton core are granite; Moab is sandstone, the La Sals laccolith, Devils Tower ...

Literal granite is the plain reading stanza 5 asks for.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i159

Rule-outs from the statements we hold. City of Rocks: 2:1–2:2 must be a pair several searchers have solved, within walking distance of 2:3 — the Reserve has no water worth a line, so stanza 2 cannot be assigned there. Sweetwater: ...

City of Rocks and Sweetwater are stanza-4-first solves with no stanza 2.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i179

Hub constraints table (Posey, per the hub): the site is below 11,000 ft; clues may cross state lines; the location is less than a mile from a car; access 24/7, no fee; not in a pay park, national-park fee area or restricted zone. ...

Rules out the highest La Sal and Uinta options.

Posey statement · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w3 · i182

Book, per the hub: the only explicit 'bride' in the book is a photo caption — 'From left: Grandpa Posey, Mom and Dad (aka the bride and groom), Grandma Posey, and Grandma Clements in September of 1979.' A photograph is a physical ...

Brandon's memorial is a granite boulder Justin pushed — the poem's granite may be a memorial stone, and the double arcs a mark on it.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i183

Book gazetteer, per the hub: places named in the memoir — Dillon, Big Hole Valley, Beaverhead Valley, Wisdom (in the Grasshopper Valley chapter), Polaris MT (explicitly named), Pioneer Mountains, Crystal Park, Bannack, Blacktail ...

Crystal Park — a granite dig — is in the book.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w3 · i211

Book geography verbatim: 'the Big Hole's crystal waters'; Grasshopper Valley 'flanked by the Big Hole Valley'; 'At night, the sky in Grasshopper Valley is so star-spangled... thumbing through your mental Rolodex for ...

Wet granite at Crystal Park — granite in his own Montana words.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w1 · i219

MW Sep 8 2025 — the 'right questions' from the X Q&A. On AI vs human: 'creating a puzzle for an intellect that dwarfs our own is a paradox... I really wanted to design something that embraces the core of what it means to be human... ...

Checkpoint found by an action on site — consistent with 'something must be manipulated'.

Posey statement · Likely · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i243

Unresolved conflicts in the Sister Superior solve: direction — Castle Valley is northwest of Waas/Manns and northeast of Moab, not east; sequence — Castle Valley opens off SR-128 at the same junction as Matrimony Spring (S2L1), ...

Moab stanza 4 has no candidate

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026

SUPPORTS · w1 · i042

Cover: the M in 'Map's' is cut short. Searchers propose the cover aperture matches a watershed or terrain outline; the working solve proposes Jeep Arch rotated 90°. Posey has said the interior map was designed by a third party ...

An arch on the cover would put an arch in the poem.

Community claim · Unverified · Searcher observation + Beyond the Map's Edge (hardcover)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i061

Corona Arch and Bowtie Arch, paired within a few hundred feet on one trail off 279. Corona means crown; a bowtie is a groom's — the wedding pair. The trail's bolted cable and ladder supply a man-made element.

Two arcs, side by side, with a marriage reading.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w3 · i080

Medicine Lakes, south side of Tukuhnikivatz near La Sal Pass: a named plural pair at Tuk's southern base. Trip accounts describe descending the peak with the Medicine Lakes reflecting below. The name is already plural, so ...

Double, by name, at the foot of the bride.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i082

Gold Basin / Tuk cirque, north side of Tukuhnikivatz, drained by a Brumley Creek tributary — reached via Geyser Pass Road to Gold Basin Road. Cirques are arc-shaped by definition: curved headwalls cut into bold rock, so 'double ...

Arcs as landform, at the bride's foot.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i089

Community: Hole 'N The Rock, the roadside attraction south of Moab in San Juan County, as 'the Hole'; Corona and Bowtie Arch west of Moab as the 'double arcs' — the most-cited Utah reading online.

Independent arrival at Corona/Bowtie, for what that is worth.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i090

Full solve (Justin Greer, Jul 2026): Madison River, West Yellowstone. Start at Baker's Hole ('the Hole'), follow the Boundary Trail near the water, round the bend, face east toward the Madison Valley. The Three Brothers peaks ...

Granite is real in the Madison range, unlike Moab.

Community claim · Unverified · Justin Greer, 'The Treasure I Found Along the Madison — A Full Solve' (Jul 31 2026) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w3 · i106

Sweetwater walkthrough, stanza 3–4: 'ursa east' as a heading — Highway 220 northeast along the river to the ancient gates = Devil's Gate on the Sweetwater. 'Her foot of three' = three landmarks east of Devil's Gate. 'Return her ...

Split Rock is actual granite with an actual notch — the only circulating reading where 'granite' is literal.

Community claim · Unverified · TreasureNet full walkthrough, Apr 2026 — via user research

SUPPORTS · w1 · i119

Reddit (u/GreenEyes7141018, 13 up / 48 comments): what if the hunt is like National Treasure — each stanza is one location, and at that location is a clue giving the next. Offered to explain two Posey quotes: 'the key to one ...

Stanza 4 as location three, where the on-site clue is found.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapsguide, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/GreenEyes7141018)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i121

Reddit (u/Senior_Muscle_8829): each stanza puts you somewhere — levels in a game, or checkpoints you know are right — and the last few stanzas are where your area is dialed in and you go boots-on-the-ground to 'convey the said ...

Stanza 4 as the on-the-ground distance step — matches 'BOTG required at stanza four'.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapsedge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/Senior_Muscle_8829)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i124

The structure probably isn't a walk. He wouldn't say whether the poem is linear or several points miles apart, then mentioned Indiana Jones and National Treasure — both about an object or device that reveals a location when ...

Explains the armchair boundary: the construction resolves on paper, and stanza 4 is where you go stand on the result.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i126

Checks on Bear Lodge from what I know, unverified on the ground: Devils Tower National Monument charges an entrance fee and the rock is phonolite porphyry, not granite; the Belle Fourche River bends past the base ('waters' silent ...

Not granite, if the arcs are meant to be at the tower.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i128

City of Rocks, Idaho (~42.07°N — the parallel the 42 clues point at). Actual granite, so 'granite bold' is literal. California Trail landmark where emigrants wrote their names on the rock in axle grease, still legible: secrets of ...

Literal granite, a paired formation, natural arches.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i129

Granite Creek / Jackson Hole, Wyoming. 'The Hole' capitalized reads as Jackson Hole, and Posey called the hole-in-the-name question on the nose rather than shutting it down. Granite Hot Springs sits up Granite Creek off the ...

Granite by name and by rock.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i130

Pioneer Mountains, Montana — the Wisdom theory run through Polaris instead of the town. Elkhorn Hot Springs supplies the surge, Polaris supplies ursa and the north star, the Big Hole River supplies the fishing and the Hole. The ...

Granitic range; Crystal Park is a public dig in it.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i131

Cross-reference: the Tetons are literally 'her' and literally 'three'. 'Les Trois Tétens' — the Grand, Middle and South Teton — were named by French trappers for a woman's breasts. 'Her foot of three' would then be the foot of ...

Teton core is granite and gneiss.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i153

Elevation check against Rule 42 (approximate): Potash Rd / Corona ≈ 4,000 ft (below a mile); Devils Tower base ≈ 4,200; Big Hole / Wisdom ≈ 6,000; City of Rocks ≈ 6,000; Jackson / Granite Hot Springs ≈ 6,200–6,900; Split Rock ≈ ...

Whichever reading holds, it splits the board cleanly — settle it before spending a trip.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i154

Checkpoint = the double arcs. Cross-referencing five statements: the checkpoint is something he placed AND something already there; it has 'some implication' of a topographic feature; the audiobook calls it 'carved in stone'; one ...

Placed + already there + carved in stone + the one man-made implication = a carving on granite.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i155

What are 'double arcs'? Candidates that are literal shapes, not place names: a HEART (two arcs — 'a place that's dear to my heart', Heart Lake in the safe combination, a hunt dedicated to four dead, lovers' carvings on rock); ...

Heart = double arcs; 'dear to my heart' is Posey's own phrase for the site.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i157

New composite — Thermopolis / Wind River Canyon / Wedding of the Waters (WY). Big Spring in Hot Springs State Park: the world's largest mineral hot spring, surging, free, 24/7 ('hope surges, clear and bright'). Wind River Canyon ...

Precambrian granite at the canyon's north end; bighorn horns as arcs.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i162

Cross-reference on the footprint: the free / 24-7 / dogs gate puts the site outside the park, but the Fenn epicenter is the park's west and north edges. The overlap is the ring of national forest just outside: Hebgen Lake and the ...

Upper and Lower Mesa Falls — a double, on the same river.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w3 · i174

Scan result — Hole-in-the-Wall (Kaycee, WY): a natural gap in the Red Wall, capital-H on every map; BLM, fee-free Outlaw Cave campground; Middle Fork Powder blue-ribbon; Rock Art Cave petroglyphs and an ancient cairn line. 'His ...

Sandstone.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i175

Scan result — Provo Canyon / Timpanogos (UT): Bridal Veil Falls (free county park, dogs) is the maiden's tears in the Timpanogos legend; the mountain's skyline is her sleeping profile from the canyon — a named 'her face'. The ...

Limestone.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i176

Scan result — Blue Hole, Santa Rosa NM: a bell-shaped artesian sinkhole, 3,000 gal/min, 62°F, crystal clear, tied to the Pecos; north of the Santa Fe cutoff. Against: a city dive park with structures and a grate; no granite, no ...

Nothing for stanza 4.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i186

Hub readings of 'double arcs on granite bold': two carved or natural U-curves on a granite boulder or cliff; double rainbows or river curves reflected in granite; two horseshoe shapes (his mother's barrel racing); two ...

'Bold' as visible from a distance cuts against a small carving and toward a landmark.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i186

Hub readings of 'double arcs on granite bold': two carved or natural U-curves on a granite boulder or cliff; double rainbows or river curves reflected in granite; two horseshoe shapes (his mother's barrel racing); two ...

Against my checkpoint-as-small-carving reading, if 'bold' means big.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i212

Hub community theories (all speculation): Hope Creek NE of Wisdom in the Anaconda-Pintler ('hope surges'); Lamar / Trout Creek; the Hidden Lake / Queener Mountain BOTG solve (Storm Lake Pass = gates, Queener = bride, triangular ...

A bridge is a man-made structure — a bridge cannot be the site, only a mark.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w2 · i217

Cross-reference on the Twin Bridges reading: at Twin Bridges, Montana the Big Hole, the Beaverhead and the Ruby join to form the Jefferson. Lewis named those three forks in 1805 for Jefferson's virtues — Wisdom (Big Hole), ...

Tobacco Roots: literal granite east of the confluence.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i217

Cross-reference on the Twin Bridges reading: at Twin Bridges, Montana the Big Hole, the Beaverhead and the Ruby join to form the Jefferson. Lewis named those three forks in 1805 for Jefferson's virtues — Wisdom (Big Hole), ...

No double arcs identified.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i246

Eastern Beartooths case: a bear-named range with a real east half; granitic against the volcanic Absarokas; Granite Peak is the state high point; rock dated ~3.96 billion years, so 'secrets of the past still hold' and 'beyond the ...

Granite

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — regions compared

SUPPORTS · w2 · i247

Pioneer Mountains / Big Hole / Beaverhead case: by far the strongest book support (Dillon signing; Wisdom, Big Hole, Polaris, Pioneers, Bannack, Crystal Park, Blacktail Deer Creek, Clark Canyon, Red Rock River); Pioneer batholith ...

Pioneer batholith granite

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — regions compared

L14 Where secrets of the past still hold.

16 facts · 0 against

SUPPORTS · w1 · i164

VERIFIED — Lewis named the Big Hole River the 'Wisdom' on Aug 6 1805 (with the Philanthropy, now the Ruby) for Jefferson's virtues; fur trappers later renamed it the Big Hole, 'hole' being their word for a mountain valley. The ...

Secrets of the past still hold in the old name.

Book text · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i168

VERIFIED — Thermopolis: Hot Springs State Park is free but open 6 am–10 pm, so the site itself cannot be in the park; leashed dogs allowed on park trails. The Wedding of the Waters is 5 miles south, a Game & Fish public access ...

Old dam abutments — a past that still holds, and a dam the map omits.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i178

Scan result — Independence Rock (WY): granite dome with 5,000+ emigrant names carved or greased on; no fee; dogs; 5 miles from Devil's Gate. Better stanza 4 than Split Rock for the Sweetwater solve ('secrets of the past still ...

Names that still hold.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i204

Site verbatim: 'a place that is important to me, and a place that I've known about for quite some time'; meaningful for beauty, symbolism AND sentiment ('all of the above'); 'physical objects along the way — fair to say there ...

Personal lore and secrets at the site.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i019

Something will need to be manipulated in order to see the treasure; depending on conditions a flashlight could be helpful. Punted separately on whether you need to move any rocks.

'Secrets still hold' — hidden until manipulated.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i045

Audiobook: 'The' is added to the chapter title 'Trailside Troubles' (p. 113 hardcover). In 'The Treasure Trail' (p. 185) there is a search list; the narrator adds that two entries remained uncrossed.

Two uncrossed entries — secrets of the past that still hold.

Book text · Likely · Audiobook vs hardcover comparison

SUPPORTS · w2 · i211

Book geography verbatim: 'the Big Hole's crystal waters'; Grasshopper Valley 'flanked by the Big Hole Valley'; 'At night, the sky in Grasshopper Valley is so star-spangled... thumbing through your mental Rolodex for ...

Bannack, Plummer, hidden gold — secrets of the past.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w1 · i062

Petroglyph panels and dinosaur tracks along the Potash corridor are 'secrets of the past still hold'. Thematic, not pinned.

Thematic fit.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w1 · i065

The Old Spanish Trail ran from Santa Fe past the La Sals, connecting the region to Fenn country.

Secrets of the past along the corridor.

Community claim · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w2 · i084

Lines 4:2–4:4 applied to whichever basin: the sediment record on the pool floors (undisturbed layers back to deglaciation — pollen, charcoal, ash, isotopes; researchers core exactly these lakes) is 'secrets of the past'; the same ...

Sediment record as the secret that still holds.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i128

City of Rocks, Idaho (~42.07°N — the parallel the 42 clues point at). Actual granite, so 'granite bold' is literal. California Trail landmark where emigrants wrote their names on the rock in axle grease, still legible: secrets of ...

Emigrant signatures in axle grease — secrets of the past, still holding.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i130

Pioneer Mountains, Montana — the Wisdom theory run through Polaris instead of the town. Elkhorn Hot Springs supplies the surge, Polaris supplies ursa and the north star, the Big Hole River supplies the fishing and the Hole. The ...

Digging for crystals — secrets of the past.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i143

The map as a time anchor. Read the book's map not as modern geography but as a historical lens: place names changed, rivers and creeks were relabeled, section lines drawn later, towns existed before boundaries were final. The map ...

Secrets of the past still hold: old names on a modern outline.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i154

Checkpoint = the double arcs. Cross-referencing five statements: the checkpoint is something he placed AND something already there; it has 'some implication' of a topographic feature; the audiobook calls it 'carved in stone'; one ...

'Secrets of the past still hold' — a carving that keeps.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i174

Scan result — Hole-in-the-Wall (Kaycee, WY): a natural gap in the Red Wall, capital-H on every map; BLM, fee-free Outlaw Cave campground; Middle Fork Powder blue-ribbon; Rock Art Cave petroglyphs and an ancient cairn line. 'His ...

Outlaw caches and petroglyphs.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i246

Eastern Beartooths case: a bear-named range with a real east half; granitic against the volcanic Absarokas; Granite Peak is the state high point; rock dated ~3.96 billion years, so 'secrets of the past still hold' and 'beyond the ...

3.96-billion-year rock

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — regions compared

L15 Beyond the reach of time's swift race,

7 facts · 0 against

SUPPORTS · w3 · i210

Tucker poem (p. 213, Mountain Memory) — confirmed helpful: 'Tucker, once my earthly friend, / Took half my soul around the bend'; 'In the mountain's hushed solitude, where the air is crisp and the trees stand in silent reverence, ...

'Mortal coil' — 4:3 is the Tucker poem's line restated.

Book text · Confirmed · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w2 · i012

All clues are expected to stand the test of time; he will announce if something drastic changes.

'Beyond the reach of time's swift race' — the clues, and the site, endure.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i063

The river and the canyon it cut are 'time's swift race'; arch country over the site is 'wonder guards this sacred space'. Thematic.

Thematic fit.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w2 · i084

Lines 4:2–4:4 applied to whichever basin: the sediment record on the pool floors (undisturbed layers back to deglaciation — pollen, charcoal, ash, isotopes; researchers core exactly these lakes) is 'secrets of the past'; the same ...

L2 and L3 read as one continuous statement — what consecutive order should produce.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i145

Where are the dams? Major reservoirs are missing from the map though obvious on any modern sheet: Hoover / Lake Mead, Glen Canyon / Lake Powell, Fort Peck, Oroville, Grand Coulee. Rivers are drawn as if never dammed — pre-dam cartography.

Rivers 'beyond the reach of time's swift race' — drawn before they were altered.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i157

New composite — Thermopolis / Wind River Canyon / Wedding of the Waters (WY). Big Spring in Hot Springs State Park: the world's largest mineral hot spring, surging, free, 24/7 ('hope surges, clear and bright'). Wind River Canyon ...

2.9-billion-year rock — beyond time's swift race.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i246

Eastern Beartooths case: a bear-named range with a real east half; granitic against the volcanic Absarokas; Granite Peak is the state high point; rock dated ~3.96 billion years, so 'secrets of the past still hold' and 'beyond the ...

Oldest rock = beyond time's reach

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — regions compared

L16 Wonder guards this sacred space.

80 facts · 24 against

SUPPORTS · w2 · i001

Hunt Items (the treasure, the checkpoint and any placed clue) are NOT underwater, on private property, in caves, mines or tunnels, anywhere that needs rappelling, associated with man-made buildings, near graves or grave markers, ...

Site constraint: wherever the sacred space is, it is none of these.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest official rules

SUPPORTS · w1 · i002

All Hunt Items ARE more than 1 mile from anywhere Posey, his family or friends live, work or own property (including their businesses); on publicly accessible land anyone can visit; safe to get to.

Site constraint.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest official rules

SUPPORTS · w1 · i003

You DON'T need climbing gear or ropes, permission to enter private land, swimming skills, ladders or climbing skills, or a high-clearance vehicle.

Site constraint: reachable without gear.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest official rules

SUPPORTS · w2 · i150

Official FAQ (treasure.quest announcements): Are the clues in consecutive order? Yes. Is the treasure buried? 'If you know where to go, it wouldn't matter either way.' Exact spot or general area? 'If you've solved the poem in its ...

'Wouldn't matter either way' — the container is concealed in a way that makes buried-or-not moot: covered, wedged, or inside something.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest announcements FAQ (via r/TreasureHunting, u/Advanced_Relation_79)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i151

Official FAQ: 'Can I bring my dog? If your dog is the outdoors type, absolutely!' Dogs are barred from trails and backcountry in Yellowstone and Grand Teton and most national parks; they are allowed on national forest and BLM ...

A site on a no-dogs park trail fails a direct FAQ answer.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest announcements FAQ (via r/TreasureHunting, u/Advanced_Relation_79)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i151

Official FAQ: 'Can I bring my dog? If your dog is the outdoors type, absolutely!' Dogs are barred from trails and backcountry in Yellowstone and Grand Teton and most national parks; they are allowed on national forest and BLM ...

Forest Service and BLM land pass — the Hoback, Big Hole, Pioneers, City of Rocks, Sweetwater all do.

Posey statement · Confirmed · treasure.quest announcements FAQ (via r/TreasureHunting, u/Advanced_Relation_79)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i163

VERIFIED — Sinks Canyon, Lander WY: the Middle Fork of the Popo Agie disappears into a limestone cavern ('the Sinks') and reappears about a quarter mile downstream at 'the Rise', a clear pool of huge trout, after ~2 hours ...

Free, 24/7, dogs, natural.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i166

VERIFIED — Medicine Lakes (La Sals): reached by FR 238 off La Sal Pass Road, ~350 yards of road that 'requires a high-clearance 4-wheel-drive vehicle'; it is a trailhead and camping area with pit toilets and stocked rainbow ...

Same.

Objection / constraint · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i168

VERIFIED — Thermopolis: Hot Springs State Park is free but open 6 am–10 pm, so the site itself cannot be in the park; leashed dogs allowed on park trails. The Wedding of the Waters is 5 miles south, a Game & Fish public access ...

Inside the state park is out (hours); the site must be canyon-side or at the access area.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i169

VERIFIED — Beaverhead Rock State Park: the landmark 'may be viewed and photographed from a distance but is not directly accessible'; non-residents pay \$8 per vehicle. Clark's bearings confirm it as the feature Sacagawea named. As ...

Fee for non-residents if the site were there; it cannot be — the rock is inaccessible.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i178

Scan result — Independence Rock (WY): granite dome with 5,000+ emigrant names carved or greased on; no fee; dogs; 5 miles from Devil's Gate. Better stanza 4 than Split Rock for the Sweetwater solve ('secrets of the past still ...

Rest area buildings.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i187

CORRECTION — railroad tracks. Dillon (6/21/25): 'Do you consider railroad tracks a man-made structure?' → 'I consider them to be a man-made structure. Yes.' Summit (3/28/26): 'Based on how the rules are described, railroad tracks ...

Not at railroad tracks. Not close to any man-made trail — 'a little ways off'.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i189

Not private property — reiterated emphatically June 2026 after reports of trespassing: 'the treasure is not on private property', already stated in rules, posts and interviews. Federal vs state land: 'No, but it's publicly ...

Public land, period.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i196

Container: 'Who says it's a box?' (4/9/25). 'Targeted and deliberate modifications' to an existing object; some searchers have guessed it correctly; 'extremely recognizable — anybody who watched the series or read my book will ...

Something 60 lb and briefcase-sized, modified, concealed so that something must be moved to see it.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Treasure Hunt With Us podcast — Apr 9 2025 (THAP)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i203

Hiding verbatim: two 2023 journeys totaling 9,000+ miles (first was reconnaissance), off-grid; 'no hint meant to be read into 9,000 miles'; at least four trips from the car, all within a 24-hour span, with a broken tibia, not his ...

A four-trip carry within a day on a broken leg from a normal car: the site is close, gentle and drivable-to.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i204

Site verbatim: 'a place that is important to me, and a place that I've known about for quite some time'; meaningful for beauty, symbolism AND sentiment ('all of the above'); 'physical objects along the way — fair to say there ...

Nothing shows at 15 ft; something is manipulated; digging not ruled out — a covered or wedged cache, not a visible one.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i210

Tucker poem (p. 213, Mountain Memory) — confirmed helpful: 'Tucker, once my earthly friend, / Took half my soul around the bend'; 'In the mountain's hushed solitude, where the air is crisp and the trees stand in silent reverence, ...

'Where earth and memory converge' — the sacred space is a memorial spot.

Book text · Confirmed · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w2 · i229

Q: Are 'the place' and 'the sacred space' the same location? Posey: not necessarily.

The sacred space can be a different location from 'the place'

Posey statement · Confirmed · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i004

'If you need rope then it's not the right location.' Searchers are going too deep into wilderness, rappelling into caves and searching cliffsides. Nothing dangerous is required. Asked point blank where it is: on earth, in the ...

The sacred space is close to access and benign — not a cliff, not a cave.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i008

A 'fair amount' can be solved from home. Boots on the ground are required for retrieval. If the poem is solved in its entirety, an exact location is given.

Retrieval happens here; the rest can be worked from home.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i011

The map is useful. The treasure is hidden within the printed map, not beyond its edge.

Bounds the site to the book's printed map.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i018

'By the time you're going to get the treasure you're not searching, you're retrieving.' Once you figure out exactly where it is, you will have sufficient time to plan how you wish to retrieve it.

Retrieval is a planned act, not a scramble.

Posey statement · Likely · X Marks the Pod (Sep 4 2025)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i019

Something will need to be manipulated in order to see the treasure; depending on conditions a flashlight could be helpful. Punted separately on whether you need to move any rocks.

The sacred space conceals: something guards or covers the container.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i031

Part of stanza 3 has been solved by searchers, at least in part. 'The place' (3:4) and 'the sacred space' (4:4) are not necessarily the same location.

The sacred space may lie beyond the place the bride's face reveals.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i037

Confirmed he had at some point searched for the Fenn chest within 75 miles of where he hid his own treasure — then walked it back, not wanting people to think he'd eliminated states, and questioned whether Fenn's site was even in ...

Weak regional bound: somewhere he once searched for Fenn, within 75 miles.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i039

Access to the location is free and available 24/7. It is NOT near any trail — deliberate, so it wouldn't be stumbled upon.

Site constraint: off-trail, free, always open — rules out fee areas with gates and hours.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i043

'The Concrete Kiss': the Big Hill speed-bump line says Idaho in hardcover (p. 43) but Utah in the audiobook. The hill illustration is on page 42. Idaho and Utah share the 42nd parallel.

A deliberate Idaho → Utah swap puts Utah in play; 42 ties the page to the parallel.

Book text · Likely · Audiobook vs hardcover comparison

SUPPORTS · w1 · i049

Roughly 60 pounds including container. Mostly gold: bars, precious gems, rare coins, a meteorite, historical artifacts dating to 561 BC, items from the Forrest Fenn chest, and a Bitcoin wallet funded by book sales. Container ...

Sixty pounds sets the retrieval problem — somewhere you can reach and carry out from without gear.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w2 · i101

Dillon: the entire hunt is based on naturally occurring structures and landscapes; depending which of the multiple solution paths you take, one clue has a man-made implication. He confirmed there are multiple valid ways to solve ...

The site is a natural place; searchers have been within two miles of it.

Posey statement · Likely · Dillon, MT Q&A (Jun 21 2025) — via user research

SUPPORTS · w2 · i122

Reddit (u/PNW-00TW quoting Posey): 'How far from your car do you need to go? You don't need to hike a great distance. You don't need to hike more than a mile to figure out where the treasure is at.' Commenter's read: with 'a fair ...

The site is within a mile of a car — a drivable pass with a trailhead fits; a deep cirque does not.

Posey statement · Likely · r/beyondthemapsedge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/PNW-00TW, quoting Posey)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i132

Cross-reference: 'access is free and available 24/7' quietly rules out the inside of any fee-entry unit. Grand Teton, Yellowstone and Devils Tower charge entry; the surrounding national forests and BLM land do not. Posey refusing ...

Any site inside a fee-entry park fails 'free and available 24/7'.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i132

Cross-reference: 'access is free and available 24/7' quietly rules out the inside of any fee-entry unit. Grand Teton, Yellowstone and Devils Tower charge entry; the surrounding national forests and BLM land do not. Posey refusing ...

A site just outside a park boundary satisfies both this and 'not ruling parks out'.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i133

Cross-reference: Fenn's chest was found in Wyoming (Fenn confirmed the state, June 2020; the finder, Jack Stuef, never gave the spot). Posey bought that chest from Stuef and said he had at some point searched for it within 75 ...

Wyoming solves clear the 75-mile Fenn gate without argument.

Posey statement · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i136

Posey has said that during his Fenn search he believes he was extremely close to the chest's location in Yellowstone — possibly within 10–15 feet — and missed it. Fenn's chest was found in Wyoming in June 2020 by Jack Stuef. ...

Yellowstone is where he searched hardest for Fenn. 'Within 75 miles of somewhere I searched for Fenn' now has a named center: the Yellowstone / Jackson Hole / West Yellowstone corridor.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i137

The container is a Saddleback Leather 16-inch 'Grandfather' briefcase, about 60 lb loaded — not a chest. Contents: PAMP Suisse kilo gold bars, gold flakes and dust, coins across eras, large loose emeralds, rubies and amethysts, ...

A 16-inch briefcase is the object that must fit in, and be manipulated out of, the sacred space.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i138

Posey's grandfather was reportedly a fish-and-game warden in Montana, where Posey spent summers exploring (one forum notes an obituary calling the grandfather a lifelong New Mexico resident). Community discussion says Posey owns ...

A place dear to his heart, dedicated to a grandfather who worked Montana fish-and-game — Montana water is a natural fit.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i138

Posey's grandfather was reportedly a fish-and-game warden in Montana, where Posey spent summers exploring (one forum notes an obituary calling the grandfather a lifelong New Mexico resident). Community discussion says Posey owns ...

If he owns Montana property, the site must be more than a mile from it — a constraint, not a pointer.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i140

Rules restated in the report: no specialized knowledge needed; no dangerous water crossings; not associated with any structure; accessible 24/7 with no fee (the report reads this as likely excluding fee-entry National Parks); ...

Free, 24/7, no structure, no dangerous crossing — a benign, non-park, near-road site.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i160

The 75-mile exchange, as transcribed (Seekers Summit, Mar 28 2026). Q: 'Is the location where you hid your treasure within 75 miles of a place where you searched for the Forrest Fenn chest?' A: 'I searched a lot of places, guys. ...

A yes — but 'at some point' and 'a lot of places' make the radius large, not a pointer.

Posey statement · Likely · Seekers Summit transcript via Mysterious Writings (relayed by Google AI overview)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i173

VERIFIED — Posey's summers were at the family cabin in Montana where his grandfather was a fish-and-game warden; he explored the nearby hills with a metal detector. The rules put every hunt item more than a mile from property his ...

A Montana site near, but more than a mile from, a family cabin — find the cabin and you have a ring.

Posey statement · Likely · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i173

VERIFIED — Posey's summers were at the family cabin in Montana where his grandfather was a fish-and-game warden; he explored the nearby hills with a metal detector. The rules put every hunt item more than a mile from property his ...

Not within a mile of it.

Posey statement · Likely · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i179

Hub constraints table (Posey, per the hub): the site is below 11,000 ft; clues may cross state lines; the location is less than a mile from a car; access 24/7, no fee; not in a pay park, national-park fee area or restricted zone. ...

Under 11,000 ft — every basin above that is out (Gold Basin is marginal).

Posey statement · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i182

Book, per the hub: the only explicit 'bride' in the book is a photo caption — 'From left: Grandpa Posey, Mom and Dad (aka the bride and groom), Grandma Posey, and Grandma Clements in September of 1979.' A photograph is a physical ...

A memorial site: 'wonder guards this sacred space'.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w3 · i183

Book gazetteer, per the hub: places named in the memoir — Dillon, Big Hole Valley, Beaverhead Valley, Wisdom (in the Grasshopper Valley chapter), Polaris MT (explicitly named), Pioneer Mountains, Crystal Park, Bannack, Blacktail ...

The grandfather's territory: the Grasshopper Valley (Polaris, Elkhorn Hot Springs, Crystal Park) is where the family cabin most plausibly sits — and the site must be more than a mile from it.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i183

Book gazetteer, per the hub: places named in the memoir — Dillon, Big Hole Valley, Beaverhead Valley, Wisdom (in the Grasshopper Valley chapter), Polaris MT (explicitly named), Pioneer Mountains, Crystal Park, Bannack, Blacktail ...

Clark Canyon Reservoir is a dam the map omits.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i209

Book verbatim, motifs: dedication 'thank you for being my north star'; 'Like four points of a compass, I've dedicated this treasure to four departed souls' (book order is authoritative, per Justin); Prologue opens 'Grid searching ...

'Standing guard' is his phrase for protective landforms.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i213

Hub 'contradictions to watch': (1) 'not associated with any man-made structure' (Cowlazars, strongest) vs 'exterior of a structure — always a possibility' (X Marks); (2) 'leans armchair' vs BOTG from stanza 4; (3) verbal answers ...

Written statements outrank verbal ones — the rules page is the gate, the Q&A is color.

Objection / constraint · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy

SUPPORTS · w1 · i235

Tucker thread: Posey's Vizsla Tucker, trained by hide-and-seek on trails, appears throughout the Netflix documentary; the dog illustrated beneath the treasure poem in the book is a Vizsla. The memorial poem 'Mountain Memory' (p. ...

'Where earth and memory converge' echoes the sacred space

Book text · Likely · Beyond the Map's Edge p. 213 'Mountain Memory' + Netflix (session notes Sep 6 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i240

Against reading the haystack swap as a pointer: he removed the word, and an omission has no direction — 'he avoided it because it gives the place away' and 'because it is irrelevant' are equally available. 'Football field' may be ...

'Football field' as a size of the search area

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026

SUPPORTS · w1 · i038

Community inference, not Posey: from Fenn's 'north of Santa Fe' framing, everything roughly 75 miles south of Santa Fe is out. Moab (~38.6°N) is well north of that cutoff.

Moab clears the community's Santa Fe cutoff.

Community claim · Unverified · Searcher inference

SUPPORTS · w2 · i047

A Bureau of Land Management placard is visible in a Netflix packing scene, proposed as one of the obvious hints. The Gold Bar / Potash corridor is BLM land.

Points to BLM land — matches the Moab corridor and satisfies 'publicly accessible'.

Community claim · Unverified · Gold & Greed (Netflix) — searcher observation

SUPPORTS · w1 · i063

The river and the canyon it cut are 'time's swift race'; arch country over the site is 'wonder guards this sacred space'. Thematic.

Thematic fit.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w1 · i080

Medicine Lakes, south side of Tukuhnikivatz near La Sal Pass: a named plural pair at Tuk's southern base. Trip accounts describe descending the peak with the Medicine Lakes reflecting below. The name is already plural, so ...

Ringed by Tuk, Peale, Mellenthin and Laurel.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i084

Lines 4:2–4:4 applied to whichever basin: the sediment record on the pool floors (undisturbed layers back to deglaciation — pollen, charcoal, ash, isotopes; researchers core exactly these lakes) is 'secrets of the past'; the same ...

Mountains standing guard, literally.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i091

Community: the safe combination shown in Gold & Greed reads as 44.26 N 110.5 W — Heart Lake, Yellowstone. Most treat it as a starting point or easter egg rather than the site.

Yellowstone in play; national parks never ruled out.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i097

Community inference from the 75-mile Fenn statement: Fenn's 2013 map covered only Montana, Wyoming, Colorado and New Mexico. With Colorado eliminated and south-of-Santa-Fe out, many searchers now confine the hunt to MT, WY and ...

Same: the site would be in MT, WY or NM.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary

SUPPORTS · w1 · i106

Sweetwater walkthrough, stanza 3–4: 'ursa east' as a heading — Highway 220 northeast along the river to the ancient gates = Devil's Gate on the Sweetwater. 'Her foot of three' = three landmarks east of Devil's Gate. 'Return her ...

South Pass: the Divide as the map's edge.

Community claim · Unverified · TreasureNet full walkthrough, Apr 2026 — via user research

SUPPORTS · w1 · i109

Where the community sits: leaning hard toward Montana, Wyoming and Utah — so Utah is not fringe — but nobody found is working Moab or the La Sals specifically. The Moab basin is being worked alone.

No competition in the basin; also no independent confirmation.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i119

Reddit (u/GreenEyes7141018, 13 up / 48 comments): what if the hunt is like National Treasure — each stanza is one location, and at that location is a clue giving the next. Offered to explain two Posey quotes: 'the key to one ...

'State borders are arbitrary' undercuts the Fenn four-state inference that puts Utah out — borders don't bound the solve.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemap's edge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/GreenEyes7141018)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i126

Checks on Bear Lodge from what I know, unverified on the ground: Devils Tower National Monument charges an entrance fee and the rock is phonolite porphyry, not granite; the Belle Fourche River bends past the base ('waters' silent ...

Entrance fee and hours inside the monument vs 'free and available 24/7' — the site would have to be outside the boundary.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i126

Checks on Bear Lodge from what I know, unverified on the ground: Devils Tower National Monument charges an entrance fee and the rock is phonolite porphyry, not granite; the Belle Fourche River bends past the base ('waters' silent ...

Literally a sacred space, guarded by a wonder.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i130

Pioneer Mountains, Montana — the Wisdom theory run through Polaris instead of the town. Elkhorn Hot Springs supplies the surge, Polaris supplies ursa and the north star, the Big Hole River supplies the fishing and the Hole. The ...

Heavily searched; 'within two miles' means someone has been close, not that the crowd is right.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i142

The report's own read of the mile statement: 'not more than a mile to figure out where the treasure is at' plus 'clues lead to the exact location' implies a final step — the mile takes you to the vicinity (perhaps the checkpoint) ...

Manipulate something to see it — the final step is at the site.

Community claim · Unverified · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i148

Alaska as legend or key rather than location. 1825: Treaty of Saint Petersburg set a vague Russia–Britain boundary; 1867: the US bought Alaska with that boundary undefined. Alaska stands apart on the map and may function as the ...

Not a search location under this reading.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i152

Rule 42 (r/beyondthemapsedge, 33 up): at the end of Gold & Greed Posey quotes Lewis Carroll. In Alice, the King invokes Rule 42: 'All persons more than a mile high to leave the court.' Reading 1: eliminates locations above a mile ...

Reading 1 puts most of the Rockies out: everything on the board except Moab and Devils Tower sits above a mile.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapsedge, ~Jan 2026 (u/DesertCloak)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i152

Rule 42 (r/beyondthemapsedge, 33 up): at the end of Gold & Greed Posey quotes Lewis Carroll. In Alice, the King invokes Rule 42: 'All persons more than a mile high to leave the court.' Reading 1: eliminates locations above a mile ...

Reading 2 keeps every mountain site in and drops the Moab corridor (~4,000 ft) and Devils Tower (~4,200 ft).

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapsedge, ~Jan 2026 (u/DesertCloak)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i155

What are 'double arcs'? Candidates that are literal shapes, not place names: a HEART (two arcs — 'a place that's dear to my heart', Heart Lake in the safe combination, a hunt dedicated to four dead, lovers' carvings on rock); ...

A memorial carving makes 'sacred space' literal.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i158

New composite — Gates of the Mountains / Sleeping Giant / Beartooth (Helena, MT). The Gates of the Mountains on the Missouri is the most literal 'ancient gates' in the West (Lewis & Clark, 1805). The ridge north of Helena called ...

Mann Gulch crosses are grave markers; the site must be clear of them.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i161

Posey's Fenn search footprint, as compiled by the community: the epicenter was the west and north sides of Yellowstone — the Madison River corridor including Nine Mile Hole (Fenn's favorite fishing spot) and Madison Junction ...

The 75-mile ring around west/north Yellowstone covers Jackson Hole, Island Park, Hebgen, the Madison, Gardiner — and Gallatin / Bridger-Teton forest land around the park that is free and dog-friendly.

Community claim · Unverified · Google AI overview citing Reddit r/JustinPoseysTreasure + Mysterious Writings (machine summary – verify)

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i172

Lead — Alaska Basin. If 'return her face' turns the Tetons' famous east face around, the west side of the range is Teton Canyon and Alaska Basin (Jedediah Smith Wilderness, Caribou-Targhee NF, Idaho): free, dogs allowed, granite. ...

Too far from a car, on a trail.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i174

Scan result — Hole-in-the-Wall (Kaycee, WY): a natural gap in the Red Wall, capital-H on every map; BLM, fee-free Outlaw Cave campground; Middle Fork Powder blue-ribbon; Rock Art Cave petroglyphs and an ancient cairn line. 'His ...

Far from Fenn country; ranch road.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i180

Hub progress board: the Hole (2:3) is 'confirmed solved by the community'; the Bride (3:2) has been identified; at least 6 clues solved by the most-advanced searcher; part of stanza 3 solved; the technical clue solved by one ...

'Kitchen-sized target area' — the final spot is a few square yards; the last step is recognition.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary

SUPPORTS · w2 · i188

Fenn footprint per Treasure Among Us: Madison Junction, Nine Mile Hole, Hebgen Lake, Yellowstone, SINKS CANYON, Grand Teton, San Juan Mountains. If accurate, Sinks Canyon (Lander, WY) was itself a Posey Fenn-search location — the ...

Grand Teton too — the Jackson Hole solve clears the gate.

Community claim · Unverified · Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i215

Mysterious Writings, 'Top 10 New Clues Found in Beyond the Map's Edge' (running list): (1) the book cover's torn outline matches the Big Hole River watershed, river through mountains; (2) hardcover-only images on pp. 4 and 117 → ...

Above the 42nd parallel + below 11,000 ft + inside the printed map + free — the box is getting small.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack — Top 10 New Clues (via search summary)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i215

Mysterious Writings, 'Top 10 New Clues Found in Beyond the Map's Edge' (running list): (1) the book cover's torn outline matches the Big Hole River watershed, river through mountains; (2) hardcover-only images on pp. 4 and 117 → ...

If 42 is a latitude floor, La Sal, Provo, Tres Piedras, Blue Hole and Bear Lodge (44.6 — passes) split: the Utah and New Mexico sites fall.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack — Top 10 New Clues (via search summary)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i223

Heron Lake, New Mexico (Rio Arriba County, ~36.7°N — north of the Santa Fe cutoff; 7,200 ft; a reservoir that the old-map theory would omit). In the book: p. 33 'Heron Lake being our north star', the lost-pole story ('I wait for ...

Fee park; the site would be outside it.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude) from MW + book references

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i223

Heron Lake, New Mexico (Rio Arriba County, ~36.7°N — north of the Santa Fe cutoff; 7,200 ft; a reservoir that the old-map theory would omit). In the book: p. 33 'Heron Lake being our north star', the lost-pole story ('I wait for ...

A reservoir — a dam the map omits, if the old-map theory holds.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude) from MW + book references

SUPPORTS · w2 · i233

Analysis: there are two destinations in the back half. 'The place' and 'the sacred space' are not necessarily the same. Stanza 3 ends somewhere; stanza 4 is somewhere else. Since the checkpoint sits at least halfway through the ...

Sacred space = the treasure site, distinct from the place

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i100

Fringe: an Alaska theory (Mike Unfiltered) reads 'beyond the map's edge' as the last frontier. Incompatible with 'the treasure is within the printed map' and 'American West'.

Outside the printed map by Posey's own statement.

Community claim · Disputed · Mike Unfiltered substack — via web search summary

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i107

Alaska — the minority position (one Substack writer). Alaska appears on Posey's map and Hawaii does not; the Alaska section carries nine labeled peaks with elevations, more than any other state, and ordering them by height yields ...

'Within the printed map' includes Alaska on paper, but 'American West' and 'not many miles to find' do not.

Community claim · Disputed · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

L17 Truth rests not in clever minds,**4 facts · 2 against****SUPPORTS · w3 · i206**

Design philosophy verbatim: 'formalized hide-and-seek with confidence checkpoints'; 'the part of me that embraces childlike wonder' wrote the poem; designed for humans not AI ('an astronomical amount of thought'); won't say if ...

Childlike wonder, not engineering — the reading a kid would give.

Posey statement · Confirmed · X Marks the Pod — pre-Summit, ~early 2026 (THAP)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i114

Caution: Posey said the last actionable clue is stanza four OR five, depending on interpretation. He has not ruled stanza 5 out as geography — any reading that makes it pure method has to live with that.

May still be a place clue.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Posey via MW (restated in my analysis)

SUPPORTS · w3 · i110

Stanza 5, reading 1 — method instruction (most common read). 'Truth rests not in clever minds, not in tangled, twisted finds' and the couplet completes the thought: solve it the way a river moves, steadily and in one direction, ...

Plain-reading instruction.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i115

Caution: 'What you seek, you already know' may be doing double duty as consolation for the reader of a grief memoir — the book is dedicated to four dead. Not every line has to be a clue.

Same for the stanza's opening.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · My own analysis

L18 Not in tangled, twisted finds.**7 facts · 0 against****SUPPORTS · w1 · i007**

No red herrings in the poem. No hidden codes in the website's source code.

Every line means something; nothing is there to mislead.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

SUPPORTS · w1 · i191

Poem creation: 'I wrote the bulk of that poem in 6 hours or less. Purposely didn't finish the poem til the day the book went to print... I only tweaked two words tops.' (Dillon). Froggy: 'Forrest spent like 10 years... I came up with ...

Written fast and intuitively — the plain reading is likely the intended one.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Dillon Q&A — Jun 21 2025 (THAP / JIBLE)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i198

Multiple solves as safeguards: 'in case certain aspects of the mechanics don't work... there are other ways to approach it so that you end up finding it either way' (Sandal). 'There is an optimal solution and fallback paths... ...

Redundancy is built in; a solve need not close every line.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Sandal Sanders livestream — Sep 27 2025 (JIBLE)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i070

Derivation order: the solve was built outward from Jeep Arch rather than forward from the poem. Stanza 5 explicitly warns against tangled, twisted finds.

The poem's own test: a solve that needs the answer to justify its steps is a twisted find.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Master file §12 — constraints to reconcile

SUPPORTS · w1 · i139

He made multiple trips (four, per one account) to hide the treasure, some designed to obscure the destination, and aimed to leave no digital footprint of the journey. He filmed a description of the treasure for Netflix only just ...

Obscured travel is about his trail, not the poem's — the solve is still meant to be plain.

Posey statement · Likely · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

SUPPORTS · w1 · i182

Book, per the hub: the only explicit 'bride' in the book is a photo caption — 'From left: Grandpa Posey, Mom and Dad (aka the bride and groom), Grandma Posey, and Grandma Clements in September of 1979.' A photograph is a physical ...

'Probability matrices devoured a decade' — stanza 5 is autobiographical.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary

SUPPORTS · w3 · i110

Stanza 5, reading 1 — method instruction (most common read). 'Truth rests not in clever minds, not in tangled, twisted finds' and the couplet completes the thought: solve it the way a river moves, steadily and in one direction, ...

Explicit warning against twisted solves.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

L19 Like a river's steady flow—

10 facts · 1 against

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i114

Caution: Posey said the last actionable clue is stanza four OR five, depending on interpretation. He has not ruled stanza 5 out as geography — any reading that makes it pure method has to live with that.

'Like a river's steady flow' could be an actionable instruction at the site, not only a metaphor.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Posey via MW (restated in my analysis)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i064

Stanza 1 reading: 'time' literally (clock, date, hours); 'measured rhyme' = counting words, syllables, positions; 1:3 and 5:3 are the poem's only two em dashes — a pairing that brackets the poem.

The other em dash — the pair.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11

SUPPORTS · w2 · i103

Wisdom/Big Hole supporting reads: 'what lives in time' and 'flowing through each measured rhyme' as the river itself, each clue a point along it, with 'like a river's steady flow' closing the loop in stanza 5. The cover's torn ...

Stanza 5 closes the river loop.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i110

Stanza 5, reading 1 — method instruction (most common read). 'Truth rests not in clever minds, not in tangled, twisted finds' and the couplet completes the thought: solve it the way a river moves, steadily and in one direction, ...

River as the model for how to solve, not where.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i111

Stanza 5, reading 2 — structural bookend. 5:3 carries the second of only two em dashes in the poem; the first is 1:3. Same position, third line, in the two stanzas that are not location clues. If the cipher has a frame, those two ...

The closing bracket of a frame opened at 1:3.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i112

Stanza 5, reading 3 — literal river. 'Like a river's steady flow' confirms that a river runs through the whole solve, naming the thread rather than adding a clue. The Big Hole camp uses this; so does the Colorado read. Under this ...

Names the river as the through-line.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i113

Stanza 5, reading 4 — callback to stanza 1 (weighted highest). 'What lives in time' opens the poem; 'what you seek, you already know' closes it. A river is a standard answer to what lives in time and flows through measure. The ...

The river named outright at the end.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i145

Where are the dams? Major reservoirs are missing from the map though obvious on any modern sheet: Hoover / Lake Mead, Glen Canyon / Lake Powell, Fort Peck, Oroville, Grand Coulee. Rivers are drawn as if never dammed — pre-dam cartography.

A river's steady flow, undammed.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i158

New composite — Gates of the Mountains / Sleeping Giant / Beartooth (Helena, MT). The Gates of the Mountains on the Missouri is the most literal 'ancient gates' in the West (Lewis & Clark, 1805). The ridge north of Helena called ...

One river carries the whole poem.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i217

Cross-reference on the Twin Bridges reading: at Twin Bridges, Montana the Big Hole, the Beaverhead and the Ruby join to form the Jefferson. Lewis named those three forks in 1805 for Jefferson's virtues — Wisdom (Big Hole), ...

One river carries the poem from Wisdom to the three.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)

L20 What you seek, you already know.

10 facts · 2 against

SUPPORTS · w2 · i195

Cipher solved and confirmed: MAGYAR (April 2026) — Hungarian; Tucker was a Vizsla, a Hungarian breed. 'The cipher is more than anything a nod to what the container is' (Sandal). Not in the poem, not in the book ('Who says the ...

'What you seek, you already know' — the container is Tucker-shaped: recognizable to anyone who read the book.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i196

Container: 'Who says it's a box?' (4/9/25). 'Targeted and deliberate modifications' to an existing object; some searchers have guessed it correctly; 'extremely recognizable — anybody who watched the series or read my book will ...

Recognizable on sight.

Posey statement · Confirmed · Treasure Hunt With Us podcast — Apr 9 2025 (THAP)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i206

Design philosophy verbatim: 'formalized hide-and-seek with confidence checkpoints'; 'the part of me that embraces childlike wonder' wrote the poem; designed for humans not AI ('an astronomical amount of thought'); won't say if ...

Obvious in retrospect.

Posey statement · Confirmed · X Marks the Pod — pre-Summit, ~early 2026 (THAP)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i018

'By the time you're going to get the treasure you're not searching, you're retrieving.' Once you figure out exactly where it is, you will have sufficient time to plan how you wish to retrieve it.

'What you seek, you already know' — by the end there is nothing left to search for.

Posey statement · Likely · X Marks the Pod (Sep 4 2025)

CONTRADICTS · w1 · i114

Caution: Posey said the last actionable clue is stanza four OR five, depending on interpretation. He has not ruled stanza 5 out as geography — any reading that makes it pure method has to live with that.

Same.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Posey via MW (restated in my analysis)

SUPPORTS · w2 · i110

Stanza 5, reading 1 — method instruction (most common read). 'Truth rests not in clever minds, not in tangled, twisted finds' and the couplet completes the thought: solve it the way a river moves, steadily and in one direction, ...

The answer is simple enough that you already have it.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w3 · i113

Stanza 5, reading 4 — callback to stanza 1 (weighted highest). 'What lives in time' opens the poem; 'what you seek, you already know' closes it. A river is a standard answer to what lives in time and flows through measure. The ...

Closes the loop opened in 1:1.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

CONTRADICTS · w2 · i115

Caution: 'What you seek, you already know' may be doing double duty as consolation for the reader of a grief memoir — the book is dedicated to four dead. Not every line has to be a clue.

A line that works as memoir closing may carry no hunt content at all.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w1 · i118

The word 'find' appears exactly twice in the poem: 1:1 ('Can you find what lives in time') and 3:4 ('Return her face to find the place'). If stanza 1 is the reading method, the two uses may be pointing at each other.

Consistent with the stanza-1 callback: what you find is what you already know.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis

SUPPORTS · w2 · i142

The report's own read of the mile statement: 'not more than a mile to figure out where the treasure is at' plus 'clues lead to the exact location' implies a final step — the mile takes you to the vicinity (perhaps the checkpoint) ...

The last step is recognition, not travel — 'what you seek, you already know'.

Community claim · Unverified · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)

8

FACTS CATALOGUE

Everything in the store except Posey statements (section 6), grouped by kind and ordered by weight (links × confidence).

BOOK TEXT · 18

i210 Tucker poem (p. 213, Mountain Memory) — confirmed helpful: 'Tucker, once my earthly friend, / Took half my soul around the bend'; 'In the mountain's hushed solitude, where the air is crisp and the trees stand in silent reverence, I cast my line into a babbling brook'; 'And as I tread this mortal coil, / I wish release from sorrow's toil'; 'Two lonely souls, forever twined'; 'Here, where earth and memory converge, Tucker lives on.' Tucker: a Vizsla, trained by hide-and-seek on trails; appears through the documentary; a three-legged (porcelain) dog recurs in the book; Tucker Creek exists in the Big Hole region; community theory: a lost-dog poster of Tucker as the checkpoint.

Book text · Confirmed · treasurehuntamusementpark.com – BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy · 2025-03-27

→L06

→L15

→L16

→L11

→L07

→L08

i183 Book gazetteer, per the hub: places named in the memoir — Dillon, Big Hole Valley, Beaverhead Valley, Wisdom (in the Grasshopper Valley chapter), Polaris MT (explicitly named), Pioneer Mountains, Crystal Park, Bannack, Blacktail Deer Creek, Clark Canyon Reservoir, Red Rock River. The hub reads the 'geographic fingerprint' as the Big Hole / Grasshopper Valley / Pioneer Mountains corridor with Dillon as hub, and the hiding spot as 'connected to his grandfather's territory'.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary · 2025-03-27

→L09

→L03

→L07

→L13

→L16

×L16

i182 Book, per the hub: the only explicit 'bride' in the book is a photo caption — 'From left: Grandpa Posey, Mom and Dad (aka the bride and groom), Grandma Posey, and Grandma Clements in September of 1979.' A photograph is a physical object that can be rotated; 'return her face' would then be literal and armchair. Also: Brandon's memorial is 'The Redington Requiem' — a granite boulder pushed by Justin; the Tucker tribute poem in 'The Mountain Memory' chapter has helpful clues (confirmed at Seekers Summit 2026); Justin's mother barrel-raced (horseshoes = double arcs theory); a rancher held a brass ring with 18–20 keys; Brandon counted 17 steps across the patio by 'Shadow Feet the raccoon'; 'probability matrices devoured nearly a decade of my life'.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary · 2025-03-27

→L10

→L12

→L13

→L16

→L01

→L18

i164 VERIFIED — Lewis named the Big Hole River the 'Wisdom' on Aug 6 1805 (with the Philanthropy, now the Ruby) for Jefferson's virtues; fur trappers later renamed it the Big Hole, 'hole' being their word for a mountain valley. The town of Wisdom keeps the old name. So 'Wisdom waits in shadowed sight' is the river's former name — hidden in plain sight on an old map, which is what the 1864-map theory predicts.

Book text · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude) · 2026-09-05

→L03

→L07

→L01

→L14

i211 Book geography verbatim: 'the Big Hole's crystal waters'; Grasshopper Valley 'flanked by the Big Hole Valley'; 'At night, the sky in Grasshopper Valley is so star-spangled... thumbing through your mental Rolodex for constellations'; Crystal Park 'smell of pine and wet granite... fairy dust shards and crystal chunks'; Red Rock River feeds Clark Canyon Reservoir 'where fresh, cool, oxygen-rich water flows in'; Dillon 'steeped in history, like a tea bag stewing for centuries'; Bannack and Sheriff Plummer; 'local lore suggests millions in precious metal still hidden in those hills'; Shoshone and Bannock named as original inhabitants; photo 'Mom fishing the river she loves the most — The Beaverhead'; Grandpa Fitzwater with binoculars 'never met a faraway view he didn't need to inspect closer'.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com – BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy · 2025-03-27

→L14

→L05

→L03

→L09

→L13

i209 Book verbatim, motifs: dedication 'thank you for being my north star'; 'Like four points of a compass, I've dedicated this treasure to four departed souls' (book order is authoritative, per Justin); Prologue opens 'Grid searching Nine Mile Hole. Again... Six years had changed me'; the treasure spans 'ancient Lydia to outer space'; hiding spot 'dear to my heart... whispers of personal lore and secrets'; Introduction 'you might find clues to my treasure scattered through these pages'; acknowledgments 'the best treasures hide in plain sight — sometimes between the lines of an acknowledgments page' and 'your fingerprints are on every page'; p. 116 'ursine'; 'You have to think like a trout'; 'Childhood runs on wonder, not wisdom'; the crawdad lesson (simple traps catch more); 'saguaros standing guard'; the Quail Egg Quest ('pure, unadulterated childlike wonder'); Tucker afraid of a bronze bear that 'stood guard near the town center'; hiding on the horse Meghan 'in plain sight'; the Great Gift Hunt; mother 'so precisely calculated you'd think she had a protractor in her stirrups'.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com – BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy · 2025-03-27 →L09 →L01
→L04 →L16 →L11

i208 Book verbatim, structure: chapters Seinfeld-style. Named: The Gracie Grail (Gracie's Antiques, Dillon — 'an arched entryway crowned with brick', 'the iron gate seemed to politely suggest this place had boundaries', a door that needs 'lift and turn'); The Rod Race (Grasshopper Creek); The Mountain Memory (Tucker poem, p. 213); The Treasure Trail (Nine Mile Hole, Yellowstone list, '\$100 to the first person who can tell me where this was taken' photo); The Redington Requiem (Brandon; 'I pushed a monument of granite across this unforgiving land'); The Curious Confluence; The Fitzwaters (Grandpa, Dillon, Blacktail Deer Creek 'whispered stories through the willows'); The Dubious Decision ('navigating the great unknown with wisdom as your compass'); Money Machine; The Concrete Kiss; The Trailside Troubles; The Postal Pilgrimage and Poseys on the Road ('the most meaningful chapters' — Justin). Legal Lowdown: no hints.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com – BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy · 2025-03-27 →L10 →L12
→L03 →L11

i235 Tucker thread: Posey's Vizsla Tucker, trained by hide-and-seek on trails, appears throughout the Netflix documentary; the dog illustrated beneath the treasure poem in the book is a Vizsla. The memorial poem 'Mountain Memory' (p. 213) shares wording with stanza 2: 'around the bend' appears in both; casting a line into a babbling brook sits against 'cast your pole'; 'where earth and memory converge' echoes the place / sacred space. Best reading: S2L3–L4 may be anchored to a small mountain brook in timber at elevation that Posey associated with Tucker — a tributary, not a valley river like the Big Hole or Beaverhead.

Book text · Likely · Beyond the Map's Edge p. 213 'Mountain Memory' + Netflix (session notes Sep 6 2026) · 2026-09-06 →L07 →L08 →L16

i041 Intentional differences between hardcover and digital, and he said the differences hold insights. Hardcover has two more images than digital, on pages 4 and 117. Page 90 does not exist — pages run 89 to 91 inside chapter 9. Page 156 is missing its page number where comparable pages have theirs.

Book text · Confirmed · Beyond the Map's Edge (hardcover) · 2025-03-27 →L01 →L02

i222 MW Sep 8 2025 — 'The Bronze Beast' chapter (Tucker, Novelty Hill, Washington state) is laced with Hitchhiker's Guide allusions: 'quietly contemplate the meaning of life', 'decode the secrets of the universe', 'solved the world's greatest mystery', 'ponder life's big questions'. Washington is the 42nd state. Jenny's read: another way 42 is planted — and Posey, asked about the 42 on his taillight, said only 'The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy is a fantastic book.'

Book text · Likely · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text · 2025-09-08 →L01 →L07

i214 Numbers in the materials (hub): 42 (truck, Hitchhiker's), 4:19 clock, 17 steps (Brandon counting Shadow Feet the raccoon), 18–20 keys on the rancher's ring, 1979 (wedding photo), 113 (117–4), 6.73 mi, 111 (explicitly meaningless), 1652 (Oak Tree shilling from Grandpa's counterfeit collection, replaced with a genuine one), 561 BC (Lydian), 4 compass points, 10 breadcrumbs, 60 lb, 9,000 miles (no hint), 24 hours, 4 trips.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com – BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy · 2026 →L02 →L11

i149 Territories as they stood before statehood (a period table for the map): California unorganized 1848 → state 1850 (31st); Oregon Terr. 1848 → 1859 (33rd); Utah Terr. 1850 → 1896 (45th); New Mexico Terr. 1850 → 1912 (47th); Washington Terr. 1853 → 1889 (42nd); Colorado Terr. 1861 → 1876 (38th); Dakota Terr. 1861 → ND/SD 1889 (39th/40th); Nevada Terr. 1861 → Oct 31 1864 (36th); Idaho Terr. 1863 → 1890 (43rd); Arizona Terr. 1863 → 1912 (48th); Montana Terr. May 26 1864 → 1889 (41st). By 1864 the modern map was outlined but not final — like this map.

Book text · Likely · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L01 →L03

- i094** Audiobook bonus chapter 'Los Camarones Calientes', set at Lukeville on the Arizona border, gives a 'Border Crossing Commandment – Lukeville Edition. Rule #1 – Carved in stone – never shall wheel touch checkpoint soil. Foot traffic only.' Read as: the checkpoint cannot be driven to or identified from home.

Book text · Likely · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) – via web search summary →L10 →L13
- i043** 'The Concrete Kiss': the Big Hill speed-bump line says Idaho in hardcover (p. 43) but Utah in the audiobook. The hill illustration is on page 42. Idaho and Utah share the 42nd parallel.

Book text · Likely · Audiobook vs hardcover comparison →L16 →L01
- i045** Audiobook: 'The' is added to the chapter title 'Trailside Troubles' (p. 113 hardcover). In 'The Treasure Trail' (p. 185) there is a search list; the narrator adds that two entries remained uncrossed.

Book text · Likely · Audiobook vs hardcover comparison →L14
- i044** Audiobook Acknowledgements add a sentence: the difference between reality and fantasy is not a wall but a map waiting to be drawn.

Book text · Likely · Audiobook vs hardcover comparison →L04
- i051** Posey searched for Fenn for years; bought the Fenn chest from finder Jack Stuef, auctioned most contents Dec 2022, kept the chest, the dragon bracelet, a few coins, dust and flakes. Software engineer, art and antique dealer, raised in Arizona, based in Texas. Hunt dedicated to four late loved ones: his father, grandfather, brother Brandon, and his dog Tucker.

Book text · Likely · Beyond the Map's Edge (hardcover) · 2025-03-27
- i040** 220-page memoir with hints scattered throughout. Clues and hints are the same thing in his view. Many clues in the book, but not every story contains one. The book is a better clue resource than the documentary.

Book text · Likely · Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings

MAP / GEODATA · 8

- i168** VERIFIED — Thermopolis: Hot Springs State Park is free but open 6 am–10 pm, so the site itself cannot be in the park; leashed dogs allowed on park trails. The Wedding of the Waters is 5 miles south, a Game & Fish public access area on a blue-ribbon reach. Wind River Canyon's three highway tunnels were blasted through solid rock, the third through Precambrian granite at the north end, with abutments of an old dam visible on the walls south of tunnel 3. The canyon's formations carry brown signs listing period, name and age. Legend Rock petroglyphs are ~30 miles NW.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude) · 2026-09-05 →L10 →L13 →L14 →L11

×L16
- i163** VERIFIED — Sinks Canyon, Lander WY: the Middle Fork of the Popo Agie disappears into a limestone cavern ('the Sinks') and reappears about a quarter mile downstream at 'the Rise', a clear pool of huge trout, after ~2 hours underground. Fishing is prohibited at the Rise and from the Rise down to the Sinks Canyon Road bridge. No day-use fee. Leashed dogs allowed. Upper canyon is Shoshone National Forest.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude) · 2026-09-05 →L05 →L06 →L07 →L08

→L16
- i218** VERIFIED from the poem text: 'Hole' is the 42nd word (Can-you-find-what-lives-in-time = 7; +5 = 12; +5 = 17; +8 = 25; +6 = 31; +5 = 36; Round-the-bend-past-the = 41; Hole = 42). 42 is confirmed relevant by Posey. The only capitalized common noun in the poem is also its 42nd word — the number points at the Hole.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Poem word count (verified by Claude) – flagged by Mysterious Writings · 2025-09-08

→L07 →L02 →L01
- i178** Scan result — Independence Rock (WY): granite dome with 5,000+ emigrant names carved or greased on; no fee; dogs; 5 miles from Devil's Gate. Better stanza 4 than Split Rock for the Sweetwater solve ('secrets of the past still hold' is literal), but it sits beside a rest area with buildings.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude) · 2026-09-05 →L13 →L14 ×L16

i170 VERIFIED — Lemhi Pass (7,373 ft, Continental Divide, MT/ID): gravel but passenger-car OK; Sacajawea Memorial Area is a free Forest Service site 0.2 mi south of the pass. Sacagawea was taken by Hidatsa raiders near Three Forks (~1800) and reunited with her brother Cameahwait five days after the Corps crossed Lemhi Pass in 1805. 'Return her face' as her literal return home lands here.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude) · 2026-09-05 →L12 →L11 →L09

i165 VERIFIED — The Sleeping Giant north of Helena is Beartooth Mountain (6,792 ft) on the maps; it lies west of the Missouri and Holter Lake, head to the EAST, feet to the west; the Gates of the Mountains are nearby. But the Gates are Madison Group limestone (Mission Canyon / Lodgepole), not granite, and access is by boat or the Meriwether picnic site. Pictographs near Mann Gulch.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude) · 2026-09-05 →L09 ×L13 →L10

i171 VERIFIED — Jackson Hole's Sleeping Indian (Sheep Mountain, Gros Ventre Range) is a chief lying on his back with headdress, obvious from the west, on the EAST edge of the Hole. Posey's 'whether he is living depends on your perspective' fits a sleeping figure exactly. A 'his' now sits east of the Hole, opposite the Tetons ('her') on the west. No bear name yet — the mountain is named for bighorn sheep.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude) · 2026-09-05 →L09 →L10

i169 VERIFIED — Beaverhead Rock State Park: the landmark 'may be viewed and photographed from a distance but is not directly accessible'; non-residents pay \$8 per vehicle. Clark's bearings confirm it as the feature Sacagawea named. As a bride it is exactly 'something visible' — visible only, and not alive.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude) · 2026-09-05 →L10 ×L16

COMMUNITY CLAIM · 40

i215 Mysterious Writings, 'Top 10 New Clues Found in Beyond the Map's Edge' (running list): (1) the book cover's torn outline matches the Big Hole River watershed, river through mountains; (2) hardcover-only images on pp. 4 and 117 → 113, the meridian through Wisdom MT; (3) 'needle in a football field' in Netflix → Big Hole Valley, Land of 10,000 Haystacks; (4) not in any pay park; (5) first actionable clue is 'As hope surges'; (6) clues in the songs, plus two 'obvious' Netflix hints in scenes without Justin that he had control over; (7) NEW — the number 42 appears on the ALASKA portion of the map, read as 'the treasure is above the 42nd parallel'; (8) NEW — the Netflix safe combination is 44–26–1–11, read as 44.26 N / 110.5 W → Heart Lake, Yellowstone, and the dialing scene itself is taken as intentional; (9) the Big Hill is Idaho in hardcover, Utah in the audiobook; (10) the ARKADE song cover with its X — plot points from the poem and draw an X; plus the Alt+42 = asterisk = star technical clue → Polaris; NEW — the books visible behind Justin in the documentary are being catalogued as possible clues (several identified).

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack — Top 10 New Clues (via search summary) · 2025 →L01

→L16 →L11 →L09 ×L16 →L04

i119 Reddit (u/GreenEyes7141018, 13 up / 48 comments): what if the hunt is like National Treasure — each stanza is one location, and at that location is a clue giving the next. Offered to explain two Posey quotes: 'the key to one direction lies in another' and 'state borders are arbitrary'.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/GreenEyes7141018) · 2026-08-23 →L12 →L09

→L05 →L09 →L13 →L16

i106 Sweetwater walkthrough, stanza 3–4: 'ursa east' as a heading — Highway 220 northeast along the river to the ancient gates = Devil's Gate on the Sweetwater. 'Her foot of three' = three landmarks east of Devil's Gate. 'Return her face' = turn around and head back west (the bride being the Sweetwater River and its landscape). 'Double arcs on granite bold' = Split Rock, the notched granite landmark on the way back. Ends at or just past South Pass, where the Divide meets the river. Speculates the Netflix safe combination encodes paces or coordinates and the clock is compass quadrants at twenty degrees.

Community claim · Unverified · TreasureNet full walkthrough, Apr 2026 — via user research →L09 →L10 →L11 →L12

→L13 →L16

i221 MW Sep 8 2025 — word notes on 2:3–2:4. 'Round the bend': is 'Round' a name? Bend, Oregon (now eliminated); the Tucker poem p. 213 'took half my soul around the bend'; p. 149 'Tucker and Jennie rounded the bend'; p. 177 'Rounding the bend, we spotted another group of anglers across the water.' 'Past the Hole': Big Hole River, Hole-in-the-Wall, Nine Mile Hole, any Hole place-name, a fishing hole; sound-clue 'past MT' (Montana); a hole is empty. 'Cast your pole': fishing spot; the North Pole; casting a shadow with a pole (gnomon); an azimuth; an action marking one point of an X. 'Who is I?': Justin, the treasure, the location, the bride, or HERON LAKE — the book's story of the lost pole is at Heron Lake ('I' = the lake).

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text · 2025-09-08 →L07 →L08 →L03 →L09 →L11

i103 Wisdom/Big Hole supporting reads: 'what lives in time' and 'flowing through each measured rhyme' as the river itself, each clue a point along it, with 'like a river's steady flow' closing the loop in stanza 5. The cover's torn outline is argued to match the Big Hole watershed, shifting between watershed edge, ridgeline and river course. 117 – 4 = 113 (the two hardcover-only image pages) and Wisdom sits on the 113th meridian. In Netflix Posey says 'needle in a football field', and the Big Hole's nickname is Land of 10,000 Haystacks. The cut-off M in 'Map's' = the edge lies beyond the mountain.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research) →L01 →L02 →L19 →L04 ×L09

i087 Community (Southwest Montana cluster): Polaris, Montana — a town named for the North Star, Beaverhead County — as 'his realm'; Beaverhead Rock near Twin Bridges (the landmark Sacagawea recognised as home) as the bride; the Pioneer Scenic Byway / Beaverhead NF as the ancient gates. Wisdom, Montana ('Wisdom waits') sits on the Big Hole River ('past the Hole'). Posey did his June 2025 signing in Dillon, MT, and his August 2026 featured question was delayed by Montana wildfires.

Community claim · Unverified · Southwest Montana tourism blog — via web search summary; Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary →L09 →L10 →L07 →L03 →L08

i212 Hub community theories (all speculation): Hope Creek NE of Wisdom in the Anaconda-Pintler ('hope surges'); Lamar / Trout Creek; the Hidden Lake / Queener Mountain BOTG solve (Storm Lake Pass = gates, Queener = bride, triangular ridge at 20° NE of Trout Creek = foot of three, Waterton Valley CDT 6.73 mi = return, Hidden Lake canyon walls = double arcs; claims a 200-ft checkpoint area); a double-arched stone bridge near Warm Springs Conservation Area MT ('Rainbow Arch', matching Netflix coffee-cup handles); the four-city X (Wisdom MT, Bend OR, Jackson Hole WY, Truth or Consequences NM); the page-156 acrostic B-R-G-D-S-H-L shifted one → 'CHEST I AM'; the line-initial acrostic C-F-W-F-A-W-R-I-I-H-H-R-D-W-B-W-T-N-L-W; 'Wise River'; 'the vessel's a loco' anagram and the father's train culture / Great Northern; Wonder Lake / Wonder Mountain names; 'shadowed sight' = Wisdom in valley shadow.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy · 2026 →L05 →L10 ×L13 →L12

i180 Hub progress board: the Hole (2:3) is 'confirmed solved by the community'; the Bride (3:2) has been identified; at least 6 clues solved by the most-advanced searcher; part of stanza 3 solved; the technical clue solved by one person overseas; no one has reached the 'kitchen-sized target area' as of Seekers Summit 2026. Still open on the hub: the exact ura east reading, 'foot of three at twenty', and the double arcs location.

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary · 2026-03 →L07 →L10 →L16 ×L09

i161 Posey's Fenn search footprint, as compiled by the community: the epicenter was the west and north sides of Yellowstone — the Madison River corridor including Nine Mile Hole (Fenn's favorite fishing spot) and Madison Junction where the Firehole and Gibbon meet; the northern gateways at Gardiner, Devil's Slide and the Boiling River; Hebgen Lake and Iron Springs. Montana: the 'bitter-cold mountains' of Glacier NP. South and early: Ojo Caliente NM (warm waters), and early looks at clusters of clues in Utah and Idaho before Fenn ruled them out. Cloudcroft NM and Tucson AZ are out (south of Santa Fe).

Community claim · Unverified · Google AI overview citing Reddit r/JustinPoseysTreasure + Mysterious Writings (machine summary – verify) · 2026-09 →L16 →L07 →L09 →L05

i105 Wyoming / Sweetwater — the most complete published line-by-line (TreasureNet, Apr 2026). Starts from the site's legal disclaimer specifying Wyoming law governs the property; claims the site logo traces Utah's northeast corner. Journey begins in the Bridger Wilderness; 'shadowed sight' = start at dawn with the sun behind the mountains; the map's edge = the Continental Divide (his explanation for Alaska on the map). Drive Wind River Canyon to the Sweetwater River, legendary fishing water, for 'cast your pole'.

Community claim · Unverified · TreasureNet full walkthrough, Apr 2026 — via user research →L03 →L06 →L08 →L04

i090 Full solve (Justin Greer, Jul 2026): Madison River, West Yellowstone. Start at Baker's Hole ('the Hole'), follow the Boundary Trail near the water, round the bend, face east toward the Madison Valley. The Three Brothers peaks aligned west-to-east with a line extended north point at the Harlequin Lake trailhead; 'double arcs' expected on granite near the parking area; return on the Boundary Trail to face the valley from Sled Hill / Old Bump. No chest reported.

Community claim · Unverified · Justin Greer, 'The Treasure I Found Along the Madison – A Full Solve' (Jul 31 2026) – via web search summary →L07 →L11 →L13 →L12

i216 Mysterious Writings, 'Justin Posey's Poem: Round the bend, past the Hole...' (Jenny Kile): the line read as a curve in the river and then past the Big Hole River; a specific theory places it where the Beaverhead and Big Hole flow into the Jefferson near Twin Bridges; 'cast your pole' is another fishing reference; and 'around the bend' is the phrase Justin uses in the Tucker poem for what comes after — the spiritual unknown — so the treasure-poem bend carries that second meaning. Posey facts restated: walking distance from 'waters' silent flight' to 'round the bend, past the Hole'; stanza 1 and at least part of stanza 2 solved; nobody at the checkpoint as of 6/21/25.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings Substack – 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (via search summary) · 2025 →L07 →L08 →L07

i152 Rule 42 (r/beyondthemapledge, 33 up): at the end of Gold & Greed Posey quotes Lewis Carroll. In Alice, the King invokes Rule 42: 'All persons more than a mile high to leave the court.' Reading 1: eliminates locations above a mile high (5,280 ft). Reading 2 (commenter): those above a mile high 'get out' — i.e. go boots-on-the-ground — so the treasure is between 5,280 and ~11,000 ft. Another searcher's first BOTG was outside Denver, the Mile High City (Colorado is now eliminated).

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapledge, ~Jan 2026 (u/DesertCloak) · 2026-01 →L01 ×L16 →L16

i142 The report's own read of the mile statement: 'not more than a mile to figure out where the treasure is at' plus 'clues lead to the exact location' implies a final step — the mile takes you to the vicinity (perhaps the checkpoint) and the precise spot is then identified by close observation or a final poem instruction, not by arriving at the end of a hike.

Community claim · Unverified · Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026) →L20 →L12 →L16

i121 Reddit (u/Senior_Muscle_8829): each stanza puts you somewhere — levels in a game, or checkpoints you know are right — and the last few stanzas are where your area is dialed in and you go boots-on-the-ground to 'convey the said distance'. The final move is the chess move that travels the actual distance.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/Senior_Muscle_8829) · 2026-08-23 →L11 ×L01 →L13

i120 Reddit (u/PNW-OOTW, 9 up): Posey said in an interview that the poem isn't meant to convey a great distance.

Community claim · Unverified · r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/PNW-OOTW) · 2026-08-23 →L07 →L12 ×L11

i104 Polaris, Montana companion: 'in ursa east' = Polaris, the North Star in Ursa Minor, married to the town of Polaris on the Pioneer Scenic Byway in the Beaverhead; the bride is then a north-star location on the map. Supporters cite a page-33 line about Heron Lake being 'our north star' and what looks like a heron in the Netflix background. Others take the same line to Heron Lake, New Mexico.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research) →L09 →L10 →L03

i102 Wisdom, Montana / Big Hole Valley — the community's dominant theory since launch week. 'Wisdom waits in shadowed sight' = the town of Wisdom in the Big Hole Valley. 'Past the Hole' with a capital H = the Big Hole River or Valley; no other common noun in the poem is capitalized, which is the whole argument and a fair one.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research) →L03 →L07 ×L07

i188 Fenn footprint per Treasure Among Us: Madison Junction, Nine Mile Hole, Hebgen Lake, Yellowstone, SINKS CANYON, Grand Teton, San Juan Mountains. If accurate, Sinks Canyon (Lander, WY) was itself a Posey Fenn-search location — the 75-mile gate for the Sinks solve is met at zero miles. San Juans are Colorado (eliminated).

Community claim · Unverified · Treasure Among Us – BTME pages (user research write-up) · 2026 →L05 →L16

i186 Hub readings of 'double arcs on granite bold': two carved or natural U-curves on a granite boulder or cliff; double rainbows or river curves reflected in granite; two horseshoe shapes (his mother's barrel racing); two semicircular petroglyphs or erosion marks. 'Bold' = prominent, visible from a distance — a recognizable landmark, not a subtle marker. Hub note on homophones: numbers 'indirectly encoded through wordplay and homophones' (our file has him declining on homophones specifically — treat as unsettled).

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary · 2026 →L13 ×L13

i184 Hub theories for the gates and bride: Storm Lake Pass on the Continental Divide (Anaconda-Pintler, above the Big Hole) as the 'gate'; Beaverhead Rock; Queener Mountain (queen = bride) in the Big Hole area; Bridal Veil Falls / Creek. Wisdom, Montana as 'the most widely accepted first geographic clue', literally shadowed by its ranges morning and evening ('shadowed sight').

Community claim · Unverified · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary · 2026 →L10 →L03

i108 The 42 theory, consolidated: 42 on the truck taillight, the clock at 4:02, the page-42 hill illustration, the Idaho → Utah audiobook swap across the 42nd parallel, and the Alaska peak ordering. Feeds Montana, Wyoming and Idaho readings. Dented by Posey eliminating 4:02 and 5:26 as meaningful.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research) →L01 ×L01

i099 Netflix interview backdrop: Posey sits in front of computer wallpapers (identified as Lake Louise, Colorado, Wyoming, and Utah near the Colorado River) under a giant clock. Searchers treat the wallpapers and clock as the hidden hints. Posey eliminated the clock times 4:02 and 5:26.

Community claim · Unverified · Moviedelic Netflix-clue roundup – via web search summary →L01 →L06

i095 Community (fringe, Arizona): the Birthing Cave near Sedona (a half-spherical hole) as the Hole; Woo Ranch at the base of Bear Mountain ('ursa') in an alcove next to the Palatki Heritage Site — 'beyond the map's edge' of the controlled site. Posey was raised in Arizona.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) – via web search summary ×L07 →L09

i091 Community: the safe combination shown in Gold & Greed reads as 44.26 N 110.5 W — Heart Lake, Yellowstone. Most treat it as a starting point or easter egg rather than the site.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) – via web search summary →L01 →L16

i089 Community: Hole 'N The Rock, the roadside attraction south of Moab in San Juan County, as 'the Hole'; Corona and Bowtie Arch west of Moab as the 'double arcs' — the most-cited Utah reading online.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) – via web search summary ×L07 →L13

i088 Community: Big Hole River as 'the Hole' and 'cast your pole' as fishing. Posey punted on whether the Hole is a place with 'hole' in its name (Jackson Hole, Big Hole), calling it 'an on the nose question' — which searchers read as a live possibility rather than a no.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) – via web search summary →L07 →L08

i086 Community: the 'technical' hint is Alt+42 on the numpad, which types an asterisk — a STAR. Ties the recurring 42 (page 42 hill illustration, Idaho/Utah 42nd parallel, peaks-in-order count) to 'use a star'.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) – via web search summary →L09 →L01

i085 Community: 'URSA EAST' anagrams to 'USE A STAR' — a nod to navigating by Polaris, which sits in Ursa Minor. Identified on the MW Discord in early 2026. Posey, asked about it: the lowercase was intentional, 'but that's all the clarity I'm willing to provide.'

Community claim · Unverified · MW Discord, early 2026 – via web search summary →L09 ×L09

i042 Cover: the M in 'Map's' is cut short. Searchers propose the cover aperture matches a watershed or terrain outline; the working solve proposes Jeep Arch rotated 90°. Posey has said the interior map was designed by a third party and its errors were not intentional — his input on the cover art is unknown.

Community claim · Unverified · Searcher observation + Beyond the Map's Edge (hardcover) · 2025-03-27 →L12 →L13

i239 Haystack theory: in the Netflix documentary Posey said 'needle in a football field' instead of 'needle in a haystack'; the Big Hole Valley around Wisdom is called the land of 10,000 haystacks. Community inference — Posey has never tied the phrase to any place. Haystack Mountain in the La Sals is offered as a rival (the Moab Times casts it as a female figure, 'chicks around a hen').

Community claim · Unverified · Community inference (session notes Sep 6 2026) · 2026-09-06 →L03

i109 Where the community sits: leaning hard toward Montana, Wyoming and Utah — so Utah is not fringe — but nobody found is working Moab or the La Sals specifically. The Moab basin is being worked alone.

Community claim · Unverified · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research) →L16

i107 Alaska — the minority position (one Substack writer). Alaska appears on Posey's map and Hawaii does not; the Alaska section carries nine labeled peaks with elevations, more than any other state, and ordering them by height yields 42. The title is read as pointing past the edge, the Lower-48 clustering as the blind spot. Most treat it as thematic rather than derived. The Wyoming poster reaches Alaska differently: it is on the map because it sits west of the Continental Divide.

Community claim · Disputed · Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research) ×L16 →L01

i096 Community: other bride candidates in circulation — Bridal Veil Falls (Provo Canyon, UT; also Shoshone NF, WY), Queener Mountain (queen = bride), Spica as companion to Arcturus (the bear-guard star), and Sophia ('Wisdom') as the celestial bride, prompted by The Da Vinci Code appearing in the documentary.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary →L10

i093 Community: the 'extremely definitive' song hint is thought to be in 'Beyond the Map's Edge' by Arkade (the Netflix track). Candidates: the X on the album cover, the cracked-desert landscape, or the number 27. Audiobook tracks (Memories Begin, Requiem to Treasure, Martinis at Midnight) have no lyrics — titles or placement may carry the hint.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary →L01

i092 Community: the cipher was solved on the MW Discord (Mooshee85 and Rose) — it reads MAGYAR. It is not in the poem and is a nod to the container, read as hinting the container is a CHEST. Not needed for the solve.

Community claim · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary →L04

i065 The Old Spanish Trail ran from Santa Fe past the La Sals, connecting the region to Fenn country.

Community claim · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11 · 2026-09-05 →L14

i047 A Bureau of Land Management placard is visible in a Netflix packing scene, proposed as one of the obvious hints. The Gold Bar / Potash corridor is BLM land.

Community claim · Unverified · Gold & Greed (Netflix) — searcher observation →L16

i038 Community inference, not Posey: from Fenn's 'north of Santa Fe' framing, everything roughly 75 miles south of Santa Fe is out. Moab (~38.6°N) is well north of that cutoff.

Community claim · Unverified · Searcher inference →L16

i100 Fringe: an Alaska theory (Mike Unfiltered) reads 'beyond the map's edge' as the last frontier. Incompatible with 'the treasure is within the printed map' and 'American West'.

Community claim · Disputed · Mike Unfiltered substack — via web search summary ×L16

MY OWN THEORY · 55

i158 New composite — Gates of the Mountains / Sleeping Giant / Beartooth (Helena, MT). The Gates of the Mountains on the Missouri is the most literal 'ancient gates' in the West (Lewis & Clark, 1805). The ridge north of Helena called the Sleeping Giant is officially Beartooth Mountain — so 'in ursa [Beartooth] east his [the Giant's] realm awaits' is double-confirmed, and 'whether he is living depends on your perspective' is exactly what you say about a sleeping giant. East of the Beartooth lies Holter Lake and the Gates. The Missouri below Holter is a famous fly-fishery ('cast your pole'); the map's missing dams mean the river is drawn undammed ('waters' silent flight'). Upstream the Missouri is born of THREE rivers at Three Forks ('her foot of three'), fed by the Jefferson, fed by the Big Hole ('the Hole') from Wisdom ('Wisdom waits') — one river thread from the crowd's stanza 1–2 to a new stanza 3 ('like a river's steady flow'). Helena ~4,000 ft: below a mile. Grandfather was Montana fish-and-game. Gaps: the bride; Mann Gulch memorial crosses nearby are grave markers; distances are large unless stanzas 1–3 are armchair.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 →L10 →L09 →L11 →L03 →L07
→L08 →L19 ×L10 ×L16 ×L06

i217 Cross-reference on the Twin Bridges reading: at Twin Bridges, Montana the Big Hole, the Beaverhead and the Ruby join to form the Jefferson. Lewis named those three forks in 1805 for Jefferson's virtues — Wisdom (Big Hole), Philanthropy (Ruby) and Philosophy — so the poem's 'Wisdom' river runs OUT past its Hole into a literal THREE. 'Her foot of three' = the three forks at Twin Bridges; 'his realm' = the Jefferson (named for a 'he'; alive or not 'depends on perspective'); 'his bride stands guard' = Beaverhead Rock, 12 miles up the Beaverhead, Sacagawea's landmark, 'visible but not accessible' — exactly Posey's wording. Twin Bridges is ~4,600 ft (below a mile), on the Big Hole's last reach, free BLM/FWP fishing access, dogs, and Beaverhead Rock State Park sits between it and Dillon. Gaps: 'ursa' (unless pole-star), 'twenty degree', granite (the Tobacco Roots east of Twin Bridges ARE a granite batholith — 'in ursa EAST his realm awaits' could be the Tobacco Roots), and no double arcs yet.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 →L11 →L03 →L07 →L10 →L09
→L13 →L19 xL09 xL13

i157 New composite — Thermopolis / Wind River Canyon / Wedding of the Waters (WY). Big Spring in Hot Springs State Park: the world's largest mineral hot spring, surging, free, 24/7 ('hope surges, clear and bright'). Wind River Canyon cuts through the OWL CREEK Mountains — an owl is the animal of silent flight ('waters' silent flight'). At the canyon mouth is a named place, the Wedding of the Waters, where the Wind River becomes the Bighorn ('his bride' at the gates of the canyon, which is signed by geological age — 'ancient gates'). Precambrian granite at the north end; the highway's three tunnels are arcs cut in it. Bighorn = double-arc horns. Wedding of the Waters is a named fishing access ('cast your pole'). Elevation ~4,400 ft — below a mile, the only mountain solve that passes Rule 42 reading 1. Wyoming law. Dogs fine. Gaps: no bear for 'ursa'; the Hole; the tunnels are man-made and no hunt item may be in one.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 →L05 →L06 →L10 →L08 →L13
→L15 xL09 xL07

i130 Pioneer Mountains, Montana — the Wisdom theory run through Polaris instead of the town. Elkhorn Hot Springs supplies the surge, Polaris supplies ursa and the north star, the Big Hole River supplies the fishing and the Hole. The Pioneers are granitic. Crystal Park is a public granite-and-quartz dig with free access. Gap: heavily searched already, and Posey has said people got within two miles, which cuts both ways.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L05 →L09 →L07 →L08 →L13 →L14 xL10 xL16

i129 Granite Creek / Jackson Hole, Wyoming. 'The Hole' capitalized reads as Jackson Hole, and Posey called the hole-in-the-name question on the nose rather than shutting it down. Granite Hot Springs sits up Granite Creek off the Hoback, supplying the surge, clear and bright, in a drainage named granite. Granite Falls is there. The Hoback and Snake are serious fishing. 'Round the bend past the Hole' works as a driving instruction out of Jackson. Gap: the hot-spring pool is man-made and the access road is long gravel.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L07 →L05 →L06 →L08 →L13 xL05 xL06

i128 City of Rocks, Idaho (~42.07°N — the parallel the 42 clues point at). Actual granite, so 'granite bold' is literal. California Trail landmark where emigrants wrote their names on the rock in axle grease, still legible: secrets of the past still hold. The Twin Sisters are a paired granite formation. Free public access, easy parking, natural arches in the granite. Emigrants called it a gateway (ancient gates). Gap: no bride, no bear, no obvious fishing water.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L13 →L14 →L10 →L01 xL09 xL08 xL07

i174 Scan result — Hole-in-the-Wall (Kaycee, WY): a natural gap in the Red Wall, capital-H on every map; BLM, fee-free Outlaw Cave campground; Middle Fork Powder blue-ribbon; Rock Art Cave petroglyphs and an ancient cairn line. 'His realm' = Butch Cassidy's — and whether Butch is alive or dead 'depends on your perspective' is the actual state of the historical record (Bolivia 1908 vs. survival legends). Against: Red Wall is sandstone; the Bighorn granite is 20+ miles west; ~200 miles from Posey's Fenn ground; access road runs through a ranch headquarters.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude) · 2026-09-05 →L07 →L10 →L09 →L14 xL13 xL16

i162 Cross-reference on the footprint: the free / 24-7 / dogs gate puts the site outside the park, but the Fenn epicenter is the park's west and north edges. The overlap is the ring of national forest just outside: Hebgen Lake and the Madison Arm (Gallatin NF), Island Park and Big Springs (Caribou-Targhee NF, Idaho — a huge clear spring at the head of the Henry's Fork, legendary fly-fishing, free), the Gallatin canyon, Gardiner's surroundings, and the Hoback south of Jackson. Big Springs, Idaho: 'hope surges, clear and bright' (one of the largest springs in the US, gin-clear), 'waters' silent flight' (the Henry's Fork), fishing ('cast your pole'), and Upper/Lower Mesa Falls downstream — two falls, two arcs. Idaho is on the 42 thread. Untested.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 →L05 →L06 →L08 →L13 xL07
xL09

i124 The structure probably isn't a walk. He wouldn't say whether the poem is linear or several points miles apart, then mentioned Indiana Jones and National Treasure — both about an object or device that reveals a location when oriented correctly, not about following directions. Add 'return her face' technically implying physical rotation and a bearing with no origin, and the middle of the poem likely builds a construction on a map rather than a route on the ground. That also explains why boots on the ground isn't required until stanza four.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L12 →L11 →L09 →L10 →L13 ×L07

i223 Heron Lake, New Mexico (Rio Arriba County, ~36.7°N — north of the Santa Fe cutoff; 7,200 ft; a reservoir that the old-map theory would omit). In the book: p. 33 'Heron Lake being our north star', the lost-pole story ('I wait for you to cast your pole'), and 'Heron Lake' among the fishing waters. A heron is the community's read of a shape in the Netflix background. Heron Lake State Park charges a day-use fee (site cannot be in the park; the surrounding Carson NF and BLM land are free). Ojo Caliente — Posey's own Fenn search — is 25 miles south.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude) from MW + book references · 2026-09-05 →L08 →L09 →L05 ×L16 ×L16

i156 'Cast your pole' → 'in ursa' is one navigational step, not two. The pole is the pole star; Polaris sits in Ursa Minor. 2:4 tells you to fix north, 3:1 tells you which bear ('only Ursa East matters, no west to consider' — a direction relative to the bear, not a second bear), and 3:3 gives the bearing: 'twenty degree' is 20° east of north. 3:1 and 3:3 then say the same thing twice, which is how this poem confirms itself. 'Return her face' reverses it to 200°. This is the construction: north from the pole, 20° east, a measured leg ('foot of three'), then the back-bearing.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 →L08 →L09 →L11 →L12 ×L09

i246 Eastern Beartooths case: a bear-named range with a real east half; granitic against the volcanic Absarokas; Granite Peak is the state high point; rock dated ~3.96 billion years, so 'secrets of the past still hold' and 'beyond the reach of time's swift race' stop being metaphors; Custer-Gallatin and Shoshone NF (free), paved US-212, outside Yellowstone's paid boundary. Against: no gates found; no bride (Twin Peaks is paired but not a bride); no book support — the book names southwest Montana, 200 miles west.

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — regions compared · 2026-09-06 →L09 →L13 →L14 →L15

i175 Scan result — Provo Canyon / Timpanogos (UT): Bridal Veil Falls (free county park, dogs) is the maiden's tears in the Timpanogos legend; the mountain's skyline is her sleeping profile from the canyon — a named 'her face'. The Provo is blue-ribbon. Against: no Hole, no bear, the mountain is limestone, and it is urban.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude) · 2026-09-05 →L10 →L12 ×L07 ×L13

i154 Checkpoint = the double arcs. Cross-referencing five statements: the checkpoint is something he placed AND something already there; it has 'some implication' of a topographic feature; the audiobook calls it 'carved in stone'; one clue has a man-made implication depending on path; and the double-arcs question got a punt where the Hole got a clean no. All five are satisfied at once if the checkpoint is a mark Posey carved on a natural granite boulder. That also explains 'hard pressed to get all the way without seeing it' (4:1 is on the way), 'zero photos of the correct checkpoint' (a small carving), and boots-on-the-ground beginning at stanza 4.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 →L13 →L14 ×L07 →L10

i143 The map as a time anchor. Read the book's map not as modern geography but as a historical lens: place names changed, rivers and creeks were relabeled, section lines drawn later, towns existed before boundaries were final. The map has an old-world feel from the mid-to-late 1860s, possibly 1864 — by then every state on it except Alaska existed at least as a territory; finalized state boundaries appear overlaid on earlier territorial terrain; National Parks look updated while other features stay historically incomplete; most named places already existed as towns by the 1860s.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L01 →L04 →L14 →L02

i131 Cross-reference: the Tetons are literally 'her' and literally 'three'. 'Les Trois Tétons' — the Grand, Middle and South Teton — were named by French trappers for a woman's breasts. 'Her foot of three' would then be the foot of the Three Tetons, a phrase that needs no wordplay. It sits inside the Jackson Hole reading, on granite-and-gneiss peaks, above serious fishing water, in the state named in the site's legal disclaimer. Not checked: a bear (ursa) east of the Hole, and what 'return her face' does there. Bearpaw Lake exists north of Jenny Lake.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 →L11 →L10 →L07 →L13

i113 Stanza 5, reading 4 — callback to stanza 1 (weighted highest). 'What lives in time' opens the poem; 'what you seek, you already know' closes it. A river is a standard answer to what lives in time and flows through measure. The last line says the answer was stated in stanza 1 and you have been carrying it since. This explains why stanza 1 has no actionable clue: it is the answer, not a step.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L20 →L01 →L02 →L19

i110 Stanza 5, reading 1 — method instruction (most common read). 'Truth rests not in clever minds, not in tangled, twisted finds' and the couplet completes the thought: solve it the way a river moves, steadily and in one direction, not by knots. The correct solution is simple and linear. Backed by confirmed facts: no red herrings, consecutive order, no specialized knowledge. Under this reading stanza 5 is a warning label, not geography.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L17 →L18 →L19 →L20

i064 Stanza 1 reading: 'time' literally (clock, date, hours); 'measured rhyme' = counting words, syllables, positions; 1:3 and 5:3 are the poem's only two em dashes — a pairing that brackets the poem.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11 · 2026-09-05 →L01 →L02 →L03 →L19

i242 Sister Superior solve (Castle Valley, Moab): the Rectory ridge runs Castleton Tower, the Rectory, the Priest and Nuns, Sister Superior, the Convent — a nun is a bride of Christ. Gates = the valley mouth flanked by the Rectory ridge and Parriott Mesa; 'foot of three' = three towers sharing one 1,000-ft Moenkopi-Chinle pedestal; rotation readings applied to Sister Superior's face. Best supporting find: Matrimony Spring sits at the junction where SR-128 begins, and SR-128 runs to a priest, nuns, a convent and a sister superior — a marriage spring at the head of a road ending in a wedding party.

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — working solve · 2026-09-06 →L10 →L05 →L11

i247 Pioneer Mountains / Big Hole / Beaverhead case: by far the strongest book support (Dillon signing; Wisdom, Big Hole, Polaris, Pioneers, Bannack, Crystal Park, Blacktail Deer Creek, Clark Canyon, Red Rock River); Pioneer batholith granite at Crystal Park; East and West Pioneers are a genuine east-west split of one range; ancient passes nearby (Lemhi, Big Hole, Chief Joseph). Against: bear naming not established; gates not established.

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — regions compared · 2026-09-06 →L09 →L13 →L10

i177 Scan result — Big Springs / Henry's Fork (Island Park, ID): 120 million gallons a day of crystal-clear 52°F water; fishing prohibited at the spring, great below; free national forest, dogs; Upper and Lower Mesa Falls downstream; inside Posey's Fenn ring; Idaho on the 42 thread. Against: no Hole, no bear.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude) · 2026-09-05 →L05 →L08 ×L07

i176 Scan result — Blue Hole, Santa Rosa NM: a bell-shaped artesian sinkhole, 3,000 gal/min, 62°F, crystal clear, tied to the Pecos; north of the Santa Fe cutoff. Against: a city dive park with structures and a grate; no granite, no mountains, no bear. A perfect 2:1 with nothing after it.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude) · 2026-09-05 →L05 →L07 ×L13

i155 What are 'double arcs'? Candidates that are literal shapes, not place names: a HEART (two arcs — 'a place that's dear to my heart', Heart Lake in the safe combination, a hunt dedicated to four dead, lovers' carvings on rock); BIGHORN RAM HORNS (two arcs, the commonest petroglyph subject in the West, and Wyoming's Bighorn River and Basin); the numeral 3 or letter B (Brandon, his late brother); a rainbow pair. A carved heart on granite is the reading that ties the most statements together.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 →L13 →L16 →L01

i146 Mountains and measurement: Mount Shasta was widely held to be California's highest peak in the 1850s–early 1860s; on July 6, 1864 the California Geological Survey named Mount Whitney the highest in California and the contiguous US. Posey's errata notes a missing period on 'Mt. Shasta' but says nothing about Whitney. Gannett Peak is listed at 7,076 — its prominence, not its elevation — addressed in the errata as an unintended error, but it reinforces a theme of historical measurement confusion.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L01 →L02 →L11

i145 Where are the dams? Major reservoirs are missing from the map though obvious on any modern sheet: Hoover / Lake Mead, Glen Canyon / Lake Powell, Fort Peck, Oroville, Grand Coulee. Rivers are drawn as if never dammed — pre-dam cartography.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L15 →L06 →L19

i144 Time-warp anomalies on the map: Wyoming was part of Dakota Territory until 1868 (no Wyoming Territory yet in 1864). Salem, Oregon is missing (fixed in the errata) — and Salem was only confirmed as Oregon's capital in 1864. Washington is listed as the 42nd state, though it reached statehood three days after Montana in 1889 by clerical delay; Montana would otherwise have been 42nd. Small inconsistencies, or cues to look backward.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L01 →L09 →L03

i127 'Foot of three' is probably a measurement, not a shape. Three feet is a yard. Or 'three at twenty' reads as degrees and minutes: 3°20'. Stop trying to make it describe a mountain's geometry.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L11 ×L11 →L12

i125 'Ursa east' as a proper name, not a constellation. Only Ursa East matters, there is no west to consider, and the lowercase was deliberate — that reads like a place name disguised by decapitalizing. Test first: Bear Lodge. Devils Tower's Lakota name is Bear Lodge, and it sits in the Bear Lodge Mountains in northeast Wyoming. Lodge and realm are near-synonyms, so 'ursa... his realm' would be doing the same work twice, which is how these poems confirm themselves. Wyoming also fits the site's legal disclaimer. Unchecked: a bride-shaped feature or ancient gates nearby. May fall apart in five minutes, but the reading to chase first.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L09 →L10 ×L09

i118 The word 'find' appears exactly twice in the poem: 1:1 ('Can you find what lives in time') and 3:4 ('Return her face to find the place'). If stanza 1 is the reading method, the two uses may be pointing at each other.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L01 →L12 →L20

i112 Stanza 5, reading 3 — literal river. 'Like a river's steady flow' confirms that a river runs through the whole solve, naming the thread rather than adding a clue. The Big Hole camp uses this; so does the Colorado read. Under this version stanza 5 confirms you followed water the whole way.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L19 →L06 →L05

i111 Stanza 5, reading 2 — structural bookend. 5:3 carries the second of only two em dashes in the poem; the first is 1:3. Same position, third line, in the two stanzas that are not location clues. If the cipher has a frame, those two marks likely define it, and this couplet is the closing bracket.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L19 →L03 →L04

i084 Lines 4:2–4:4 applied to whichever basin: the sediment record on the pool floors (undisturbed layers back to deglaciation — pollen, charcoal, ash, isotopes; researchers core exactly these lakes) is 'secrets of the past'; the same sealed record is 'beyond the reach of time's swift race'; the ring of 12,000-foot summits — Tuk, Peale, Mellenthin, Mount Laurel — is 'wonder guards this sacred space', literally. Accuracy note: the water is annual snowmelt; cirques date to ~20,000 years, rock 25–28 million; the sediment, not the water, carries the age.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L14 →L15 →L16

i080 Medicine Lakes, south side of Tukuhnikivatz near La Sal Pass: a named plural pair at Tuk's southern base. Trip accounts describe descending the peak with the Medicine Lakes reflecting below. The name is already plural, so 'double' is satisfied by the feature itself; sits at a drivable pass with a trailhead, fitting 'no more than a mile' far better than a high cirque; and it is exactly what Reading C delivers.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L13 →L12 →L16

i079 Reading C — reverse the face on the map. Her face is the mountain's aspect; returning it means reversing which direction that face looks, done on paper. North face reversed gives the south side. Preserves the rotation, stays armchair-solvable before stanza four, leaves twenty free for the foot, and outputs an actual destination.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L12 →L11 ×L12

i233 Analysis: there are two destinations in the back half. 'The place' and 'the sacred space' are not necessarily the same. Stanza 3 ends somewhere; stanza 4 is somewhere else. Since the checkpoint sits at least halfway through the clues and boots on the ground begins at stanza 4, 'the place' is a strong candidate for the checkpoint itself.

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 · 2026-09-06 →L12 →L16

i241 La Sal name hooks (peaks visible looking south: Peale, Mellenthin, South Mountain, Tukuhnikivatz, Haystack, Manns, Waas, Castle Mountain, La Sal Peak): Castle Mountain is a better 'realm' candidate than Waas (a realm is what a castle governs); Manns Peak beside Mount Waas — if Waas means 'man', two adjacent peaks mean the same thing in two languages; Mount Mellenthin is named for a ranger killed there in 1918 (memorial angle hits the no-graves rule); La Sal Peak = Spanish 'the salt'. Absent and needed: nothing bear, nothing bride, nothing three or twenty, nothing hole.

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 – La Sal screenshot · 2026-09-06 →L09 ×L09

i172 Lead — Alaska Basin. If 'return her face' turns the Tetons' famous east face around, the west side of the range is Teton Canyon and Alaska Basin (Jedediah Smith Wilderness, Caribou-Targhee NF, Idaho): free, dogs allowed, granite. The user's Alaska-as-key idea and the rotation reading land on the same named basin. Against: Alaska Basin is an 8-mile trail hike and 9,500 ft — far past 'a mile from the car' and on a trail.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude) · 2026-09-05 →L12 ×L16

i148 Alaska as legend or key rather than location. 1825: Treaty of Saint Petersburg set a vague Russia–Britain boundary; 1867: the US bought Alaska with that boundary undefined. Alaska stands apart on the map and may function as the anchor that 'shrinks the universe' — a key to the map's period rather than a place to search.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L04 ×L16

i078 Reading B — go to the face and turn around. Walk to her face, reverse your own facing. 'Return' in its plain sense, which suits stanza 5's warning against clever readings; satisfies the rotation; fits 'her face is probably not as far from the place as people think.'

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L12 ×L12

i077 Reading A — back bearing. 'Twenty degree' is a compass bearing and 'return' reverses it: $20 + 180 = 200$. Standard surveying practice for working backward from a landmark to your own position.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L12 ×L12

i063 The river and the canyon it cut are 'time's swift race'; arch country over the site is 'wonder guards this sacred space'. Thematic.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11 · 2026-09-05 →L15 →L16

i054 The spring's outflow is piped through a culvert under SR-128 into the Colorado — the water in 2:1 physically becomes the water in 2:2. North on 191, cross the Colorado on the highway bridge; SR-279 branches left about two miles up and drops onto the river's north bank. Roughly four miles total; the walking constraint begins at 2:2, so a drive here is permitted.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11 · 2026-09-05 →L06 →L05

i053 Matrimony Spring at the junction of US-191 and SR-128 north of Moab: cold, clear, flows 365 days a year, likely sourced from the La Sals ~30 miles southeast. Local legend: couples who drink from it marry; drinking marries you to the land and you always return. Supports 'clear and bright' where the muddy Colorado does not.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11 · 2026-09-05 →L05 →L10

i234 Gates-as-passage reframe: 'ancient gates' as a valley or pass used as a crossing route long ago, rather than a formation with 'gate' in its name. Fits gates-before-bride (a historic crossing is identified first; the bride is the landform standing over it), fits not needing to be at the bride (she is visible from the pass), and is mappable from an armchair. Candidates: Lemhi Pass (ancient trade and buffalo route, Lewis & Clark 1805), Big Hole Pass and Chief Joseph Pass (Nez Perce 1877), the Great Bannock Trail (Shoshone-Bannock buffalo route by Cooke City and the Beartooth edge), South Pass (emigrant gateway, Archean granite, Devil's Gate and Split Rock nearby).

My own theory · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (Josh's reframe) · 2026-09-06 →L10

i082 Gold Basin / Tuk cirque, north side of Tukuhtnikivatz, drained by a Brumley Creek tributary — reached via Geyser Pass Road to Gold Basin Road. Cirques are arc-shaped by definition: curved headwalls cut into bold rock, so 'double arcs' reads as landform rather than wordplay.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 →L13

i062 Petroglyph panels and dinosaur tracks along the Potash corridor are 'secrets of the past still hold'. Thematic, not pinned.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11 · 2026-09-05 →L14

i061 Corona Arch and Bowtie Arch, paired within a few hundred feet on one trail off 279. Corona means crown; a bowtie is a groom's — the wedding pair. The trail's bolted cable and ladder supply a man-made element.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11 · 2026-09-05 →L13

i060 Tukuhtnikivatz is usually translated as roughly 'where the sun sets last' — a direction-facing name. Reverse her facing: 20 becomes 200.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11 · 2026-09-05 →L12

i059 Tukuhtnikivatz's three-sided pyramid form is 'her foot of three'; twenty degrees is taken from her foot.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve — master file §11 · 2026-09-05 →L11

i058 Mount Tukuhnikivatz as the bride to the man-mountain, standing at the gates of the range. 'Ancient gates' not pinned to a specific feature.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve – master file §11 · 2026-09-05 →L10

i057 'Bear east' read as a heading instruction; from Jeep Arch the La Sals lie east. 'His realm' = Mount Waas (12,306 ft), Grand County high point, named by the Hayden Survey for a local Ute chief; 'Waas' also reported (hedged) to mean 'man' in Ute. Older maps label it Mount Nas or Nass.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve – master file §11 · 2026-09-05 →L09

i056 The canyon bend, then the large culvert on the Gold Bar approach to Jeep Arch, is 'round the bend, past the Hole.' Argument: Posey's exclusion language is 'man-made buildings', which leaves a culvert available as a passable route feature.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve – master file §11 · 2026-09-05 →L07

i055 The Colorado River along SR-279 (Potash Road) is 'waters' silent flight' — a big, quiet river moving through the canyon.

My own theory · Unverified · Working solve – master file §11 · 2026-09-05 →L06

i052 Speculation: 'not a person who is alive right now' plus a hunt dedicated to four late loved ones — the bride could honor a dedicatee (a memorial, a named or personal feature) rather than be a landform.

My own theory · Unverified · My own theory →L10

OBJECTION / CONSTRAINT · 29

i243 Unresolved conflicts in the Sister Superior solve: direction — Castle Valley is northwest of Waas/Manns and northeast of Moab, not east; sequence — Castle Valley opens off SR-128 at the same junction as Matrimony Spring (S2L1), so stanza 3 returns you to where stanza 2 started, against Posey's consecutive order. Removing Tukuhnikivatz also emptied stanza 4: Medicine Lakes and Gold Basin only existed at Tuk's foot. Archived so they are not re-argued: Waas as realm, Tuk as bride, Medicine Lakes, Gold Basin, Corona + Bowtie.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 · 2026-09-06 ×L09 ×L10 ×L13

i114 Caution: Posey said the last actionable clue is stanza four OR five, depending on interpretation. He has not ruled stanza 5 out as geography — any reading that makes it pure method has to live with that.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Posey via MW (restated in my analysis) ×L17 ×L19 ×L20

i166 VERIFIED — Medicine Lakes (La Sals): reached by FR 238 off La Sal Pass Road, ~350 yards of road that 'requires a high-clearance 4-wheel-drive vehicle'; it is a trailhead and camping area with pit toilets and stocked rainbow trout. So the lakes are on a trail, at structures, past a 4WD spur — three gate problems for a site (as a waypoint the walk from La Sal Pass Road is trivial).

Objection / constraint · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude) · 2026-09-05 ×L13 ×L16

i126 Checks on Bear Lodge from what I know, unverified on the ground: Devils Tower National Monument charges an entrance fee and the rock is phonolite porphyry, not granite; the Belle Fourche River bends past the base ('waters' silent flight); it is a major climbing site (rules: no climbing skills needed); and it is a sacred site to several tribes ('sacred space'). A site inside the monument fails 'free, 24/7' and 'not associated with man-made buildings'; land just outside it in the Bear Lodge Mountains (Black Hills NF) would not.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 ×L13 ×L16 →L06 →L16

i240 Against reading the haystack swap as a pointer: he removed the word, and an omission has no direction — 'he avoided it because it gives the place away' and 'because it is irrelevant' are equally available. 'Football field' may be the actual content: a size statement (~1.3 acres) consistent with no more than a mile of hiking. Haystack is a shape word that multiplies (Wind Rivers, Adirondacks, Connecticut, Oregon; GNIS lists 144 peaks named Bear Mountain). Equal plausibility in two regions means the clue does not discriminate — set it aside rather than count it for either. The one asymmetry: Montana's version sits on a pile of book references; the La Sal version attaches to a peak that appears nowhere in the book.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 · 2026-09-06 ×L03 →L16

i159 Rule-outs from the statements we hold. City of Rocks: 2:1–2:2 must be a pair several searchers have solved, within walking distance of 2:3 — the Reserve has no water worth a line, so stanza 2 cannot be assigned there. Sweetwater: no Hole at all, and a bride that is 'the river and its landscape' contradicts 'something visible that someone has identified'; Martin's Cove beside Devil's Gate is private and memorial ground. Bear Lodge: fee monument, phonolite, no bride in a first look. Madison: three gate failures. Corona: three statements. The La Sals stand only if stanza 2 is re-solved with a natural Hole.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 ×L13 ×L10

i135 Cross-reference: 'granite' is literal in every rival solve and figurative only in the La Sals. Split Rock, City of Rocks, the Pioneers and the Teton core are granite; Moab is sandstone, the La Sals laccolith, Devils Tower phonolite. Posey said clues should stand the test of time and that the hunt is built on natural landscape; a rock type is exactly the kind of clue that does. Treat 'granite' as a gate, not a flourish.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 ×L13 →L13

i134 Cross-reference: the capital-H Hole is the single most discriminating fact on the board. Posey gave a direct 'no' to a man-made Hole and called the place-name question on the nose. Every solve that survives that pair has a proper-noun natural Hole: Jackson Hole, Big Hole, Baker's Hole. The Moab corridor has none — the culvert fails the first statement and Hole 'N The Rock is man-made. Whatever else the La Sal solve gets right, stanza 2 line 3 has to be re-read before it can pass the gate.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 ×L07 →L07

i132 Cross-reference: 'access is free and available 24/7' quietly rules out the inside of any fee-entry unit. Grand Teton, Yellowstone and Devils Tower charge entry; the surrounding national forests and BLM land do not. Posey refusing to rule national parks in or out is consistent with a site just outside a park boundary. So a Yellowstone or Teton solve must land in Bridger-Teton or Gallatin NF, not inside the park.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 ×L16 →L16

i123 Reddit (u/Theroguehippie1): reread the question he was asked. The 'not more than a mile' answer was about distance from your car to figure out where the treasure is — it says nothing about whether the clues convey distances at all, or how far clue-to-clue is. 'To figure out where the treasure is at... OK then what?' People need to get better at asking questions.

Objection / constraint · Likely · r/beyondthemapsedge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/Theroguehippie1) · 2026-08-23 ×L07 ×L12

i070 Derivation order: the solve was built outward from Jeep Arch rather than forward from the poem. Stanza 5 explicitly warns against tangled, twisted finds.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Master file §12 – constraints to reconcile · 2026-09-05 →L18 ×L07

i167 VERIFIED — Torrey Lake petroglyphs (Dubois) are on sandstone boulders, not granite; a guided visit is recommended. Drop as a granite site.

Objection / constraint · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude) · 2026-09-05 ×L13

i115 Caution: 'What you seek, you already know' may be doing double duty as consolation for the reader of a grief memoir — the book is dedicated to four dead. Not every line has to be a clue.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 ×L20 ×L17

i097 Community inference from the 75-mile Fenn statement: Fenn's 2013 map covered only Montana, Wyoming, Colorado and New Mexico. With Colorado eliminated and south-of-Santa-Fe out, many searchers now confine the hunt to MT, WY and northern NM. Utah is outside Fenn's map. Posey walked the statement back, but the inference dominates online discussion.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) – via web search summary ×L09 ×L16

i231 Analysis of the Ursa East answer: the question 'is there a west ursa and an east ursa?' only makes sense if ursa names something. If it were 'bear east' as a heading verb there would be no west version to ask about. With the deliberate lowercase, ursa is a common noun doing place work — the eastern part of a bear-named thing. This closes the 'bear east as instruction' reading the Moab stanza 3 was built on.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 – analysis of confirmed Q&A · 2026-09-06 ×L09

i232 Analysis: the gates are the anchor, not the bride. Gates come first (Posey), so they are the more findable, probably named or well-known thing; the bride is what you spot once you are looking at them. Solves that find a bride and then hunt for gates have this inverted.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 · 2026-09-06 →L10

i236 Lost-dog-poster checkpoint theory REJECTED: it fails three of Posey's statements. The checkpoint is both something he placed AND something already there (a poster is only placed); clues must stand the test of time (paper outdoors since 2023 would not); and the checkpoint is not something that could be moved.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 · 2026-09-06 xL12

i244 'Foot of three' weakness admitted: the Rectory ridge has more than three named towers; getting to three requires picking an unjustified subgroup — fitting a number to a place. Readings left open: foot as a unit (three feet at a bearing); a base with three of something at it (drainages, ridges, trails, trees); three as part of a number (320, 203, a coordinate fragment); the base of something named Three-something.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 · 2026-09-06 xL11

i213 Hub 'contradictions to watch': (1) 'not associated with any man-made structure' (Cowlazars, strongest) vs 'exterior of a structure — always a possibility' (X Marks); (2) 'leans armchair' vs BOTG from stanza 4; (3) verbal answers carry less weight than written — 'I'm much more apt to answer mechanic questions in written form'; verify verbal answers against treasure.quest; (4) national parks: 'I'm not going to say yes or no.' Hub on stanza 1 acrostic: no phrase found.

Objection / constraint · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy · 2026 xL16

i083 Constraint on Gold Basin: no named paired pools located there. Trip reports describe talus, avalanche paths and creek, not lakes. Unnamed tarns may exist but are unconfirmed. Higher and more snowbound than Medicine Lakes.

Objection / constraint · Likely · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 xL13

i081 Constraint on Medicine Lakes: the La Sal Pass Road is rough. One climber reported a high-clearance Subaru failing in a wet year, with rangers suggesting a modified 4x4. Posey's rules say no high-clearance vehicle is needed. Verify dry-season access in a standard car, or find another approach.

Objection / constraint · Likely · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 xL13

i071 Waas etymology: the 'man' translation is hedged in sources; the Ute chief attribution is better supported. Clues should stand the test of time, which argues against building on a contested translation.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Master file §12 — constraints to reconcile · 2026-09-05 xL09

i069 Direction of travel: nothing in 2:2 specifies bank, downstream, or the choice of SR-279 over SR-128, which also follows the Colorado from the same junction. The turn onto 279 is currently chosen retroactively by the destination.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Master file §12 — constraints to reconcile · 2026-09-05 xL06

i067 Ursa: no bear-related naming exists among the La Sal peaks (Waas, Peale, Mellenthin, Tukuhtnikivatz, South Mountain) or the local drainages (Mill Creek, Pack Creek). The nearest bear name, Bears Ears, is ~70 miles southwest — the wrong direction from Moab.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Master file §12 — constraints to reconcile · 2026-09-05 xL09

i066 Granite: Moab is sandstone; the La Sals are laccolithic intrusive rock. Neither is granite.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Master file §12 — constraints to reconcile · 2026-09-05 xL13

i153 Elevation check against Rule 42 (approximate): Potash Rd / Corona ≈ 4,000 ft (below a mile); Devils Tower base ≈ 4,200; Big Hole / Wisdom ≈ 6,000; City of Rocks ≈ 6,000; Jackson / Granite Hot Springs ≈ 6,200–6,900; Split Rock ≈ 6,300; Baker's Hole ≈ 6,600; Crystal Park ≈ 7,800; Medicine Lakes ≈ 10,000; Gold Basin ≈ 10,500. Under 'below a mile' only the Moab corridor and Devils Tower survive; under 'above a mile' those two are the ones that fall.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 xL13

i068 The bride clarification — volunteering twice that she is not a living person and not someone you can interact with — only makes sense if the bride reads as person-shaped. Counterweight: he also said the bride is visible, and that whether 'he' is living depends on perspective; both are compatible with landforms.

Objection / constraint · Unverified · Master file §12 — constraints to reconcile · 2026-09-05 xL10

i237 Tucker Creek DROPPED: a fan-analysis site claimed a 'Tucker Creek' in the Big Hole drainage. It does not appear in Montana geographic name records (GNIS) for that drainage. Unverified and removed from the working file — the reason the reliability tiers exist.

Objection / constraint · Disputed · Fan-analysis site (untraced) vs GNIS check, Sep 6 2026 · 2026-09-06 xL08

i249 Method lesson: a resonant name found after arriving in a region is not evidence that the region is right (the Haystack episode). The Moab solve was built outward from Jeep Arch rather than forward from the poem; today it gained its best detail (the SR-128 naming chain) and lost its two most load-bearing pins (ursa-as-verb and all of stanza 4). The gates-as-passage reframe points back toward southwest Montana where ancient passes and book references overlap.

Objection / constraint · Likely · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — standing assessment · 2026-09-06

QUESTION TO ASK · 7

i238 Ask / read: the 'Mountain Memory' chapter (p. 213) and the chapter that introduces Tucker — is the fishing location named? If it names a place, work that place against the poem; if it deliberately withholds the place, that is informative too. Highest-value fifteen-minute action.

Question to ask · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — next actions · 2026-09-06 →L08

i245 Ask / look up: what does 'Tomasaki' mean (Mount Tomasaki, adjacent to Manns and Waas, a Ute name like Waas), and is it male or female? Unworkable as a bride or realm until established. Also Mount Laurel (12,271 ft; laurel = wedding garland) is one foot different from Manns Peak (12,272) but sits across Geyser Pass — an elevation coincidence, not a clue.

Question to ask · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 · 2026-09-06 →L10

i248 Ask: which historic pass has a named landform standing over it that could read as a bride? First question in a while that runs forward from the poem rather than backward from a place. Also: check whether the East Pioneers have anything gate-named.

Question to ask · Unverified · Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — next actions · 2026-09-06 →L10

i075 Ask: Is 'her foot of three' a measurement, a bearing, or a shape? Does 'twenty degree' refer to a compass bearing?

Question to ask · Unverified · Master file §13 — open questions · 2026-09-05 →L11

i074 Ask: Is the bride a natural feature or something made?

Question to ask · Unverified · Master file §13 — open questions · 2026-09-05 →L10

i073 Ask: Did you have any input on the book's cover art?

Question to ask · Unverified · Master file §13 — open questions · 2026-09-05 →L12

i072 Ask: Does the Hole refer to something you pass through?

Question to ask · Unverified · Master file §13 — open questions · 2026-09-05 →L07

9

THE MAP — STATE BY STATE

STATE	STATUS	NOTE
UT	ACTIVE	My solve: Moab start, La Sal bride, Medicine Lakes. Outside Fenn's 2013 map — the community's sharpest objection — but Posey reportedly said 'state borders are arbitrary' (via r/beyondthemapledge), which cuts against it.
MT	HOT	Dominant theory since launch week: Wisdom ('Wisdom waits') on the Big Hole ('the Hole', the poem's only capitalized common noun), Polaris MT for ursa, Beaverhead Rock as bride; 117–4=113 meridian; 10,000 Haystacks. Also the Madison–Harlequin solve. Inside Fenn's map.
WY	HOT	TreasureNet full line-by-line: Bridger Wilderness → Wind River Canyon → Sweetwater → Devil's Gate → Split Rock → South Pass. Wyoming law named in the site's legal disclaimer. Yellowstone Heart Lake easter egg. Inside Fenn's map.
ID	INPLAY	42nd parallel / Big Hill swap points at the ID–UT line; Bear River / Bear Lake names. Outside Fenn's map.
NM	INPLAY	Only north of the Santa Fe –75 mi line. Inside Fenn's map. Few concrete solves circulating.
CA	OPEN	
NV	OPEN	
WA	OPEN	
AK	FRINGE	On the printed map (Hawaii is not); nine labeled peaks order to 42; 'past the edge' reading. Fails 'American West' and 'not many miles'. Thematic, not derived.
AZ	FRINGE	Sedona: Birthing Cave + Woo Ranch under Bear Mountain by Palatki. Posey raised in AZ. Cave reading fails the rules.
CO	ELIMINATED	Eliminated by Posey at Seekers Summit, Mar 28 2026 — intentional.
OR	ELIMINATED	Eliminated by Posey at Seekers Summit, Mar 28 2026 — intentional.

10

NEXT MOVES, OBJECTIONS AND SOURCES

NEXT MOVES

The cheapest actions that would change the ranking, as the site computes them today.

1.

P1

 Place L05 for "TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor": “As hope surges, clear and bright,”
4 stanza 2–4 lines unplaced · score 97
2.

P1

 Place L09 for "TOP 2 · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front": “In ursa east his realm awaits;”
6 stanza 2–4 lines unplaced · score 91
3.

P2

 Read 'The Mountain Memory' and the chapter that introduces Tucker...
cheapest test · TOP 1 · Wisdom River corridor
4.

P2

 Open the book's Treasure Trail list and confirm or strike Sinks Canyon...
cheapest test · TOP 2 · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front
5.

P2

 Judge "Wisdom / Big Hole / Beaverhead Rock" against: Not at railroad tracks
gate · kills 0 solves so far
6.

P2

 Judge "Wisdom / Big Hole / Beaverhead Rock" against: Below about a mile high? (soft — check his exact words)
gate · kills 0 solves so far
7.

P2

 Draw the route Wisdom → Big Hole → Polaris → Beaverhead Rock and measure it against 'not a great distance'...
cheapest test · Wisdom / Big Hole / Beaverhead Rock
8.

P2

 Judge "Sinks Canyon → Wind River front" against: Not at railroad tracks
gate · kills 0 solves so far
9.

P2

 Judge "Sinks Canyon → Wind River front" against: Below about a mile high? (soft — check his exact words)
gate · kills 0 solves so far
10.

P2

 From the Rise, run 20° and 200°: what do the lines cross within a mile of a road...
cheapest test · Sinks Canyon → Wind River front

STANDING OBJECTIONS

i168 VERIFIED — Thermopolis: Hot Springs State Park is free but open 6 am–10 pm, so the site itself cannot be in the park; leashed dogs allowed on park trails. The Wedding of the Waters is 5 miles south, a Game & Fish public access area on a blue-ribbon reach. Wind River Canyon's three highway tunnels were blasted through solid rock, the third through Precambrian granite at the north end, with abutments of an old dam visible on the walls south of tunnel 3. The canyon's formations carry brown signs listing period, name and age. Legend Rock petroglyphs are ~30 miles NW.

Map / geodata · Confirmed · Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude) · 2026-09-05

→L10

→L13

→L14

→L11

×L16

i158 New composite — Gates of the Mountains / Sleeping Giant / Beartooth (Helena, MT). The Gates of the Mountains on the Missouri is the most literal 'ancient gates' in the West (Lewis & Clark, 1805). The ridge north of Helena called the Sleeping Giant is officially Beartooth Mountain — so 'in ursa [Beartooth] east his [the Giant's] realm awaits' is double-confirmed, and 'whether he is living depends on your perspective' is exactly what you say about a sleeping giant. East of the Beartooth lies Holter Lake and the Gates. The Missouri below Holter is a famous fly-fishery ('cast your pole'); the map's missing dams mean the river is drawn undammed ('waters' silent flight'). Upstream the Missouri is born of THREE rivers at Three Forks ('her foot of three'), fed by the Jefferson, fed by the Big Hole ('the Hole') from Wisdom ('Wisdom waits') — one river thread from the crowd's stanza 1–2 to a new stanza 3 ('like a river's steady flow'). Helena ~4,000 ft: below a mile. Grandfather was Montana fish-and-game. Gaps: the bride; Mann Gulch memorial crosses nearby are grave markers; distances are large unless stanzas 1–3 are armchair.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05

→L10

→L09

→L11

→L03

→L07

→L08

→L19

×L10

×L16

×L06

i217 Cross-reference on the Twin Bridges reading: at Twin Bridges, Montana the Big Hole, the Beaverhead and the Ruby join to form the Jefferson. Lewis named those three forks in 1805 for Jefferson's virtues — Wisdom (Big Hole), Philanthropy (Ruby) and Philosophy — so the poem's 'Wisdom' river runs OUT past its Hole into a literal THREE. 'Her foot of three' = the three forks at Twin Bridges; 'his realm' = the Jefferson (named for a 'he'; alive or not 'depends on perspective'); 'his bride stands guard' = Beaverhead Rock, 12 miles up the Beaverhead, Sacagawea's landmark, 'visible but not accessible' — exactly Posey's wording. Twin Bridges is ~4,600 ft (below a mile), on the Big Hole's last reach, free BLM/FWP fishing access, dogs, and Beaverhead Rock State Park sits between it and Dillon. Gaps: 'ursa' (unless pole-star), 'twenty degree', granite (the Tobacco Roots east of Twin Bridges ARE a granite batholith — 'in ursa EAST his realm awaits' could be the Tobacco Roots), and no double arcs yet.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 [→L11](#) [→L03](#) [→L07](#) [→L10](#) [→L09](#)
[→L13](#) [→L19](#) [xL09](#) [xL13](#)

i183 Book gazetteer, per the hub: places named in the memoir — Dillon, Big Hole Valley, Beaverhead Valley, Wisdom (in the Grasshopper Valley chapter), Polaris MT (explicitly named), Pioneer Mountains, Crystal Park, Bannack, Blacktail Deer Creek, Clark Canyon Reservoir, Red Rock River. The hub reads the 'geographic fingerprint' as the Big Hole / Grasshopper Valley / Pioneer Mountains corridor with Dillon as hub, and the hiding spot as 'connected to his grandfather's territory'.

Book text · Likely · treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) – via search summary · 2025-03-27
[→L09](#) [→L03](#) [→L07](#) [→L13](#) [→L16](#) [xL16](#)

i117 Poem structure. Asked whether the poem is linear, several geographic points miles apart, or a hybrid, he declined — then offered that there are some great movies out there: Indiana Jones and National Treasure. Read as a nudge away from Fenn-style point-to-point walking toward convergence: an X from intersecting lines, or something you assemble rather than follow.

Posey statement · Likely · Posey Q&A (via user research) [→L11](#) [→L12](#) [→L04](#) [xL07](#) [→L02](#)

i157 New composite — Thermopolis / Wind River Canyon / Wedding of the Waters (WY). Big Spring in Hot Springs State Park: the world's largest mineral hot spring, surging, free, 24/7 ('hope surges, clear and bright'). Wind River Canyon cuts through the OWL CREEK Mountains — an owl is the animal of silent flight ('waters' silent flight'). At the canyon mouth is a named place, the Wedding of the Waters, where the Wind River becomes the Bighorn ('his bride' at the gates of the canyon, which is signed by geological age — 'ancient gates'). Precambrian granite at the north end; the highway's three tunnels are arcs cut in it. Bighorn = double-arc horns. Wedding of the Waters is a named fishing access ('cast your pole'). Elevation ~4,400 ft — below a mile, the only mountain solve that passes Rule 42 reading 1. Wyoming law. Dogs fine. Gaps: no bear for 'ursa'; the Hole; the tunnels are man-made and no hunt item may be in one.

My own theory · Unverified · Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026) · 2026-09-05 [→L05](#) [→L06](#) [→L10](#) [→L08](#) [→L13](#)
[→L15](#) [xL09](#) [xL07](#)

i130 Pioneer Mountains, Montana — the Wisdom theory run through Polaris instead of the town. Elkhorn Hot Springs supplies the surge, Polaris supplies ursa and the north star, the Big Hole River supplies the fishing and the Hole. The Pioneers are granitic. Crystal Park is a public granite-and-quartz dig with free access. Gap: heavily searched already, and Posey has said people got within two miles, which cuts both ways.

My own theory · Unverified · My own analysis · 2026-09-05 [→L05](#) [→L09](#) [→L07](#) [→L08](#) [→L13](#) [→L14](#) [xL10](#) [xL16](#)

i194 'The key to one direction lies in another' — this line is a hidden audio message decoded from the ARKADE song 'Beyond the Map's Edge' (Netflix); Justin confirmed the associated technical clue, not as the core geographic solution. At Summit: 'Does this relate to the azimuth?' → 'No.'

Posey statement · Confirmed · Treasure Among Us – BTME pages (user research write-up) · 2026-04 [→L12](#) [xL11](#) [→L09](#)

SOURCES, RANKED BY WEIGHT

SOURCE	FACTS	WEIGHT	EARLIEST
My own analysis	27	184	2026-09
Cross-reference (Claude, Sep 5 2026)	14	132	2026-09
Posey Q&A compiled by Mysterious Writings	22	130	
Verified by web search, Sep 5 2026 (Claude)	11	128	2026-09
Seekers Summit, Tucson (Mar 28 2026) via Mysterious Writings	15	93	2026-03

SOURCE	FACTS	WEIGHT	EARLIEST
Seekers Summit, Tucson — Mar 28 2026 (THAP transcript)	8	84	2026-03
treasurehuntamusementpark.com — BTME hub (Cowlazars), site copy	7	83	2025-03
treasurehuntamusementpark.com BTME research hub (Cowlazars) — via search summary	8	76	2025-03
Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (MW Q&A compilation / Seekers Summit)	7	54	2026-03
Public-statements research report (user upload, Sep 2026)	6	49	2026-09
Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary	11	41	
Treasure Among Us — BTME pages (user research write-up)	5	39	2026
Working solve — master file §11	13	38	2026-09
Cross-reference (Claude)	5	36	2026-09
Community roundup compiled Sep 2026 (user research)	6	30	2026-09
Session notes, Sep 6 2026	7	30	2026-09
Posey Q&A (via user research)	2	28	
Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (Jenny Kile, Sep 8 2025), full text	3	27	2025-09
treasure.quest official rules	3	26	2025-03
treasure.quest announcements FAQ (via r/TreasureHunting, u/Advanced_Relation_79)	2	24	
X Dark Matters — Sep 4 2025 (JIBLE)	2	24	2025-09
Master file §12 — constraints to reconcile	6	20	2026-09
TreasureNet full walkthrough, Apr 2026 — via user research	2	20	2026-04
Dillon Q&A — Jun 21 2025 (THAP / JIBLE)	2	16	2025-06
X Marks the Pod — pre-Summit, ~early 2026 (THAP)	1	14	2026
Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — regions compared	2	14	2026-09
Audiobook vs hardcover comparison	3	12	
r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/GreenEyes7141018)	1	12	2026-08
Mysterious Writings Substack — Top 10 New Clues (via search summary)	1	12	2025
Poem word count (verified by Claude) — flagged by Mysterious Writings	1	12	2025-09
Dillon, MT Q&A (Jun 21 2025) — via user research	1	11	2025-06
Posey (quoted in user research)	1	11	
JIBLE 4.0 (jessinthewest / hi-imerica, upd. 9/30/25) via THAP hub	1	11	2025
Posey on X, Aug 1 2025	1	10	2025-08
Southwest Montana tourism blog — via web search summary; Mysterious Writings (Jenny Kile) — via web search summary	1	10	
Treasure Hunt With Us podcast — Apr 9 2025 (THAP)	1	10	2025-04

SOURCE	FACTS	WEIGHT	EARLIEST
Posey on X, ~Sep 5 2025 (via MW)	1	10	2025-09
Cross-reference (Claude) from MW + book references	1	10	2026-09
Posey via MW (restated in my analysis)	1	9	
Beyond the Map's Edge p. 213 'Mountain Memory' + Netflix (session notes Sep 6 2026)	1	9	2026-09
X Marks the Pod (Sep 4 2025)	1	8	2025-09
Beyond the Map's Edge (hardcover)	2	8	2025-03
Master file §13 — open questions	4	8	2026-09
Justin Greer, 'The Treasure I Found Along the Madison — A Full Solve' (Jul 31 2026) — via web search summary	1	8	2026-07
r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/PNW-OOTW, quoting Posey)	1	8	2026-08
Seekers Summit transcript via Mysterious Writings (relayed by Google AI overview)	1	8	2026-09
Google AI overview citing Reddit r/JustinPoseysTreasure + Mysterious Writings (machine summary — verify)	1	8	2026-09
treasure.quest announcements	1	6	
r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/PNW-OOTW)	1	6	2026-08
r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/Senior_Muscle_8829)	1	6	2026-08
r/beyondthemapledge, ~Aug 23 2026 (u/Theroguehippie1)	1	6	2026-08
Posey on X, Mar 28 2025 (via report)	1	6	2025-03
r/beyondthemapledge, ~Jan 2026 (u/DesertCloak)	1	6	2026-01
Sandal Sanders livestream — Sep 27 2025 (JIBLE)	1	6	2025-09
Mysterious Writings Substack — 'Round the bend, past the Hole' (via search summary)	1	6	2025
Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — working solve	1	6	2026-09
Dillon, MT book signing Q&A (Jun 21 2025) via Mysterious Writings	1	5	2025-06
Searcher observation + Beyond the Map's Edge (hardcover)	1	4	2025-03
MW Discord, early 2026 — via web search summary	1	4	2026
Moviedelic Netflix-clue roundup — via web search summary	1	4	
Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — next actions	2	4	2026-09
Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — La Sal screenshot	1	4	2026-09
Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — analysis of confirmed Q&A	1	3	2026-09
Searcher inference	1	2	
Gold & Greed (Netflix) — searcher observation	1	2	
My own theory	1	2	
Session notes, Sep 6 2026 (Josh's reframe)	1	2	2026-09

SOURCE	FACTS	WEIGHT	EARLIEST
Community inference (session notes Sep 6 2026)	1	2	2026-09
Mike Unfiltered substack — via web search summary	1	1	
Fan-analysis site (untraced) vs GNIS check, Sep 6 2026	1	1	2026-09
Session notes, Sep 6 2026 — standing assessment	1	0	2026-09